MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS MAGAZINE

SEPTEMBER 2026



- Detailed release for all exams
- Static GK points included
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Important Days

Date	Day	Theme
1 - 7 September	National Nutrition Week	
2 September	World Coconut Day	Coconuts in Times of Uncertainty: Securing Food, Energy, and Livelihoods
3 September	Skyscraper Day	
4 September	National Wildlife Day	
5 September	Teachers Day in India	
5 September	International Day of Charity	The Power of Charity in Global Solidarity
5 September	International Vulture Day 2026	From Crisis to Recovery – Conserving India's Vultures
7 September	International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies	Clean Air for Climate Action
7 September	International Day of Police Cooperation	Protecting against Vulnerability – Building Trust and Legitimacy in Policing
8 September	International Literacy Day	Literacy for people, the planet and prosperity
8 September	World Physiotherapy Day	
9 September	International Day to Protect Education from Attack	
10 September	World Suicide Prevention Day	Changing the narrative on suicide
11 September	National Forest Martyrs Day	
11 September	Digvijay Diwas	
12 September	International Day for South-South Cooperation	Solidarity Rising: Global Alliance for Inclusive and Innovative Development
14 September	Hindi Diwas	
15 September	Engineer's Day (India)	
15 September	International Day of Democracy	
16 September	International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer	Global action for a cooler planet
16 September	International Day for Interventional Cardiology	
17 September	World Patient Safety Day	
18 September	World Bamboo Day	Bamboo Beyond Borders
19 September (Third Saturday)	International Red Panda Day	
20 September	World Cleanup Day	From Clean Plates to Clean Cities
21 September	International Day of Peace (UN)	Invest in Peace - For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day

Date	Day	Theme
21 September	**World Alzheimer's Day**	**"The Earlier You Know, The More You Can Do: A Dementia Diagnosis Matters.**
22 September	**World Rhino Day**	
23 September	**National Ayurveda Day**	**Ayurveda for a Healthier Tomorrow**
23 September	**International Day of Sign Languages**	**Declaring deaf people's human rights**
24 September	**World Maritime Day**	**2026–2027 : From Policy to Practice: Powering Maritime Excellence**
25 September	**World Pharmacists Day**	**Empowering pharmacists for healthier futures**
25 September	**Antyodaya Diwas**	
25 September	**World Lung Day**	A Lifetime of Lung Health
26 September	**International Day for the Total Elimination of Nuclear Weapons**	
26 September	**World Environmental Health Day**	Environmental Health: Standing with Science to Protect Communities
27 September	**World Tourism Day**	Digital Agenda and Artificial Intelligence to Redesign Tourism
27 September (Fourth Sunday)	**World Rivers Day**	
28 September	**International Day for Universal Access to Information**	Upholding Information Integrity in the Digital Age: The role of access to Information in addressing Information Disorder
28 September	**World Rabies Day**	Stronger Together
29 September	**International Day of Awareness on Food Loss and Waste Reduction**	Transformative Potential of Reducing Food Loss and Waste
29 September	**World Heart Day**	Don't Miss a Beat
30 September	**International Translation Day**	**Theme - Linguistic Diversity and Language Rights**

With Static

1st - 7th September – National Nutrition Week

- **In India**, it is observed for the first week of September every year **since 1982.**
- It was **in 1973** that the **American Diabetes Association (ADA) launched the first** National Nutrition Week campaign.

2 September World Coconut Day



- **Established by** the **Asian and Pacific Coconut Community (APCC)** to recognise the importance of the coconut in agriculture, cuisine, industry, and culture
- **THEME: "Coconuts in Times of Uncertainty: Securing Food, Energy, and Livelihoods"**

- The ICAR–Central Plantation Crops Research Institute (ICAR–CPCRI), Kasaragod, As part of the celebrations, the institute will launch SHITIZ 2.0,
- An online entrepreneur mentorship and pre-incubation programme aimed at supporting aspiring entrepreneurs, startups, and innovators in transforming ideas and technologies into viable enterprises

3 September Skyscraper Day

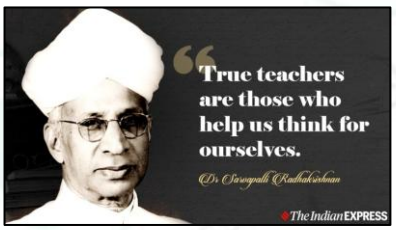
- Skyscraper Day is celebrated annually on September 3 to honor the engineering and architectural marvels of tall buildings.

4 September National Wildlife Day

- National Wildlife Day on September 4th encourages **improved awareness of the species around us and in the broader world.**
- This National Day focuses on endangered species, preservation, and conservation efforts around the world.

5 September - Teachers Day in India

- The day marks the **birth anniversary of Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan**, India's second president, an acclaimed philosopher and educationist.
- **Dr S Radhakrishnan** Worked as **Professors of Eastern Religions and Ethics** at the University of Oxford.
- Served as **India's Ambassador to the Soviet Union** from **1949 to 1952.**
- He served as the **Vice-President (1952-1962)** and **President of India (1962-1967).**



- **Literary works:** The Principal Upanishads, The Hindu view of Life, Dhammapada, etc.
- **Rewards and Recognition :** Knighthood (1931) and Bharat Ratna (1954).
- **World Teachers' Day - 5 October** to celebrate the work of teachers.

5 September International Day of Charity

- To commemorate the death **anniversary of Mother Teresa**
- **2026 THEME: The Power of Charity in Global Solidarity**
- In 1928 she went to India, where she devoted herself to helping the destitute.
- **1950**: She founded the Missionaries of Charity order in Calcutta.
- **1951**: Mother Teresa became an Indian citizen.
- **Mother Teresa died on September 5th 1997**
- **1962:** Ramon Magsaysay Peace Prize
- **1979:** Nobel Peace Prize
- **1980:** Bharat Ratna



5 September International Vulture Day 2026

- Celebrated on **first Saturday in September each year**
- Theme '**From Crisis to Recovery – Conserving India's Vultures'**
- The programme was organised in collaboration with the MoEFCC, Central Zoo Authority (CZA), Haryana Forest & Wildlife Department, Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS) and the Jatayu Conservation Breeding Centre (JCBC), Pinjore.

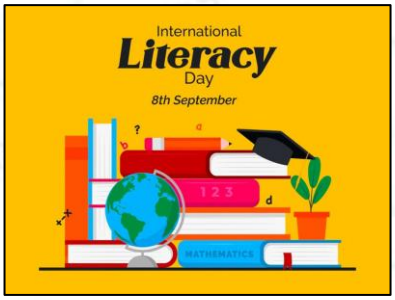
7 September International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies

- **THEME: "Clean Air for Climate Action"**
- The United Nations General Assembly designated
- First Day held in 2020.

7 September International Day of Police Cooperation

- **2026 Theme: Protecting against Vulnerability – Building Trust and Legitimacy in Policing**
- It was designated in the United Nations General Assembly
- Marked for the first time in 2023.

8 September International Literacy Day



- **Celebrated since 1967**
- **Literacy is a fundamental human right for all.**
- **Theme : "Literacy for people, the planet and prosperity."**
- **UNESCO's global International Literacy Day celebration will be held on September 8 and 9, 2026, in Chiapas, Mexico, in collaboration with the Government of Mexico.**

9 September International Day to Protect Education from Attack

- On May 28 2020, the UN General Assembly adopted **Resolution establishing September 9 as the International Day to Protect Education from Attack.**

10 September World Suicide Prevention Day

- **Observed since 2003** to raise awareness to prevent cases of suicide.
- **THEME (2024–2026) : "Changing the narrative on suicide"**
- **organised by** International Association for Suicide Prevention **(IASP); co-sponsored by WHO.**
- **India's first National Suicide Prevention Strategy (2022)**: Aims to reduce suicide mortality by **10% by 2030**
- **National initiatives:** Programs like **Tele-MANAS (Tele Mental Health Assistance and Networking Across States), DMHP (District Mental Health Programme), RKSK (Rashtriya Kishor Swasthya Karyakram), and Manodarpan** strengthen helplines, community outreach, and school-based support.

11 September - National Forest Martyrs Day

- **Started in: 2013** (declared by Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change).
- **Purpose:** To honor **forest personnel and protectors** who laid down their lives in protecting forests and wildlife.
- The date (11 Sept) **commemorates the 1730 Khejarli Massacre in Rajasthan:**
  - Led by **Amrita Devi Bishnoi.**
  - **363 Bishnoi community members** sacrificed their lives to protect **Khejri trees** from being cut by **Maharaja Abhay Singh of Jodhpur**'s soldiers.
  - This event **later inspired the Chipko Movement** and India's modern environmental conservation ethos.

11 September - Digvijay Diwas

- **To commemorate Swami Vivekananda** gave his **landmark speech on 11th September 1893** at the **World's Parliament of Religions in Chicago**, where he began with words **"Sisters and Brothers of America."**

About Swami Vivekananda

- He was born **as Narendranath Datta on 12th January, 1863.National Youth Day** is held every year to observe the birth anniversary of Swami Vivekananda.
- In **1893**, upon the request of **Maharaja Ajit Singh of the Khetri State,** he **took the name 'Vivekananda.'**
- Introduced the world to the Indian philosophies of **Vedanta and Yoga**.
- He **preached 'neo-Vedanta',** an interpretation of Hinduism through a Western lens, and believed in combining **spirituality with material progress.**
- **Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose** had called **Vivekananda the "maker of modern India."**
- He was the **chief disciple of the 19th-century mystic Ramakrishna Paramhansa** and established the **Ramakrishna Mission in 1897.**

12 September International Day for South-South Cooperation



- **Theme: Solidarity Rising: Global Alliance for Inclusive and Innovative Development**
- South-South cooperation is a collaborative approach among **developing countries, built on mutual respect, shared goals, and a deep sense of solidarity.**
- 12 September marks the adoption of the 1978 Buenos Aires Plan of Action (BAPA), a pivotal framework for technical cooperation among developing countries.

14 September - Hindi Diwas

- To commemorate the day (**14 September 1949**) when **Hindi in Devanagari script was adopted as one of the official languages of India** by the Constituent Assembly.

Constitutional Provisions



- **Article 343** – Hindi in Devanagari script as official language of the Union.
- **15 years transitional period (1950–1965)** – English continued for official purposes along with Hindi.
- **Official Languages Act, 1963** – English to continue along with Hindi even after 1965, due to protests in South India.
- **Schedule 8 of Constitution** – Lists 22 languages, including Hindi.
- **World Hindi Day – 10 January**

15 September - Engineer's Day (India)

- To commemorate the **birth anniversary of Sir Mokshagundam Visvesvaraya (1861–1962)**, one of India's greatest engineers, statesmen, and Bharat Ratna awardee.
- **Sir M. Visvesvaraya** was born on **15 September 1861** in Muddenahalli **(Karnataka).**
- Known as the **"Father of Modern Mysore"** for his role in the industrial, economic, and educational development of Mysore State.
- Famous for pioneering **irrigation systems, flood protection, and dam construction.**
- He presided over the Indian Science Congress in 1923.
- **In 1968, Government of India declared 15 September** as Engineer's Day in his honor.

Contributions:

- Designed the **Krishna Raja Sagara (KRS) Dam in Mysore** (one of the largest dams in India then).
- Contributed to **flood protection system of Hyderabad** (after 1908 floods).
- He is widely recognized as an early advocate and practitioner of **Economic Planning in India**, called the **Visvesvaraya Plan,** which he presented in a **book titled "Planned Economy in India".**

Honors:

- **Bharat Ratna (1955)**
- **Knight Commander of the British Indian Empire (K.C.I.E.) – 1915**
- **World Engineering Day – Celebrated on 4 March (declared by UNESCO in 2019)**

15 September - International Day of Democracy

- First observed in 2008

16 September International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer

- **2026 Theme: Global action for a cooler planet**
- In **1994, the UN General Assembly** proclaimed 16 September as **World Ozone Day.**
- It commemorates the signing of the **Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer** (16 September 1987).
- The **Montreal Protocol** regulates the **production and consumption of ozone-depleting substances (ODS)** such as CFCs, halons, and carbon tetrachloride.
- The **Kigali Amendment (2016)** extended the Montreal Protocol to **phase down hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs),** which are not ODS but are powerful greenhouse gases.

16 September International Day for Interventional Cardiology

- It marks the anniversary of the **first coronary angioplasty performed by Dr. Andreas Grüntzig** in Zurich on **16 September 1977**

17 September - World Patient Safety Day

- **Established by:** World Health Organization **(WHO) in 2019**
- Purpose**: To raise global awareness about patient safety, encourage people's involvement**, and call for global solidarity to reduce avoidable harm in healthcare.

18th September - World Bamboo Day

- **World Bamboo Day** is celebrated annually on **September 18** to raise global awareness about the environmental, economic, and cultural significance of bamboo.
- Established in **2009** during the 8th World Bamboo Congress in Bangkok, Thailand
- **THEME: "Bamboo Beyond Borders"**

18 September International Equal Pay Day

- This day aims to raise awareness about the persistent gender pay gap and advocate for equal pay for equal work.
- Established in 2019, **first observed in 2020.**

19 September (Third Saturday) International Red Panda Day

- To raise awareness about the **endangered red panda**, its conservation, and habitat protection.

- **Habitat:** Temperate forests of the **Himalayas and high mountains** – found in India (**Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh**), Nepal, Bhutan, China, and Myanmar.
- **IUCN Status: Endangered (IUCN Red List).**



20 September World Cleanup Day

- **THEME : From Clean Plates to Clean Cities**
- On 8 December 2023, the United Nations General Assembly, adopted resolution - proclaims 20 September as World Cleanup Day.

21 September - International Day of Peace (UN)

- **Theme: Invest in Peace - For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day**
- Established in **1981** by the **United Nations General Assembly**.
- **First observed in 1982.**
- **In 2001**, the UNGA unanimously adopted a resolution to **fix the date as 21 September** and also declared it as a **day of non-violence and ceasefire.**

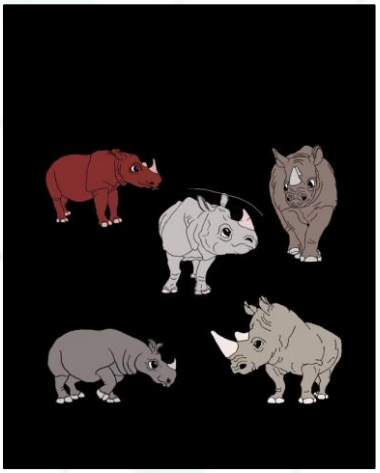
September 21 - World Alzheimer's Day("The Earlier You Know, The More You Can Do: A Dementia Diagnosis Matters)

- Alzheimer's is a **progressive neurological disorder** that affects memory, thinking, and behavior - is the **most common cause of dementia**
- **Dementia** is currently the **seventh leading cause of death** and one of the major causes of disability and dependency among older people globally.
- **Launched in 1994** by **Alzheimer's Disease International (ADI)** to mark its 10th anniversary.

UN Declares November 27 as Child Marriage Elimination Day

- India has co-sponsored a resolution in the **UN General Assembly (UNGA**) proclaiming November 27 every year as the **International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage**.
- The 193-member UNGA on Friday (September 4, 2026) adopted by consensus the resolution titled '**International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage' led by Sierra Leone.**

22 September - World Rhino Day



- **Started in 2010** by the **World Wildlife Fund (WWF) – South Africa.**
- Aim: To raise **awareness about the five rhino species** and the need to protect them from poaching and habitat loss.

Five rhino species:

- **White Rhino** (Africa)
- **Black Rhino** (Africa)
- **Indian Rhino / Greater One-horned Rhino** (Asia – mainly India & Nepal)
- **Javan Rhino** (Asia – Indonesia)
- **Sumatran Rhino** (Asia – Indonesia)

23 September National Ayurveda Day

- Theme for Ayurveda Day 2026 : **"Ayurveda for a Healthier Tomorrow"**

- Ayurveda Day was **earlier celebrated on Dhanteras** every year, in honour of **Lord Dhanwantari**, the physician of gods.
- The date, based on lunar calendar, used to vary every year.
- The **World Ayurveda Congress (WAC)**, established by World Ayurveda Foundation, is **held biennially** to promote Ayurveda globally and also integrate it in current global healthcare systems.

23 September International Day of Sign Languages

- **Theme : Declaring deaf people's human rights**
- September 23 was chosen to mark the **founding of the World Federation of the Deaf (WFD) in 1951**
- The International Day of Sign Languages was **first celebrated in 2018** as part of the International Week of the Deaf.
- **The International Week of Deaf People 2026 takes place from September 21 to 27, 2026.**

24 September World Maritime Day

- 2026–2027 Theme: "**From Policy to Practice: Powering Maritime Excellence"**
- Established by the United Nations via the International Maritime Organization (IMO).

25 September - World Pharmacists Day

- **Theme - "Empowering pharmacists for healthier futures"**
- **Established by**: International Pharmaceutical Federation **(FIP) in 2009** at its council meeting **in Istanbul, Turkey**
- **First Observed: 2010**
- **Purpose:** To recognize and promote the role of pharmacists in improving health through safe and effective use of medicines.
- Marks the anniversary of the **inception of** International Pharmaceutical Federation (FIP) **in 1912**

25 September - Antyodaya Diwas

- **First Observed: 2014**
- Marks the **birth anniversary of Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya** (1916–1968), noted philosopher, politician, and proponent of Integral Humanism.
- To honor Deendayal Upadhyaya's vision of "Antyodaya" — uplifting the last person in the queue (the poorest of the poor).
- **His philosophy of "Integral Humanism**" focussed on individual and collective welfare, social justice, economic equality, and self-reliance.
- He was the co-founder of the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS), which later evolved into the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).
- He was also a **key thinker for** the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh **(RSS).**
- **In 2015,** the name of National Rural Livelihood Mission **(NRLM) was changed to Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-NRLM.**
- **In 2018**, the **Mughalsarai Junction railway station in UP** was **renamed Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Junction**.
- He was assassinated under mysterious circumstances near Mughal Sarai in 1968.

25 September World Lung Day

- World Lung Day is observed annually on September 25, coordinated by the Forum of International Respiratory Societies (FIRS) **to raise global awareness about respiratory health.**
- **Theme : "A Lifetime of Lung Health,"**

26 September International Day for the Total Elimination of Nuclear Weapons

- The General Assembly declared the International Day in December **2013.**

26 September - World Environmental Health Day

- **Purpose:** To raise awareness about the **importance of environmental health** in preventing diseases and promoting well-being.
- **Established by** the International Federation of Environmental Health **(IFEH) in 2011**
- **THEME: Environmental Health: Standing with Science to Protect Communities**
- Links directly to **SDG 3** (Good Health and Well-being) and **SDG 13** (Climate Action).

27 September World Tourism Day

- An initiative of the United Nations World Tourism Organisation (UNWTO).
- **THEME: "Digital Agenda and Artificial Intelligence to Redesign Tourism"**
- It commemorates the **adoption of the UNWTO statutes in 1970**
- It was celebrated for the **first time in the year 1980.**
- **San Salvador and Surf City in El Salvador will host the official global celebrations for World Tourism Day 2026.**

Ministry of Tourism in India Initiatives:

- **Swadesh Darshan and Swadesh Darshan 2.0 -** 110 projects have been developed across various thematic circuits, including the Ramayana, Buddhist, Coastal, and Tribal circuits.
- **PRASHAD (**'Pilgrimage Rejuvenation And Spiritual Augmentation Drive') **a Central Sector Scheme**
- **Sustainable and Responsible Tourism (SASCI) initiative -** with 100% central funding.
- **'Dekho Apna Desh' initiative launched** in January 2020 to promote domestic tourism in the country.

27 September (Fourth Sunday) World Rivers Day

- **Started by:** Mark Angelo (river conservationist, Canada)
- **First observed: 2005** (after UN's launch of the Water for Life Decade 2005–2015)

Objective:

- To celebrate the world's waterways.
- To raise awareness about the **importance of rivers** and encourage their **protection** and **restoration.**

28 September International Day for Universal Access to Information

- **THEME: "Upholding Information Integrity in the Digital Age: The role of access to Information in addressing Information Disorder".**
- Initially the day was designated by the UNESCO General Conference. It was inaugurated in November 2015 and was **first held on 28 September 2016.**
- **UN General Assembly adopted the day in 2019**

- Emphasizes the **importance of the Right to Information (RTI)** as a key to transparency, accountability, and sustainable development.
- **India enacted** the Right to Information Act **(RTI) in 2005**, a landmark step in empowering citizens with access to public information.

28 September World Rabies Day

- **2026 Theme**: "Stronger Together".
- Rabies is a **vaccine-preventable, zoonotic, viral disease.**
- It is caused **by** a **Ribonucleic Acid (RNA) virus** that is present in the **saliva of a rabid animal** (dog, cat, monkey, etc).
- It is invariably transmitted following a bite of an infected animal that leads to **deposition of the saliva** and the virus in the wound.
- **Once clinical symptoms appear, rabies is virtually 100% fatal.**

29 September International Day of Awareness on Food Loss and Waste Reduction

- **THEME:**. "Transformative Potential of Reducing Food Loss and Waste"
- On 19 December **2019, the UN General Assembly proclaimed** International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste (IDAFLW).

29 September World Heart Day

- **2026 theme** : **"Don't Miss a Beat"**
- **Established by**: World Heart Federation **(WHF) in 1999.**
- **First celebrated** on the last Sunday of September **in 2000**, the date was set to a fixed September 29 each year starting in 2011
- **Supported by:** World Health Organization **(WHO)** and various global health agencies.

30 September International Translation Day

- **Theme 2026** - Linguistic Diversity and Language Rights
- Observed **since 1953, by** the International Federation of Translators (**FIT)**
- **24 May 2017**, the **General Assembly** declared 30 September as International Translation Day.
- 30 September **celebrates the feast of St. Jerome**, the Bible translator, who is considered the patron saint of translators. He **translated the Bible into Latin**

Appointments

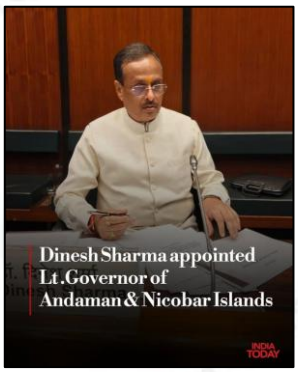
National Appointments

Person	Appointment
Dinesh Sharma	Lt Governor of Andaman and Nicobar Islands
Justice Valluri Kameswar Rao	Chief Justice, Patna High Court
Justice Ravindra V. Ghuge	Chief Justice, Calcutta High Court
Justice Sanjay Kumar Agrawal	Chief Justice, Rajasthan High Court
Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi	Chief Justice, Bombay High Court
Justice Valluri Kameswar Rao	Chief Justice, Patna High Court

Person	Appointment
Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra	Chief Justice, Punjab and Haryana High Court
Justice Krushna Ram Mohapatra	Chief Justice, Chhattisgarh High Court
Justice Alpesh Yeshwant Kogje	Chief Justice, Madhya Pradesh High Court
Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati	Chief Justice, Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court
Prasanna Kumar Acharya	Chairman-cum-Managing Director of NLC India Ltd. (NLCIL)
Sanjukta Parasor	Inspector General of the Central Reserve Police Force's elite CoBRA unit
Stanzin Tsangyang	First woman officer from the Zanskar region of Ladakh
Air Vice Marshal Shakti Sharma	First woman officer (non-medical) in the Indian Defence forces
Hansraj Singh Verma	India's Ambassador to Cuba
Suman Ray	Executive Director (ED) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
N. Chandrasekaran	Executive Chairman of Tata Sons
Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra (Retd.)	Chief Executive Officer of Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust
Muralee Mohan	Member of the Indian Red Cross Society
Nivedita Anil Sharma and Nisha Sahay Saxena	Judges in the Delhi High Court
Sanjay Sharma, Bharat Parashar, Dr. Aditi Choudhary, Dinesh Bhatt and Arun Bhardwaj	Additional Judges of the Delhi High Court
Yash Paul Bourney	Judge of the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court
Manoj Prasad, Akhil Kumar and Ram Sharma	Judges in the Jharkhand High Court
Usharani, K.S. Bharath Kumar and Nerale V. Bhavani	Additional Judges of the Karnataka High Court.
Person	Appointment
Mandeep K. Bhandari	Chairman of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE)
Jayanti Prasad	additional charge as Chairperson of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
Former Justice R. C. Chavan	Resigned from Maharashtra's seven-member Uniform Civil Code committee.

Ministries

BJP MP Dinesh Sharma appointed Lt Governor of Andaman and Nicobar Islands



- Mr. Sharma will succeed Admiral D K Joshi (retd), who took over as **lieutenant governor of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands on October 8, 2017.**
- Mr. Sharma, 62, earlier served as **deputy Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh.**
- His Rajya Sabha term was to end on November 25.
- He is also the vice chairperson of the Rajya Sabha.

Judicial

Government Appoints Eight New High Court Chief Justices

- President Droupadi Murmu appointed eight judges of **various High Courts as Chief Justices of different High Courts.**
- **High Courts in India were first established under the Indian High Courts Act, 1861.**
- The **Supreme Court Collegium system** is used for recommending appointments and transfers of judges in higher judiciary.
- **Article 217 of the Constitution governs the appointment, tenure, and conditions of office of High Court judges.**

S.No.	Appointee	Earlier Position	New High Court
1	Justice Valluri Kameswar Rao	Judge, Delhi High Court	Chief Justice, Patna High Court
2	Justice Ravindra V. Ghuge	Judge, Bombay High Court	Chief Justice, Calcutta High Court
3	Justice Sanjay Kumar Agrawal	Judge, Chhattisgarh High Court	Chief Justice, Rajasthan High Court
4	Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi	Judge, Allahabad High Court	Chief Justice, Bombay High Court
5	Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra	Judge, Punjab and Haryana High Court	Chief Justice, Punjab and Haryana High Court
6	Justice Krushna Ram Mohapatra	Judge, Orissa High Court	Chief Justice, Chhattisgarh High Court
7	Justice Alpesh Yeshwant Kogje	Judge, Gujarat High Court	Chief Justice, Madhya Pradesh High Court
8	Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati	Judge, Rajasthan High Court	Chief Justice, Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court

President Droupadi Murmu appoints 14 Judicial Officers as Judges, Additional Judges of five High Courts

- President Droupadi Murmu appointed 14 judicial officers as Judges and Additional Judges of the **Delhi, Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, Jharkhand and Karnataka High Courts.**
- The appointments were made in exercise of the **powers conferred by the Constitution of India and after consultation with the Chief Justice of India**, according to the Ministry of Law and Justice.
- In the Delhi High Court, **Nivedita Anil Sharma and Nisha Sahay Saxena have been appointed as Judges.**
- Sanjay Sharma, Bharat Parashar, Dr. Aditi Choudhary, Dinesh Bhatt and Arun Bhardwaj have been appointed as **Additional Judges of the Delhi High Court.**
- **Yash Paul Bourney** has been appointed as a Judge of the **Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court.**
- In **the Jharkhand High Court, Manoj Prasad, Akhil Kumar and Ram Sharma have been appointed as Judges.**
- **Usharani, K.S. Bharath Kumar and Nerale V. Bhavani** have been appointed as **Additional Judges of the Karnataka High Court.**

PSU Appointments

Prasanna Kumar Acharya is new CMD of NLCIL



- Prasanna Kumar Acharya assumed office as the **new Chairman-cum-Managing Director of NLC India Ltd. (NLCIL).**
- Prior to his new role, Mr. Acharya was the Director (Finance) of NLCIL.

Security & Defence

Sanjukta Parashar Becomes First Woman to Head CRPF CoBRA



- **SENIOR IPS officer Sanjukta Parasor**, also known as the **"Iron Lady of Assam"** for her **counter-insurgency work in the Northeast,** has taken charge as **Inspector General of the Central Reserve Police Force's elite CoBRA unit,** becoming the first woman officer to head the specialised jungle-warfare force.
- **a 2006-batch IPS officer of the Assam-Meghalaya cadre,**
- Parasor succeeds 1996-batch IPS officer Danesh Rana as the IG, CoBRA.
- **CoBRA, or Commando Battalion for Resolute Action, is one of CRPF's most specialised operational formations.**
- Raised for **high-risk missions in jungle and guerrilla warfare environments**, the force is trained for long-range patrols, intelligence-based operations, ambushes, counter-ambushes and operations in areas where improvised explosive devices pose a major threat.
- The force has been deployed extensively in **anti-Maoist operations** across **Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha and Maharashtra,**

Stanzin Tsangyang Becomes Kargil's First Woman Officer



- **Stanzin Tsangyang** was commissioned into the Indian Army at **the Officers Training Academy in Chennai.**
- She became the **first woman officer from the Zanskar region of Ladakh** and was part of a batch of 342 cadets who completed training at the academy.
- **The Officers Training Academy (OTA) in Chennai is one of the principal training institutions of the Indian Army**

Air Vice Marshal Shakti Sharma scripts history with AVM-rank appointment



- AIR VICE-MARSHAL Shakti Sharma has made history as the **first woman officer (non-medical)** in the Indian defence forces to **achieve the rank of Air Vice Marshal (or its equivalent).**
- She is the **first woman officer in the Indian Armed Forces**
- **Commissioned into the Education Branch of the IAF on June 18, 1994**
- She is also the **first woman officer from the Tri-Services to command a Sainik School**, serving as Principal of Sainik School, Kapurthala.

NOTE:

- Last month, **Squadron Leader Bhawana Kanth became the first woman pilot to**

clear the Fighter Combat Leader (FCL) course at the Tactics and Air Combat Development Establishment in Gwalior.

- In May this year, **Squadron Leader Saanya** became the **first woman officer in the Indian Air Force to earn the elite Category-A Qualified Flying Instructor** (Cat-A QFI) qualification.

Indian Ambassador

Hansraj Singh Verma Appointed India's Next Ambassador to Cuba



- Hansraj Singh Verma has been appointed as **India's next Ambassador to the Republic of Cuba.**
- Hansraj Singh Verma is an Indian Foreign Service officer of the 2008 batch.
- Before this posting, **he served as the Consul General of India at the Consulate General of India in Sao Paulo, Brazil.**

Banking

RBI appoints Suman Ray as Executive Director



- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has **appointed Suman Ray as Executive Director (ED) with effect from September 01, 2026.**
- Before being promoted to ED, Mr. Suman Ray **was serving as Regional Director for Maharashtra.**
- Mr. Ray has also served as Secretary to the Western Area Local Board.

Miscellaneous

N. Chandrasekaran Reappointed as Tata Sons Chairman

- The board of Tata Sons approved a **fresh five-year term for N. Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman,** but the decision has triggered a major corporate battle as Tata Trusts declared the reappointment "illegal" and a "legal nullity."
- The conflict reverses Chandrasekaran's previous decision to step down when his current tenure ends on February 20, 2027

Ram Temple Trust appoints Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra (Retd.) as first CEO



- The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust appointed **Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra (Retd.)** as its **first Chief Executive Officer.**
- The vacancies arose following the **resignations of senior Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader and general secretary Champat Rai**, and trustee Anil Mishra.

Dentist Muralee Mohan nominated



- **Dentist Muralee Mohan Choontharu** from Mangaluru has been nominated by President Droupadi Murmu as a **member of the National Managing Body (NMB) of the Indian Red Cross Society.**
- His term as NMB member will be until October 15, 2027.
- Dr. Choontharu has been a **life member of the Indian Red Cross Society.**

Mandeep K. Bhandari Appointed CBSE Chairman

- In less than four months, the Centre has appointed its third CBSE chairperson, naming senior IAS officer **Mandeep K. Bhandari as the new head of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE).**
- **Bhandari replaces Lokhande Prashant Sitaram**, marking the third officer to head the national education board since June 2
- Bhandari, a 2001-batch IAS officer of the AGMUT cadre, hails from Punjab

Jayanti Prasad Gets Additional Charge as IBBI Chairperson

- Jayanti Prasad, a Whole Time Member of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI), **assumed additional charge as Chairperson.**
- He will hold the **post until 20 November 2026** or until a full-time successor joins the office.
- Ravi Mital, an Indian Administrative Service officer of the 1986 batch, completed his tenure as IBBI Chairperson after attaining the age of 65 years.
- The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India is a statutory regulator established under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016.
- It regulates **insolvency professionals, insolvency professional agencies, information utilities, and corporate insolvency processes in India**.

Former Justice R. C. Chavan Resigns from Maharashtra UCC Panel

- Former **Justice R. C. Chavan** resigned from **Maharashtra's seven-member Uniform Civil Code committee.**
- The committee was formed in July 2026 to prepare a framework for implementing a common civil code in the state.
- The Uniform Civil Code is mentioned in Article 44 of the Directive Principles of State Policy in the Constitution of India.

International Appointments

Person	Appointment
John Ternus	Chief Executive Officer of Apple
Luke Lindberg	Executive Director of the World Food Programme (WFP)
Michael Kremer	chief economist of the World Bank
Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh	Secretary-General of the Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU)
Edward Rukidi Kijanangoma	King of the Tooro Kingdom in Uganda
Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri	Prime Minister of Morocco

Edward Rukidi Kijanangoma crowned Tooro Kingdom king

- Edward Rukidi Kijanangoma was crowned the 13th King of the Tooro Kingdom in Uganda at Karuziika Palace in Fort Portal City.
- He adopted the regnal name Edward Rukidi Nyabongo I during the coronation ceremony.
- The Tooro Kingdom is one of the traditional monarchies in Uganda.
- Kijanangoma succeeded King Oyo Nyimba Kabamba Iguru Rukidi IV.

The capital of Uganda is Kampala



Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri Becomes Morocco's First Woman Prime Minister



- Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri was appointed Prime Minister of Morocco by King Mohammed VI.
- She became the first woman to hold the office of prime minister in Morocco and the second woman prime minister in the Arab world after Tunisia's Najla Bouden.
- Morocco is a constitutional monarchy in North Africa with a bicameral parliament and a prime minister who heads the government
- The capital of Morocco is Rabat.

Pvt. Organizations



SHORT NEWS

- John Ternus officially became the Chief Executive Officer of Apple on September 1, 2026, concluding Tim Cook's historic 15-year tenure at the helm of the tech giant.

Miscellaneous

UN Appoints Luke Lindberg to Head World Food Programme



- The United Nations **appointed U.S. agriculture official Luke Lindberg as the new Executive Director of the World Food Programme (WFP).**
- The World Food Programme is the **food-assistance arm of the United Nations and is headquartered in Rome, Italy.**
- It is the world's largest humanitarian organisation focused on hunger relief, food aid, and emergency logistics.
- The World Food Programme **won the Nobel Peace Prize in 2020 for its efforts to combat hunger** and improve conditions for peace in conflict-affected areas.

Michael Kremer to Become World Bank Chief Economist



- The World Bank named Nobel laureate and University of Chicago professor **Michael Kremer as its next chief economist**, succeeding Indermit Gill, who retired last month.
- **Kremer, 61, won the Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences in 2019 jointly with Esther Duflo and Abhijit Banerjee** for their experimental approach to alleviating global poverty.

Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh Re-elected APPU Secretary-General for Second Consecutive Term



- Vinaya Prakash Singh, **a 1988 batch officer of the Indian Postal Service**, has been recently re-elected as **Secretary-General of the Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU) for a second consecutive four-year term.**
- **Asian-Pacific Postal Union**
- It is an intergovernmental organization of 32 member countries of the Asian-Pacific region.

- **Headquarters: Bangkok, Thailand.**
- It is the only Restricted Union of the Universal Postal Union (UPU) in the region, which is a **specialized agency of the United Nations dealing with postal services.**

Bangladesh Foreign Secretary Asad Alam Siam to be the next High Commissioner to India

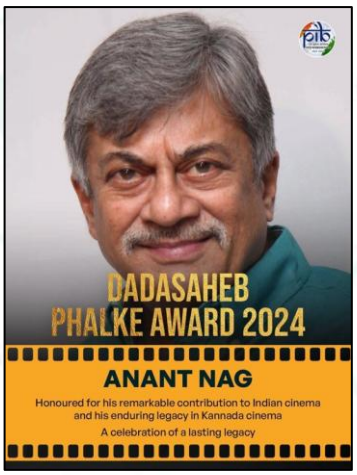
- India formally approved the appointment of Bangladesh foreign secretary Asad Alam Siam as the **next high commissioner to New Delhi,**
- **will replace Riaz Hamidullah**
- Hamidullah has been posted as Bangladesh's new permanent representative to the UN in Geneva.
- **He was Bangladesh's ambassador to the US for less than a year before he was appointed foreign secretary in June 2025.**

Awards

National

Entertainment & Music

Anant Nag to be honoured with Dadasaheb Phalke award



- **Legendary actor Anant Nag**, known for his impressive work in **Hindi and Kannada cinema** will be honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024.
- **It is given by the Indian government for lifetime contribution to Indian cinema.**
- It was **instituted in 1969** the birth centenary year of Dadasaheb Phalke.
- It is the **highest award in the field of cinema in India.**
- The award will be presented to Shri Anant Nag at the **72nd National Film Awards ceremony to be held on 22nd September, 2026, at Kevadia, Gujarat.**
- The award's **inaugural recipient was Devika Rani,** aptly titled **"the first lady of Indian cinema".**
- The recipients are recognized for their 'outstanding contribution to the growth and development of Indian cinema'.
- Award includes: **The award comprises a Swarna Kamal (Golden Lotus) medallion, a shawl, and a cash prize of ₹10 lakh.**
- It is presented by the President of India.

Key Facts about Dhundiraj Govind Phalke

- He was born on April 30, 1870, in Trimbak, Maharashtra.
- He was a film director who is considered the **father of Indian cinema.**
- He directed **India's first full-length feature film, Raja Harishchandra in 1913.**

About Shri Anant Nag

- Shri Anant Nag (born 4 September 1948, Karnataka) is a veteran Indian actor renowned for his versatility and contribution to Indian cinema spanning over 5 decades.

- Shri Anant has **won five Filmfare Awards and five Karnataka State Best Actor Awards**, along with the Karnataka Rajyotsava Award, the Karnataka Sahitya Academy Award, and the Karnataka State Lifetime Achievement Award.
- He also holds an **Honorary Doctorate from Bangalore University (North).**
- In 2023, he celebrated the **Golden Jubilee of his 50-year career in cinema.**
- Shri Anant served as a Member of the Karnataka Legislative Council from 1988 to 1994 and as a Member of the Legislative Assembly from 1994 to 1999, during which he held office as Minister of State for Bangalore City Development.
- **He has been honoured by the Government of India with the Padma Bhushan in 2025.**

Rani Mukerji Gets Maharashtra's Raj Kapoor Award

- Rani Mukerji was honoured with the **Raj Kapoor Special Contribution Award by Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis** at the 62nd Maharashtra State Film Awards ceremony held at Ravindra Natya Mandir in Prabhadevi, Mumbai.
- In August 2026, **Mukerji was awarded an Honorary Doctor of Letters by Australia's La Trobe University** during the **Indian Film Festival of Melbourne (IFFM) at Federation Square.**

72nd National Film Awards

- The 72nd National Film Awards, to be held at **Ekta Nagar, Kevadia, Gujarat, on 22 September 2026.**
- **The ceremony is particularly significant this year as the National Film Awards are being held outside New Delhi for the first time in 72 years.**
- The President of India will present the **prestigious awards, recognising outstanding achievements in Indian cinema for the year 2024.**
- The National Film Awards are among the most prestigious honours for Indian cinema.
- **Instituted in 1954,** the Awards recognise excellence across **Feature Films, Non-Feature Films and Writing on Cinema, covering a wide range of languages, regions and forms of filmmaking.**
- **For the first time, a Santhali film was honoured in the Non-Feature Film section.**

Section	Categories	Medal	Cash prize
Feature Films	26 (with special mentions)	Swarna Kamal, Rajat Kamal	Rs 3,00,000 and Rs 2,00,000
Non-Feature Films	16 (with special mentions)	Swarna Kamal, Rajat Kamal	Rs 3,00,000 and Rs 2,00,000
Best Writing on Cinema	2	Swarna Kamal	Rs 1,00,000
Dadasaheb Phalke Award	1	Swarna Kamal, shawl	Rs 10,00,000 for 72nd NFA

Dadasaheb Phalke Award

- The Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024 will be presented to veteran **actor Anant Nag** in recognition of his outstanding contribution to Indian cinema.

Award	Film (Language)	Awardee
Best Feature Film	Article 370 (Hindi)	Producers: Jio Studios and B62 Studios; Director: Aditya Suhas Jambhale
Best Direction	Amaran (Tamil)	Rajkumar Periasamy
Best Actor in a Leading Role	Bramayugam (Malayalam); Chandu Champion (Hindi)	Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan (shared)

Award	Film (Language)	Awardee
Best Actress in a Leading Role	Article 370 (Hindi)	Yami Gautam
Best Actor in a Supporting Role	Bhakshak (Hindi)	Sanjay Mishra
Best Actress in a Supporting Role	Maharaja (Tamil); Mithya (Kannada)	Sachana Namidass and Ropashree Varkady (shared)
Best Debut Film of a Director	Swatantrya Veer Savarkar (Hindi)	Randeep Hooda
Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment	Kalki 2898 AD (Telugu)	Producer: Vyjayanthi Movies; Director: Nag Ashwin Singireddy
Best Lyrics	Maidaan (Hindi)	Lyricist: Manoj Muntashir (For Song: Jaane Do)
Best Choreography	Stree 2 (Hindi)	Choreographer: Vijay Ganguly (For Song: Aaj Ki Raat)
Best Action Direction (Stunt Choreography)	Maharaja (Tamil)	Stunt Choreographer: Anl Arasu
Best Music Direction	i. Article 370 (Hindi) ii. Amaran (Tamil)	Music Director (Songs): Shashwat Sachdev Music Director (Background Music): G. V. Prakash Kumar
Best Feature Film Promoting National, Social and Environmental Values	Captain Miller (Tamil)	Producer: Sathya Jyothi Films; Director: Arun Matheswaran
Best Children's Film	35 - Chinna Katha Kaadu (Telugu)	Producers: S Originals and Waltair Productions; Director: Nanda Kishore Emani
Best Music Direction	Article 370 (Hindi); Amaran (Tamil)	Shashwat Sachdev (Songs); G. V. Prakash Kumar (Background Music)
Best Non-Feature Film	Bhangaar (Marathi and English)	Producer and Director: Sumira Roy
Best Debut Film of a Director (Non-Feature)	Angen (Santhali)	Director: Ravi Raj Murmu
Best Documentary	Ram-Nami (Hindi)	Producer: BBP Studio Virtual Bharat Pvt. Ltd.; Director: Bharatbala Ganapathy
Best Direction (Non-Feature)	Statue of Unity - Ekta ka Prateek (Hindi)	Aanand L Rai
Best Book on Cinema	Naaniruvude Nimagaagi Naadiruvude Nanagaagi (Kannada)	Author: Kenchanuru Pradeep Kumar Shetty; Publisher: Mirror Pusthaka

Art & Literature

Lalit Kala Akademi Announces 20 Awards at National Exhibition

- The Lalit Kala Akademi, the National Academy of Art, **announced 20 Lalit Kala Akademi Awards at the 65th National Exhibition of Art (NEA),** recognising 20 artists for their **works across painting, sculpture, drawing, printmaking and other forms of contemporary visual art.**
- selected 20 artworks by 20 artists for the Lalit Kala Akademi Awards.

Other Military Awards

President's Colour Presented to Goa Police

- The President's Colour was presented to the Goa Police on 7 September 2026 at the Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Indoor Stadium in Taleigao, Goa.
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah presented the honour, and **Goa became the fifth state police force in India to receive the President's Police Colour.**
- The President's Colour is a **ceremonial military or police honour awarded by the President of India to units with distinguished service.**
- In India, the award is associated with exceptional discipline, operational record, and service to the nation.

Also known as **Rashtrapati Ka Nishan. It's awarded only when a force completes at least 25 years of distinguished service** and shows consistent excellence in maintaining law and order.

- Recent state police winners (2024–2026):
- **Goa Police (September 2026)**
- **Puducherry Police (August 2026)**
- **Sikkim Police (May 2026)**
- **Meghalaya Police (April 2026)**
- **Odisha Police (April 2026)**
- **Chhattisgarh Police (December 2024)**

Science

UAS-Dharwad's groundnut variety GPBD 4 selected for ISSCA Award

- Groundnut variety GPBD 4, developed and **released by the University of Agricultural Sciences (UAS), Dharwad**, has been **selected for the ISSCA (ICRISAT Centre of Excellence for South-South Cooperation in Agriculture) Award 2026** under the category 'Crop Improvement and Production Technologies'.
- The award will be presented in New Delhi on September 12 during Drylands Congress 2026.
- Jointly organised by the **International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT) and the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR).**

Stanford Researcher Wins 2026 SASTRA-Ramanujan Award



- **Sarah Peluse**, associate professor of mathematics, **Stanford University, U.S., has bagged the SASTRA-Ramanujan Award 2026.**
- the SASTRA-Ramanujan Award **one of the globally renowned awards for Mathematics.**
- Prof. Peluse has been selected for the award in recognition of her **outstanding contributions to the field of analytic number theory, additive combinatorics, combinatorial geometry**, and group theory have created several breakthroughs in advanced problems.
- Interestingly, **the 2005** inaugural SASTRA-Ramanujan Award joint-winner, **Professor Kannan Soundarajan**, is **also Professor Peluse's PhD advisor at Stanford.**
- This is the first time in the award's history that a **PhD advisor and PhD scholar both win the same award after a gap of 20 years.**

- The award is globally renowned in the mathematical community. **Out of the 21 previous winners, seven went on to win the Fields Medal**, which is widely considered the Nobel Prize equivalent for mathematics.
- **The Fields Medal is awarded by the International Mathematical Union every four years to mathematicians under 40 years of age.**
- **Awarded For:** Breakthrough contributions in number theory, using ideas from combinatorics, analytic number theory, and probability.
- **Prize:** USD 10,000
- **Eligibility:** Mathematicians aged 32 or below.
- **Instituted By:** SASTRA University, Tamil Nadu in 2005.
- **Focus:** Work inspired by Srinivasa Ramanujan's mathematical legacy.



About Srinivasa Ramanujan:

- **Born:** 22 December 1887, Tamil Nadu
- **Fields:** Number theory, elliptic functions, partition theory, hypergeometric series.
- **Recognized by:** G.H. Hardy in 1913 → worked at Cambridge University.
- **First Paper:** 1911, Journal of the Indian Mathematical Society
- **Famous Number:** 1729 – known as the Ramanujan number.
- **Legacy:** 22 December celebrated as National Mathematics Day in India.

Banking & Business

A.P. social audit body wins SKOCH Gold Awards

- The **Society for Social Audit Accountability and Transparency of Andhra Pradesh (SSAAT)** has become the **first State Social Audit Organisation** in the country to **receive the prestigious SKOCH Gold Award .**
- AP Social Audit **Director G. Srikanth received the award** at the 109th SKOCH Summit held at the India Habitat Centre in New Delhi
- The award recognises the **State's efforts to make social audits more participatory, transparent and accountable**, particularly in the implementation of rural development and welfare programmes.

Ministry Related

5th Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards conferred on Best Performing Cities and Wards on Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026

- **The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC)** conferred the **5th Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards on Swachh Vayu Diwas (September 7, 2026),** held in conjunction with the **International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies**
- The awards were based on participation and **ranking of all 130 cities in 3 groups (Population below 3 Lakh; 3-10 Lakh; & above 10 Lakh), through the process involving self-assessment by cities,** approval by State-level Monitoring Committee, evaluation by CPCB, field verification by Independent Committees and **selection of 10 best performing cities.**
- **Lucknow secured the top rank nationally with 198 points,** followed closely by **Indore in second place (197 points) and Jabalpur in third place.**
- Meanwhile, **Chennai, Jamshedpur, Kota, Kolkata, and Madurai ranked in the bottom five in this category,** while **Delhi and Mumbai ranked 30th and 37th, respectively.**

- In the category of cities with a population **between 3-10 lakh people, Rourkela topped, followed by Firozabad and Guntur in joint second place, and Amravati in third place**.
- In category 3 – cities with less than 3 lakh people **– Kalinga Nagar won the first position, Angul the second, and Talcher got the third place.**

President of India confers National Awards on teachers

- President Droupadi Murmu conferred the National Teachers' Awards 2026 on **82 educators at Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi on September 5, 2026**
- The awards are presented annually by the **Ministry of Education to recognise teachers who have significantly improved the quality of school education.**
- **Categories: 48 school teachers** (representing 27 States, 7 Union Territories, and 6 Central Government organizations).
- **21 teachers and faculty members from Higher Education Institutions and polytechnics.**
- **13 teachers from the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MoSDE)**
- Short documentaries on each awardee depicting the exemplary work done by them were showcased at the event.
- The National Awards to **Teachers carry a certificate of merit, a cash award of Rs. 50,000, and a silver medal.**

Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Awards 2024 Announced

- **The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports** announced the four recipients of the **Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Awards 2024.**
- The awards recognise **achievements in land adventure, water adventure, and lifetime contribution to adventure sports** in India.
- **Baljeet Kaur** received the Land Adventure award for becoming the first Indian to scale five 8,000-metre peaks in a single season.
- **Skalzang Rigzin** received the Land Adventure award for becoming the **first Indian to summit Mount Everest without supplemental oxygen or Sherpa support.**
- **Rimo Saha** received the Water Adventure award for **achievements in national and international para-swimming competitions.**
- **Shiv Prasad Chamoli** received the Lifetime Achievement honour for **contributions to winter sports and adventure sports promotion.**
- The Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Awards are **national-level honours for adventure sports in India.**
- The awards are named after Tenzing Norgay, the **mountaineer associated with the first successful ascent of Mount Everest in 1953 with Edmund Hillary.**
- Each awardee will receive a **bronze statuette, a certificate, a blazer with a silken tie or saree, and a cash prize of Rs 15 lakh.**

Shri Kiren Rijiju distributes shields and prizes to the winners of 27th National Youth Parliament Competition, 2025-26 for Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas

- The Prize Distribution Function of the **27th National Youth Parliament Competition, 2025-26, for Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas** will be held at the Parliament House Complex in New Delhi.

- PM Shri Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya, **Ukhrul-1, Manipur, representing the Shillong Region, emerged as the national winner** of the 27th National Youth Parliament Competition, 2025-26 for Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas.
- The seven regional winners that received trophies and prizes were **JNV Kollam, Kerala** (Hyderabad Region**); JNV Theog, Shimla** (Chandigarh Region); **JNV Suratgarh, Sriganganagar** (Jaipur Region**); JNV Bilaspur, Chhattisgarh** (Bhopal Region); **JNV Valsad, Gujarat** (Pune Region); **JNV Purulia, West Bengal** (Patna Region); **and JNV Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand** (Lucknow Region).
- The Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs has been organising Youth Parliament Competitions in Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas for the past 30 years.

State Awards

Shruti Mallpani receives Bharat Gaurav Award 2026

- **Shruti Mallpani, co-founder of Symposium, Hyderabad**, was presented with the **Bharat Gaurav Award 2026 in the Social Impact category** by Uttarakhand Governor Lt. Gen. Gurmit Singh (retired) at a ceremony in Dehradun.
- **IFS officers Sameer Sinha** (Uttarakhand), **Meenakshi Negi** (Karnataka), and **IPS officer Anjani Kumar** (Andhra Pradesh) were conferred the **Lifetime Achievement Award at the same event.**
- Since its launch, Symposium, a curated knowledge and leadership forum in Hyderabad, has organised a series of high-level programmes featuring policymakers, administrators, scientists, sportspersons and industry leaders.

Former CJI Justice Dipak Misra Conferred with Kalinga Ratna Award in Cuttack



- Former Chief Justice of India (CJI) Justice Dipak Misra has been conferred with **the Kalinga Ratna Award by Sarala Sahitya Sansad in Cuttack.**
- The award comprises **a silver idol of Goddess Saraswati and a citation.**
- Given to prominent personalities from Odisha who make notable contributions at the national or international level.
- The Sansad also, on the occasion, bestowed the Sarala Samman on **eminent litterateur Dr Ramachandra Behera** for his notable contributions to Odia literature for over six decades.

Karnatak Arts College's Dept. of Tourism wins State Tourism Award-2026

- The Department of Tourism Studies of Karnatak Arts College, Karnatak University, Dharwad, has received the Karnataka Tourism Award-2026 in the category of 'Best Educational Institution in Tourism' in the State.
- The award was presented at the World Tourism Day celebrations
- Established in 2007, the department has been contributing to the development of skilled human resources for the tourism and hospitality sectors through quality education and industry-oriented training.

Other Govt Awards

NCSC Chairman Shri Kishor Makwana to Receive "Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Jan Seva Puraskar 2026"

- The Chairman of the **National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) Shri Kishor Makwana**, will be conferred the "**Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Jan Seva Puraskar 2026**" in recognition of the Commission's dedicated service and significant contribution to social justice.

- The award will be presented during the **16th edition of the Sansad Ratna Awards 2026 in Delhi.** The award ceremony is being organised by the civil society.
- The honour reflects the Commission's continued commitment to safeguarding the rights of Scheduled Castes and advancing an equitable, dignified and inclusive society.

Rajbhasha Gaurav and Rajbhasha Kirti Awards for 2025–26

- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah addressed the inaugural session of Hindi Diwas 2026 and the **6th All India Official Language Conference in Mumbai.**
- During the event, the prestigious **Rajbhasha Gaurav and Rajbhasha Kirti Awards for 2025–26 were conferred** on institutions and individuals.

Winners of Awards (2025–26):

- **Rajbhasha Kirti Puraskar**: The highest national award presented to **central government ministries, departments, public sector undertakings**, and banks for **exceptional administrative compliance and official correspondence in Hindi**.
- **Top Recipient:** The Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance, was awarded the First Prize (in the category of ministries/departments with fewer than 300 personnel) under **the Rajbhasha Kirti category for 2025–26.**
- **First Prize (Ministries/Departments > 300 personnel):** The Ministry of Defence secured first place for its extensive official use of the language
- **Special Recognition**: The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)** was conferred the Rajbhasha Utkrishtata Sammaan.
- **Rajbhasha Gaurav Puraskar**: Conferred upon citizen authors, scholars, and central government employees for publishing original, high-quality non-fiction, scientific, and technical literature written in Hindi.

4th Eco Warrior Awards 2026

- Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Shri Bhupender Yadav presided over the 4th Eco Warrior Awards and Eco Warrior Conclave,
- organised by the Indian Forest Service Association (IFSA) and Indian Masterminds, in New Delhi.
- **Eco Warrior Awards**: The awards recognised forest officers and conservation professionals across multiple categories.
- The **Lifetime Achievement Award** given to Shri Brij Kishore Singh, a 1976-batch IFS officer of the Karnataka cadre, in recognition of his decades-long contribution to forest and wildlife conservation.
- The **Special Projects Award** recognised Project Elephant and the Great Indian Bustard conservation project in Rajasthan for their significant contributions to species and habitat conservation.

Miscellaneous

V. O. C. Port bags two awards at global ports and shipping awards

- V.O. Chidambaranar (VOC) Port Authority has earned two major awards **"Green Port of the Year" and "Smart Port & Digital Transformation Project of the Year,"** at the fourth edition of ET Infra Global Ports and Shipping Awards 2026.
- The awards were received by **Chairperson of VOC Port Authority Susanta Kumar Purohit.**

International

Entertainment & Music

Emmys 2026 winners list: 'Widow's Bay' dominates

- The 78th Primetime Emmy Awards 2026
- Bob Hope Humanitarian Award
- Michael J. Fox has been honoured with the Bob Hope Humanitarian Award at the 2026 Emmys for his decades of advocacy and fundraising for Parkinson's disease research through the Michael J. Fox Foundation.

CATEGORY	WINNER
Comedy Series	Widow's Bay
Lead Actor – Comedy	Matthew Rhys (Widow's Bay)
Lead Actress – Comedy	Jean Smart (Hacks)
Directing – Comedy	Widow's Bay: "Welcome to Widow's Bay!" – Hiro Murai
Writing – Comedy Series	Widow's Bay: "Welcome to Widow's Bay!" – Katie Dippold
Drama Series	The Pitt
Lead Actor – Drama	Noah Wyle (The Pitt)
Lead Actress – Drama	Rhea Seehorn (Pluribus)
Directing – Drama	Slow Horses: "Scars" – Saul Metzstein
Writing – Drama	Pluribus: "We Is Us" – Vince Gilligan
Limited Series	DTF St. Louis
Variety Series	The Late Show with Stephen Colbert

Anuparna Roy's 'Lovers in the Blue Night' receives NETPAC Award at the Venice Film Festival

- Lovers in the Blue Night was the solo Indian feature which premiered at the Venice Film Festival this year.
- It had its world premiere in the Orizzonti slate, marking director Anuparna Roy's second consecutive year at the festival after 2025's Songs of Forgotten Trees, for which she won Best Director.
- Now, Lovers in the Blue Night has won the NETPAC award for Best Asian Film at Venice.
- The NETPAC jury recognised the film for the sensitive portrayal of marginalised lives

Guinness World Record

This 8-year-old started coding to do math homework; now he holds a world record

- **Noah Williams** from Melbourne, Australia, holds the Guinness World Record as the **youngest computer programmer** after having his software program officially published.

- **Age at Record: He was 8 years and 307 days old** when the record was officially set on August 8, 2025. He is now 9 years old.
- **Language Learned: He taught himself C++, a complex programming language**
- **Mensa Member: At age 7, he joined Mensa after scoring in the top 99.9th percentile on an IQ test.**
- He has also started exploring physical technology like robotics and drones.

V.O.C. Port handles 335-metre-long container vessel to set new record

- V.O. Chidambaranar Port has set a **new record by handling 335.23-metre-long container vessel**, **CMA CGM Thorium from Brazil, with over 13,000 containers.**
- **This is the longest container ship ever to be handled and berthed at V.O.C. Port**, surpassing the previous record of 304 metres set by handling M.V. MSC Michaela in December 2025.
- The increase of more than 31 metres in the maximum vessel length handled by the Port within nine months marks significant expansion in the scale of container vessels that can now be accommodated in V.O.C. Port.

Zero-Human-Intervention Underwater Drones Set World Record

- A Chinese team set **a Guinness World Record on 29 August 2026 for the most autonomous underwater vehicles operating simultaneously.**
- The record **involved 116 autonomous underwater vehicles, or AUVs, named TH-618s,** which carried out autonomous underwater formation **navigation without human intervention for 34 minutes over 500 metres.**

Miscellaneous

Magsaysay honour for Singapore lawyer, Bangladeshi aid giver, Myanmar activist



- Singaporean lawyer and diplomat **Tommy Koh**, Myanmar activist **Bo Kyi** and Bangladeshi social worker **Runa Khan** have been named winners of this year's **Ramon Magsaysay Awards.**
- It is **Asia's premier prize and highest honor,** celebrates greatness of spirit and transformative leadership in Asia.
- It was **first given in 1958** and named after former **Philippine president Ramon Magsaysay.**
- It is presented in **formal ceremonies in Manila, Philippines on August 31st.**
- **Singaporean lawyer and diplomat Tommy Koh**, 88, was recognised for **promoting international dialogue and the rule of law.**
- He is best known for presiding over a U.N. conference of more than 150 countries, which **adopted the U.N. Convention on the Law of the Sea in 1982.**
- **Bo Kyi, the 61-year-old winner from Myanmar**, has spent seven years in prison for a life spent in resistance against widespread **human rights violations by Myanmar's military.**
- **Runa Khan, 67, of Bangladesh**, won the award for "her profound **empathy for the poorest of the poor in her country".**

Ramon Magsaysay Award

- Asia's most prestigious award, often called the **"Asian Nobel Prize"**.

- **Established: 1957**
- In **memory of Ramon Magsaysay**, the **7th President of the Philippines** (1953–57).
- **Administered by: Ramon Magsaysay Award Foundation (RMAF), Manila, Philippines**.

From 1958 to 2008, the Award was given in six categories annually:

- Government Service
- Community Leadership:
- Communication Arts:
- Peace and International Understanding:
- Emergent Leadership:
  - The category of **Emergent Leadership was inaugurated in 2000** and is supported by a grant from the Ford Foundation.
  - **Starting in 2009**, the Ramon Magsaysay Award is **no longer being given in fixed Award categories**, **except for Emergent Leadership**.

Indian Winners:

- **Vinoba Bhave (1958) – 1st Winner**

In recent years:

- **Ravish Kumar (2019) – Journalism**
- **Ravi Kannan R. (2023) – Healthcare**

Ig Nobel Prizes 2026 Awarded for Unusual Research

- The **36th annual Ig Nobel Prize ceremony** was held on 3 September 2026 at the **Zurich Convention Center in Switzerland.**
- The event was hosted outside the United States for the first time in its history.
- The Chemistry Prize went to Leonard “Leo” Chavas, Ramaswamy Subramanian, and Nathan Coussens for work on protein crystals in the **milk of the Pacific beetle cockroach.**
- The study found that the milk contains more than three times the energy of cow’s milk.
- The Ig Nobel Prize is a **satirical award series that recognises research with unusual or humorous themes.**
- The prizes are presented in **several fields, including Chemistry, Medicine, Biology, Physics, Economics, and Peace-related categories in different years.**
- The Medicine Prize was **awarded posthumously to Tokuji Unno of Asahikawa Medical University** for a 1977 aerodynamic study on **how people blow their noses**. Miki Takahara accepted the award on his behalf.
- The Biomechanics Prize went to Matilda Brindle and Stuart West of the University of Oxford, along with Catherine F. Talbot of the Florida Institute of Technology, **for defining kissing in a scientific manner across ants, birds, polar bears, and humans.**
- The **Soil Science Prize went** to researchers from the **University of Zurich and the Agroscope research institute** for the “Underwear as Evidence” project.
- The **Economics Prize** was awarded to Paul Piff, Daniel Stancato, Stéphane Côté, Rodolfo Mendoza-Denton, and Dacher Keltner for a study on **unethical behaviour among wealthier individuals.**
- The Biology Prize went to a team led by João Miguel Alves-Nunes for a **study on stepping on venomous snakes to examine bite triggers.**

Sanya Sharma won CREST Gold Award-winning project



- Sanya Sharma, a Class 12 student and competitive equestrian, won the **CREST Gold Award for developing an affordable, AI-powered wearable device designed to detect early signs of illness and stress in horses.**
- Sharma designed a multi-sensor wearable housing unit that **comfortably fits a horse without causing irritation or slipping during physical activity.**

Sethuraman Panchanathan Wins 2026 Arthur M. Bueche Award

- **Sethuraman Panchanathan**, the **Chennai-born computer scientist** and former **director of the US National Science Foundation**, has been named the 2026 recipient of the **National Academy of Engineering's Arthur M. Bueche Award.**
- He is the **first Indian American to receive the honour,**
- Panchanathan was born on June 24, 1961, and grew up in Chennai.
- **Panchanathan is a University Professor of Technology and Innovation of Arizona State University.**
- **In 2025, the Government of India awarded Panchanathan the Padma Shri for his contributions to science and engineering.**

The UNESCO International Literacy Prizes 2026

- UNESCO presented the 2026 International Literacy Prizes during the International Literacy Day global celebrations held in **Chiapas, Mexico**, under the theme **Literacy for people, the planet and prosperity.**

Winners of 2026:

UNESCO King Sejong Literacy Prize:

- **'Escuelas LEO'** Programme (**BibloRed, Colombia**): Provides intercultural, multilingual literacy pathways for marginalized communities in Bogotá—including Indigenous peoples, Deaf populations (sign language), migrants, and displaced groups.
- **'Language Friendly School' Programme** (Rutu Foundation, Netherlands): Operates across ~70 schools in 12 countries, integrating students' native/home languages alongside the official language of instruction to bridge educational inequalities.
- **'Project PAL'** – Primary Accelerated Literacy (WAER Waters Charity Foundation, Nigeria): Delivers foundational literacy to out-of-school children in conflict-affected regions of the Niger Delta using solar-powered Literacy Hubs, Teaching at the Right Level (TaRL), and indigenous-to-English transition models.

UNESCO Confucius Prize for Literacy:

- **'Accelerated Education for Out-of-School Displaced Youth' (Alsama Project, Lebanon**): Compresses **12 years of formal education into six years for refugee and displaced youth**, deploying an intensive curriculum combining literacy, numeracy, and life skills.
- **'Chiapas Puede' State Literacy Programme (State Government of Chiapas, Mexico):** Deploys the phonics-based Matías de Córdova model across 121 municipalities, blending community study circles and digital tools to deliver bilingual instruction in Spanish and indigenous tongues.
- **'Language for Life' Programme (Hat Yai City Municipality, Thailand)**: Integrates multilingual literacy (Thai, Malay, English, Chinese) with real-life functional community resilience, specifically training citizens in disaster communication and climate awareness.

- The premier global awards honoring excellence, innovation, and measurable impact in advancing foundational and functional literacy worldwide. **Each laureate receives a cash endowment of US$ 30,000, along with a medal and a diploma.**
- **Instituted in 1967 following the proclamation of International Literacy Day in 1966.**

Currently awarded across two distinct sponsored categories:

- **UNESCO King Sejong Literacy Prize**: Established in **1989** with support from the Government of the Republic of Korea, named after **King Sejong the Great (creator of the Korean Hangul script).**
- **UNESCO Confucius Prize for Literacy**: Established in **2005** with support from the Government of the People's Republic of China, named after the **ancient Chinese Confucius.**

Miss World 2026 is Dominican Republic's Joheirry Mola



- Dominican Republic's **Joheirry Mola** has been crowned the **new Miss World.**
- **First runner up was Spain's Elisabeth R Alabern** and second runner-up was Taanusiya Chetty from Malaysia.
- **India's contestant Nikita Porwal didn't make it to Top 20.**
- Miss World 2025 winner Suchata Chuangsri of Thailand crowned her successor at the end of the event.

Cool Leaders Award

- Recently, **inaugural Cool Leaders Award** was announced at the **Global Cooling Pledge Assembly 2026 held in Singapore.**
- **It is a global recognition initiative launched by the UNEP Cool Coalition.**
- It recognizes **outstanding leadership in advancing sustainable cooling and protecting people from extreme heat.**
- The first Cool Leaders are
- **Singapore: For leadership in passive cooling and heat resilience.**
- **United Arab Emirates:** For leadership in **district cooling and advancing cooling in global climate and development policy.**
- **Dong Mingzhu**: **Chairwoman of Gree Electric Appliances,** for spearheading the development of **ultra-efficient, low-carbon cooling technologies, including the Zero Carbon Source air-conditioning system.**

What is the UNEP Cool Coalition?

- It is a **global platform driving system-level change on sustainable cooling.**
- **It was launched in 2019** as a flagship initiative of the UN Secretary-General's Climate Action Summit.
- It **brings together over 250 actors—including governments, businesses, cities, and financial institutions**—to deliver efficient, climate-friendly cooling solutions aligned with the Paris Agreement, the Kigali Amendment, and the 2030 Agenda.

Mizoram Farmer ZT Lalrithangi to Receive FAO Award

- A 35-year-old teacher-turned-farmer from a remote village in Mizoram's Lawngtlai district will **receive a United Nations award in Rome for her contribution to agriculture and rural development**, after **turning strawberry cultivation into a profitable livelihood.**

- Z T Lalrithangi, **popularly known as Pi Mari-i**, from Sangau in **south Mizoram's Lawngtlai district**, has been selected among the **"FAO 100 Women Heroes in Agrifood Systems and Rural Development"** by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the UN as part of the International Year of Women Farmers 2026.
- **She is the first Mizo to receive the recognition**.
- She will receive the **award during the World Food Forum at FAO headquarters in Rome** from October 12 to 16.
- Lalrithangi began **experimenting with strawberry cultivation in 2024** after learning about successful growers in neighbouring Siaha district.
- She was earlier adjudged the best farmer from Lawngtlai district at the Mizoram Horti Fair 2026.

Booker Prize 2026 Shortlist Announced

- The Booker Prize 2026 shortlist was announced, list includes six novels by authors from different literary backgrounds, and the winner will be announced at a ceremony on 9 November 2026.
- The Booker Prize is a major literary **award for a novel written in English and published in the United Kingdom or Ireland.**
- The prize was **first awarded in 1969 and is administered by the Booker Prize Foundation.**
- **Winner 2025: David Szalay for Flesh (first Hungarian-British author to win).**
- **A trophy named Iris, so-called after the 1978 winner Iris Murdoch.**

Awards:

- **Winner: £50,000 | Shortlisted authors: £2,500 each**

Eligibility:

- Must be an original English novel (not a translation).
- Published in UK or Ireland by a registered imprint (no self-published works).
- **Author of any nationality eligible.**
- The six shortlisted books are:



- The End of Everything by M. John Harrison,
- The Disappearers by Marlon James,
- Black Bag by Luke Kennard,
- May We Feed the King by Rebecca Perry,
- The Things We Never Say by Elizabeth Strout,
- John of John by Douglas Stuart.
- Marlon James won the Booker Prize in 2015 for A Brief History of Seven Killings.
- Douglas Stuart won the Booker Prize in 2020 for Shuggie Bain.
- **Marlon James and Douglas Stuart have a chance to become only the fifth authors to win the Booker Prize twice after both were named**

Dr Achyuta Samanta Conferred Honorary Citizenship by Romanian Town, Receives Multiple International Honours

- **Eminent educationist, social reformer** and Founder of KIIT, KISS and KIMS, **Dr. Achyuta Samanta was conferred Honorary Citizenship of Milișăuți, Romania.**
- in recognition of his lifelong contributions to education, social development and humanitarian service.

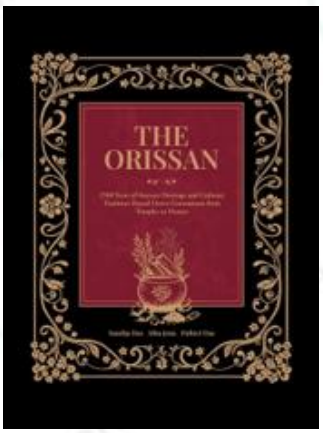
- Dr. Achyuta Samanta **received FIDE's 'Education Philanthropic Award' at the Summit on Chess in Education in Uzbekistan** on 24th September 2026, during the 46th FIDE Chess Olympiad and Congress.
- He was **recognised for his lifelong contributions to sports and education**. On the occasion, FIDE, KIIT and KISS signed an MoU to expand their Chess in Education initiatives.

Books

Book	Author
The Orissan	Alka Jena
The Actor imagines	Tavleen Singh
Who Owns What?	Xerxes Ranina
More Days at the Torunka Cafe	Satoshi Yagisawa
Beyond Our Births	Antara Mukherjee
And I Am the Arrow	Pia Ghosh-Roy
Saffron Shadows: The RSS, A Century of Influence	Compiled and edited by Leher Sethi
Seven Shades of Love	Debashis Chatterjee Published by Penguin Random House India
Vishwasanchar Hindutva Ka	Published by Saptahik Vivek
Science magazines in Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Bengali and Assamese builds upon the Institute's long-standing flagship magazines Science Reporter (English), Vigyan Pragati(Hindi) and Science ki Duniya (Urdu).	Published by the CSIR-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR).

Historical Books

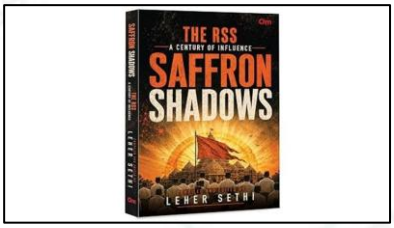
The Orissan tells the story of Odisha through history, culture, and food



- **Author : Alka Jena**
- **Book - The Orissan**
- (published by **Penguin Random House India**)
- describes as a "conversation between two generations"
- The 350-page book offers chapters dedicated to **Odisha's history, culture, temple foods, and recipes of starters, beverages, rice preparations**, curries, festive puddings, and sweets.

Political

Anthology of essays for and against RSS ideology launched



- The book - **"Saffron Shadows: The RSS, A Century of Influence"**
- **Compiled and edited by Leher Sethi**
- The book is an anthology of essays by Sangh ideologues as well as RSS

Government Launch

CSIR-NIScPR Launches Five Popular Science Magazines

- Minister of State for Science and Technology Dr Jitendra Singh **launched five new popular science magazines in Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Bengali and Assamese** on the occasion of the 85th Foundation Day of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR).
- **The magazines were published by the CSIR-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR).**
- The magazines-



- বিজ্ঞান লহৰ (**Bigyan Lahar) in Assamese,**
- বিজ্ঞান বৃত্তান্ত (**Bigyan Brittanto**) in **Bengali,**
- विज्ञान क्षितिज (**Vidnyan Kshitij) in Marathi,**
- அறிவியல் அறிக்கையாளர் **(Ariviyal Arikkaiyalar) in Tamil,**
- and విజ్ఞాన్ వెలుగు (**Vigyan Velugu) in Telugu- mark.**
- The launch builds upon the Institute's long-standing tradition of science communication through its flagship magazines **Science Reporter (English), Vigyan Pragati(Hindi) and Science ki Duniya (Urdu).**

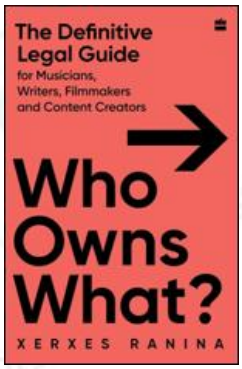
Miscellaneous

Journalist Tavleen Singh imagines India's future



- **Book : The Actor**
- By - Journalist and columnist Tavleen Singh

Xerxes Ranina book Who Owns What?



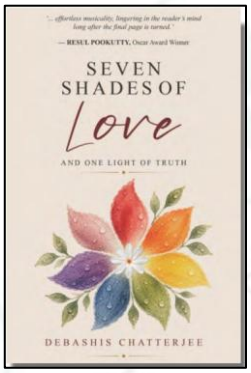
- new book, **Who Owns What?,**
- author **Xerxes Ranina,**
- **published by HarperCollins** India,
- The book talks about the common questions that creators have in their minds — "what happens if I write a script, or if somebody uses my music, these sort of questions people have all the time; I just try to answer them in a simple form using examples, case studies and illustrations

New books: Two compelling debuts and one cup of reheated comfort



- **Satoshi Yagisawa's More Days at the Torunka Cafe** , Translated by Eric Ozaw
- **Antara Mukherjee's Beyond Our Births** - Girl's search for identity to hold up a mirror to Bengal's fraught politics of belonging
- **Pia Ghosh-Roy's And I Am the Arrow** - a family haunting into a study of the wounds we pass down.

Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan releases the book 'Vishwasanchar Hindutva Ka'



- Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book Vishwasanchar Hindutva Ka, published by **Saptahik Vivek, at Uprashtrapathi Bhawan.**

Shashi Tharoor releases IIM-K Director's first book of poetry

- Shashi Tharoor, Thiruvananthapuram MP, released **Seven Shades of Love**, the first book of poetry **by Debashis Chatterjee, Director, Indian Institute of Management-Kozhikode (IIM-K).**
- Published by Penguin Random House India

Obituaries

Art & Culture

Carnatic musician S.R. Janakiraman passes away at 98



- Noted Carnatic musician**, teacher, and musicologist S.R. Janakiraman**, died in Chennai. He was 98.
- He was **presented the Padma Shri and the Kalaimamani award, besides being honoured with the Sangeeta Kalacharya and several other awards.**
- He translated Sangita Sampradaya Pradarsini, an important text on south Indian music, into English.

Pandit Indudhar Nirody passes away

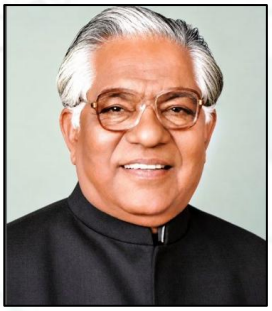
- Pandit Indudhar Nirody, 91, an eminent musician and revered **guru of Hindustani classical music**, passed away in Panvel in Maharashtra.
- **Kendra Sangeet Natak Akademi awardee Pandit Indudhar Nirody was a senior vocalist of the Agra Gharana.**
- He was honoured with the **Kendra Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 2014** and received an honorary doctorate from **Dr. Gangubai Hangal Music and Performing Arts University in 2015.**

Soorya Krishnamoorthy, Former ISRO Scientist and Founder of Soorya Festival, Dies at 78

- Soorya Krishnamoorthy**, a theatre director, cultural organiser and former Indian Space Research Organisation scientist**, died.
- He was associated with the Soorya Stage and Film Society and founded the Soorya Festival in 1977.
- He also served in Kerala's cultural institutions and received national and state honours for stage craft and direction.
- Krishnamoorthy worked with the Indian Space Research Organisation for more than two decades before focusing on the arts.
- **He worked as a scientist-engineer and was associated with APJ Abdul Kalam during his scientific career.**
- **He received the National Award for Stage Craft and Direction in 1996.**
- **He was also awarded the Kerala Prabha Award in 2023, which is among Kerala's highest civilian honours.**

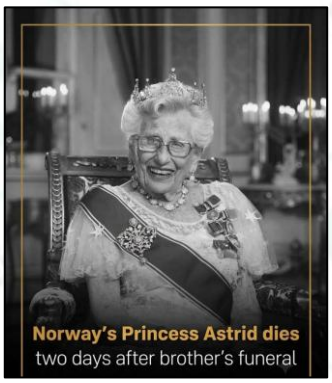
Political Members

Former Punjab Minister & BJP leader Bhagat Chunni Lal passes away



- Former Punjab Minister and BJP leader Bhagat Chunni Lal has passed away in Jalandhar. He was 94.
- Sh. Bhagat was a **former Cabinet Minister in the erstwhile SAD-BJP government in 2012.**
- He was elected as MLA from Jalandhar West thrice and also served as Deputy Speaker of the Punjab Vidhan Sabha.

Princess Astrid of Norway Dies at 94



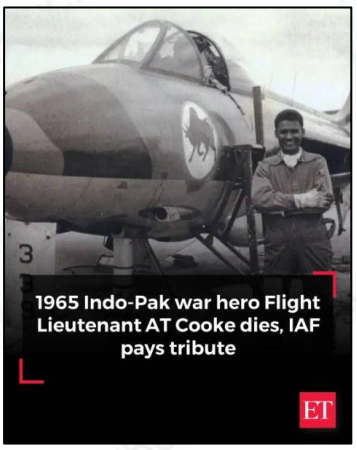
- Princess Astrid of Norway died at the age of 94. The Norwegian Royal House announced that she passed away peacefully.
- She was the last surviving child of King Olav V and Crown Princess Märtha, and she was born on 12 February 1932.
- She became Norway's first lady at the age of 22 in 1954

Sheikh Ahmed bin Rashid Al Maktoum passes away

- **Sheikh Ahmed bin Rashid Al Maktoum,** younger brother of Ruler of Dubai and UAE Vice-President and Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, **passed away at the age of 76.**
- **Following his passing, the Dubai Ruler's Court declared an official 10-day mourning period**
- He **graduated from the Royal Military Academy Sandhurst in Britain in 1975** and subsequently served in Dubai's Central Military Region, later becoming its Commander-in-Chief

Army & Police

1965 war hero and Vir Chakra awardee Alfred Tyrone Cooke dies



- **Flight Lieutenant Alfred Tyrone Cooke, a Vir Chakra awardee of the Indian Air Force, died**
- He was known for an air engagement during the 1965 Indo-Pak War over **Kalaikunda in West Bengal, where he flew a Hawker Hunter against Pakistani Sabre jets.**
- **He was awarded the Vir Chakra, India's third-highest wartime gallantry award,** for his role in the air battle over Kalaikunda in West Bengal during an air attack launched from East Pakistan, now Bangladesh, on September 7, 1965.

National

Central Government Schemes

Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

PM Vishwakarma Scheme Completes Three Years with 30 Lakh Registrations

- The PM Vishwakarma scheme was launched on **17 September 2023 for artisans and craftspeople engaged in 18 traditional trades.**
- The scheme has a financial outlay of ₹13,000 crore for FY2023-24 to FY2027-28 and provides support through skill training, toolkits, credit, and market linkage measures.
- **PM Vishwakarma is a Central Sector Scheme for traditional artisans and craftspeople.**
- It covers 18 trades, including carpentry, boat making, blacksmithing, hammer and tool kit making, locksmithing, goldsmithing, pottery, sculpting, stone carving, and basket making.

Eligible Applicants

- PM Vishwakarma is open to **artisans and craftspeople aged 18 years or above who work with their hands and tools** in one of the 18 notified family-based traditional trades.
- **They should be working in the unorganised sector on a self-employment basis.**
- Applicants **should not have availed loans under similar credit-based government schemes** for self-employment or business development during the previous five years.
- Registration and benefits are restricted to one member of a family, comprising the husband, wife and unmarried children.
- A person in **government service and their family members is not eligible.**
- Beneficiaries **of MUDRA and PM SVANidhi who have fully repaid their loans are eligible under PM Vishwakarma**

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Government Notifies Semicon 2.0 Scheme

- The Government of India notified the **Semicon 2.0 scheme as the next phase of the Semicon India Programme.**
- The scheme carries a **fiscal outlay of ₹1,27,500** crore and sets **guidelines for semiconductor manufacturing, design, packaging, and talent development** in India.
- The scheme is structured around **six pillars**. These are design, machines and materials, fabrication units, ATMP and OSAT facilities, research and development, and talent development.
- ATMP stands for **assembly, testing, marking, and packaging**. OSAT stands for **outsourced semiconductor assembly and test**.
- Under the notified guidelines, **silicon wafer fabs with a minimum investment of ₹20,000 crore are eligible for 40% fiscal support**.
- **Compound, display, and other specialised fabs are eligible for 35% fiscal support.**
- The **scheme allows startups and Indian- or OCI-owned companies to apply for chip design incentives.**

Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

7th National Formulary of India 2026 Launched

- Union Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare and Chemicals and Fertilizers **Anupriya Patel launched the 7th Edition of the National Formulary of India (NFI).**
- The minister launched the NFI 2026, the **Guidance Document for Hospitals in India for Safety Monitoring and Reporting of Medical Device-Related Adverse Events, and the ADR-PvPI 2.0 Mobile App for iOS users**
- at the **6th National Pharmacovigilance Week programme organised by the Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC)** at Dr Ambedkar International Centre in New Delhi.
- The event was held as part of the 6th National Pharmacovigilance Week, being observed from September 17 to 23, 2026, with the **theme, "Promoting Rational Use of Medicines through Pharmacovigilance: A Step Towards Safer Healthcare."**
- **The National Formulary of India has been published periodically by the IPC since 2009 as a guidance document for healthcare professionals to promote the rational and safe use of medicines.**
- The NFI 2026 contains 34 chapters, 20 appendices and 653 drugs, including 42 fixed-dose combinations and 30 immunologicals.

Ministry of Law

Union Law and Justice Ministry to organise workshop under DISHA 2.0 Scheme

- **The Department of Justice under the Ministry of Law** and Justice will organise a **regional workshop under the DISHA 2.0 Scheme.**
- The workshop is linked to technology-enabled legal services, legal awareness, and pro bono legal assistance for remote and underserved areas.
- DISHA stands for **Designing Innovative Solutions for Holistic Access to Justice.**
- The scheme is implemented by the Department of Justice and covers four major components: **Tele-Law, Nyaya Bandhu, the Legal Literacy and Legal Awareness Programme (LLLAP), and VIDHI-Sanjeevani.**
- Best reels created under the "**Nyaya Prabodh: Awakening to Justice – Know Your Rights in 90 Seconds" campaign will be showcased on this occasion.**
- A Slogan Competition under Nyaya Prabodh will also be launched during the programme

Union Health Minister Shri J.P. Nadda Inaugurated Arogya Manthan 2026 at Vigyan Bhawan

- Union Health and Family Welfare and Chemicals and Fertilizers Minister J P Nadda inaugurated Arogya Manthan 2026 at Vigyan Bhawan, **marking eight years of the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)** and **five years** of the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM).**
- **Organised by the National Health Authority (NHA),** the event will feature thematic **discussions on health assurance and digital health, including the role of the National Health Claims Exchange (NHCX)** in streamlining and standardising health insurance processes.
- **About AB PM-JAY and ABDM**
- **Launched in 2018,** AB PM-JAY provides health cover of up to **Rs 5 lakh per family annually for secondary and tertiary hospitalisation.**
- **In October 2024, the scheme was expanded to cover all senior citizens aged 70 years and above**, irrespective of their socio-economic status.

Summits and Conferences

AIIA Celebrates 11th Ayurveda Day–2026 with Public Awareness Rally, Seminar and Book Launches

- **The All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA), an autonomous organisation** under the Ministry of Ayush, celebrated the 11th Ayurveda Day at its campus with a **series of academic, awareness and outreach activities.**
- **Two major programmes** were organised as part of the celebrations.
- To mark the occasion, an **"Ayurveda Public Awareness Rally" was organised in the morning** with the objective of promoting Ayurveda**, propagating its principles, and creating greater public awareness** about the role of Ayurveda in healthy living and holistic healthcare.
- **AIIA launched "AyurVarta," a special talk show dedicated to Ayurveda.**
- The Institute organised **AYURPRABHA-2026, a six-day workshop on Ayurveda Dermatology and Cosmetology, and conducted a special eye-screening camp for students** of an NTPC school, among several other initiatives.
- **Two books, "Tarangini Sara Sangraha**" and **"Integrative Healthcare for Better Outcomes**," were also launched on the occasion.

Amit Shah to Inaugurate 3rd ANTF Conference

- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah will inaugurate the **3rd National Conference of Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) Heads of States/UTs in New Delhi**, and lay the foundation stones for **new Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) Zone complexes in Lucknow and Dehradun.**
- HM Shah will also **release television commercials (TVCs) aimed at spreading awareness against drugs during the event.**
- Based on the theme **"United Resolve, Shared Responsibility".**

Projects and Campaign

BJP to Launch Month-Long 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' to Mark PM Modi's 25 Years in Public Life

- The BJP will launch a **month-long Seva Sankalp Abhiyan** from the 17th of September on the occasion of the **birthday of Prime Minister Narendra Modi** to mark the completion of his 25 years in public life.
- **The Seva Sankalp Abhiyan will begin with organising a blood donation camp.**
- the **Seva Jyoti Kalash Yatra** will also be taken out on the 7th of October, **connecting villages and urban areas to express gratitude to the Prime Minister.**
- the **Seva Mera Yogdan programme** will be held from the 17th of this month to the 17th of October

'Swachhata Hi Seva 2026' campaign commences

- The 2026 edition of Swachhata Hi Seva, an annual campaign which encourages citizens across the country to step out and take ownership of their surroundings, commenced on 17th September .
- **The campaign will continue until 2nd October 2026**
- The observance highlighted that sustained individual action and community participation are central to building clean workplaces, neighbourhoods, villages, towns and a cleaner nation.

Department of Fertilizers to Observe 'Swachhata Pakhwada-2026' from September 1 to 15, 2026

- The Department of Fertilizers, under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers, is observing '**Swachhata Pakhwada-2026' from 1st to 15th September, 2026.**
- The primary objective of this nationwide **campaign is to foster cleanliness at both physical and digital workplaces, promote environmental conservation,** and bring qualitative improvements to work culture.

- This year, alongside **physical cleanliness, special priority is being accorded to 'Digital Cleanliness and Record Management'** to enhance administrative efficiency, transparency, and further strengthen the e-filing system.

Vice President Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan to Inaugurate 9th India International Water Week 2026 on 22 September in New Delhi

- **The Ministry of Jal Shakti**, Government of India, in collaboration with key Central Ministries, State Governments, international organisations, research and academic institutions, industry bodies, development partners, civil society and private sector partners, is organising the **9th India International Water Week (IIWW) 2026 from 22–26 September 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi,**
- **on the theme "Climate Resilient Water Management."**

Annpurna Devi to Launch 9th Rashtriya Poshan Maah

- **The Ministry of Women and Child Development**, Government of India, will launch the **9th Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2026 on 9th September 2026** at the Rudraksh International Cooperation and Convention Centre, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh.
- to be launched by Union Minister of Women and Child Development Annapurna Devi,
- **the theme "Hamari Anganwadi Hamari Jimmedari",**

Mission, Portals and Initiatives

5th Edition of Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 2026 Launched

- Dr Jitendra Singh, Hon'ble Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Earth Sciences, has officially launched the 5th edition of '**Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 2026: v.5.0'.**
- Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 5.0" **from September 12 to 19, 2026.**
- Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar is a nationwide **coastal cleanliness initiative linked with ocean conservation and shoreline protection**.

e-FAST India Initiative

- Recently, NITI Aayog launched the Platform for Aggregating Clean Transport (PACT) at the 5th e-FAST India Summit 2026.
- The e-FAST India **(Electric Freight Accelerator for Sustainable Transport – India)** is a NITI Aayog government–industry platform focused on **moving medium- and heavy-duty freight towards zero-emission vehicles.**
- It brings together government and industry stakeholders
- It includes OEMs, logistics service providers, financiers, shippers and charge point operators – to **accelerate the transition to zero-emission freight in India, particularly in the medium- and heavy-duty vehicle segments**.

What is the Platform for Aggregating Clean Transport (PACT)?

- It is a flagship initiative under the e-FAST India platform.
- It is designed to **aggregate freight demand from shippers, Logistics Service Providers (LSPs) and other ecosystem stakeholders and translate it into deployment opportunities** across identified freight corridors.

- It brings together shippers, LSPs, vehicle manufacturers, financiers, charge point operators (CPOs) to improve demand visibility, support charging infrastructure planning and strengthen the commercial case for electric medium- and heavy-duty vehicles (e-MHDVs).

Livestock Insurance Portal Launched in New Delhi

- Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, Rajiv Ranjan Singh, launched the Livestock Insurance Portal in New Delhi.
- **It will provide a single, integrated digital platform for livestock insurance.**
- It is aimed at **making livestock insurance services more transparent, efficient, accessible and technology-driven.**

CSIR Launches Science & Innovation Quiz on MY Bharat Portal

- The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) has launched the CSIR Science & Innovation Quiz **(CSIR SciQuiz) on the MY Bharat (Mera Yuva Bharat) Portal** in association with the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
- **Launched at the backdrop of 85th Foundation Day of the CSIR, the quiz is being conducted from 20-26 September 2026 which is open to all Indian citizens.**
- The quiz is designed to **target youth which will promote scientific awareness, curiosity and public engagement with science.**
- It will feature MCQs and feature questions related to CSIR's scientific achievements, technologies, innovations, institutions and contributions to society and the nation.

DDWS organises Eleventh Edition of Sujal Gram Samvad

- The Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti, organised the **11th edition of the multilingual 'Sujal Gram Samvad' .**
- A platform for **direct interaction with Gram Panchayat representatives and local communities on operation and maintenance of rural drinking water systems.**

PRAGATI-50 Initiative Launched for 50 Model Cities

- Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal launched a new set of initiatives under PRAGATI 50 to develop a Model City Framework for 50 cities of economic, cultural, heritage, pilgrimage, tourism and administrative significance.
- The initiative aims to drive visible improvements in urban cleanliness, solid waste management, used water management, sanitation, and citizen participation through a structured framework of monitoring and review within a defined timeframe.
- In collaboration with the Central Mechanical Engineering Research Institute and the Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry, the Swachh Bharat Test Bed and Innovation Centre at Durgapur were also launched.
- As part of Swachhata Hi Seva 2026, also inaugurated a Reduce Reuse and Recycle (RRR) Centre at Sankalp Bhawan, New Delhi.
- The initiative will promote sustainable consumption, reuse, resource recovery and circularity in government workplaces.

Supreme Court

Totaliser

- A three-judge Supreme Court Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant directed the Central government to clearly state its position on introducing totaliser machines for counting Electronic Voting Machine (EVM) votes.
- A totaliser is a **specialized hardware interface designed to aggregate and count votes recorded across a cluster of approximately 14 EVMs simultaneously**.
- It was **jointly engineered by public sector undertakings Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL), Bengaluru, and Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL),** Hyderabad.

How It Works and Preserves Voter Secrecy?

- The control units of up to 14 EVMs from different polling stations are connected via cables to the totaliser interface.
- When the result button on the totaliser is pressed, it displays the combined votes obtained by each candidate across the entire group of 14 booths as a single consolidated figure.
- **Masking Booth Trends: By pooling the results, it eliminates individual, booth-by-booth vote tallies.**
- Because polling booths in India are organized geographically, individual booth counts make it easy to identify how specific neighborhoods, villages, or demographic clusters voted.
- **Totalisers effectively obscure these micro-level voting patterns.**

Policies, Guidelines, Committees & Agreements

MEA Amends Passport Rules for Children Below 15 Years

- The Ministry of External Affairs has notified the **Passports (Amendment) Rules, 2026, which amend the Passports Rules, 1980.**
- The rules were published in the Gazette of India on 17 September 2026 and came into force on the same day.
- The amendment changes the **validity period and fee structure for passport services for children below 15 years.**
- Under amended **Rule 12(1A), an ordinary 36-page passport issued to a child below 15 years is valid for five years** from the date of issue **or until the child turns 18, whichever occurs earlier.**
- The earlier rule framework under the Passports Rules, 1980, has been modified through the 2026 amendment.
- **Rule 8 has been revised to state that passport application fees will be as specified in Schedule IV of the rules.**
- **The Ministry of External Affairs had already increased charges for fresh applications, renewals, and Tatkaal services with effect from 1 July 2026**.
- For minors, **a 36-page fresh or reissue passport under the normal category now costs ₹1,750, compared with ₹1,000 earlier.**
- **A 10% discount on fresh passport applications continues for children below eight years of age**. This discount does not apply to reissue applications.

Centre reconstitutes CBFC; Preity Zinta, Pankaj Tripathi among 18 members



- The Information and Broadcasting Ministry reconstituted the **Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)**
- The new board includes well-known film personalities such as actors **Preity Zinta, Suniel Shetty, Pankaj Tripathi, and Prasenjit Chatterjee, among others.**
- The list also includes actor **Roopali Ganguly and actor-producer Pallavi Joshi.**
- The 18-member board has been **reconstituted under the powers granted by the Cinematograph Act of 1952.** It will **serve for three years** or until further notice.
- The previous **CBFC Board was last reconstituted on August 1, 2017.**
- Under the Cinematograph (Certification) Rules 2024, the CBFC board must meet once every quarter.
- **Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)**
- The Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) is a **statutory body under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, Government of India.**
- Commonly known as the **Censor Board, though it functions mainly as a certification authority.**

It works under:

- Cinematograph Act, 1952
- Cinematograph (Certification) Rules, 1983
- Guidelines issued by the Central Government

Role and Structure of CBFC

- It regulates the public exhibition of films in India. **No film can be released publicly without CBFC certification.**
- Headed by a Chairperson, with 12–25 members appointed by the Central Government.
- It operates through **nine regional offices: Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bangalore, Thiruvananthapuram, Hyderabad, New Delhi, Cuttack, and Guwahati.**
- Supported by Advisory Panels (nominated by the Government for two-year terms) to assist in film examination.

Categories of Certification

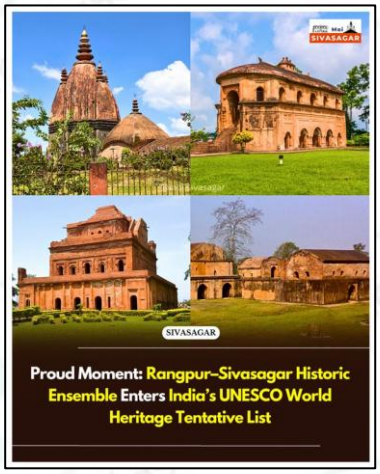
- **U (Universal):** Suitable for all age groups.
- **U/A:** Universal with parental guidance (below 12).
- **A:** Adults only.
- **S:** Restricted to special classes (e.g., doctors, farmers).
- **New Sub-Categories (2023 Amendment): UA 7+, UA 13+, UA 16+ – aligning with global best practices.**

Miscellaneous

Ahom Dynasty Capital Ensemble Enters UNESCO Tentative List

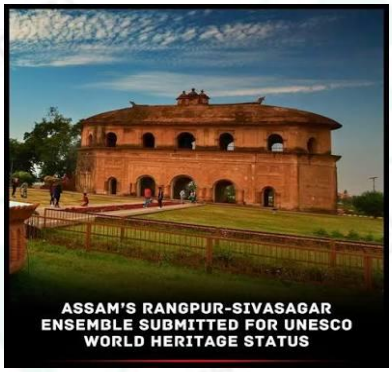
- The **Rangpur-Sivasagar Historical Ensemble in Assam has been added to UNESCO's World Heritage Tentative List**.
- India's Permanent Mission to UNESCO submitted the nomination dossier on 19 June 2026 under UNESCO cultural criteria (iii) and (iv).

- **UNESCO's Tentative List is the inventory of properties that a State Party may nominate for the World Heritage List in the future.** UNESCO cultural criteria (iii) relates to a property bearing unique testimony to a cultural tradition or civilisation.
- UNESCO cultural criteria (iv) relates to a property being an outstanding example of a type of building, architectural or technological ensemble, or landscape.

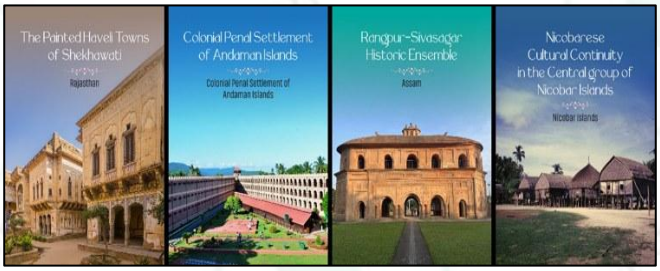


The Rangpur-Sivasagar Historical Ensemble

- The Ahom dynasty was founded **by Swargadeo Chaolung Sukapha in 1228**, with its rule coming to an end in 1826.
- Located roughly 360 km northeast of Guwahati, this ensemble captures nearly 600 years of Ahom rule over the Upper Brahmaputra Valley.
- It spans two core areas: Rangpur, once called Che Muan or the "city of amusement," founded by Ahom king Swargadeo Rudra Singha in 1704, and Sivasagar itself.
- What makes the site remarkable isn't a single monument but an entire living landscape: wetlands, rivers, palatial complexes, fortified structures, ceremonial grounds, massive water tanks, temples, and old road networks woven together.



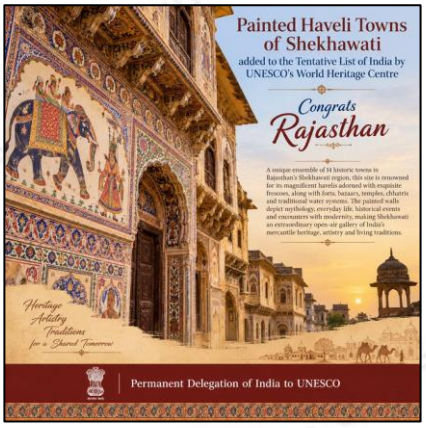
- **Three temple clusters stand out—the Joysagar, Gaurisagar, and Sivasagar groups**, each built along the banks of large tanks.
- Add to this iconic structures like Talatal Ghar, Rang Ghar, Fakuwa Doul, Pohugarh, and the Namdang Stone Bridge, and you get a sense of the scale of Ahom engineering and architecture.
- Along with the Rangpur-Sivasagar Ensemble, three other Indian sites joined the list on the same day:



- **The Colonial Penal Settlement of the Andaman Islands**
- The Colonial Penal Settlement of Andaman Islands brings together four historically connected sites: **Cellular Jail, Viper Island, Chatham Island and Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Island, formerly Ross Island.**
- The proposed serial property reflects the evolution of Britain's colonial penal system after the 1857 uprising, including forced labour, incarceration and administrative control.
- **Nicobarese Cultural Continuity in the Central Group of Nicobar Islands.**

The Painted Haveli Towns of Shekhawati – Rajasthan

- Rajasthan's Painted Haveli Towns of Shekhawati represents a serial nomination covering historic ensembles **across 14 towns in the Jhunjhunu, Churu and Sikar districts.**
- Built largely through merchant patronage between the 18th and early 20th centuries, these towns are renowned for their richly painted havelis.
- This takes **India's total tally on the Tentative List to 73 properties, split across Cultural (53), Natural (17), and Mixed (3) categories.**



Vice-President of India addressed the 25th Anniversary celebrations of ICWA

- Recently, the Vice-President of India addressed the 25th Anniversary celebrations of **Indian Council of World Affairs (ICWA) at Sapru House, New Delhi.**
- **Origin: It was established in 1943 by a group of Indian intellectuals as a think tank.**
- It was established by a **group of eminent intellectuals led by Sir T.B. Sapru and Dr. H.N. Kunzru** to create an Indian perspective on international relations and foreign policy issues.
- **It was registered as a non-official, non-political and non-profit organisation** under the Registration of Societies Act 1860.
- **By an Act of Parliament in 2001,** the Indian Council of World Affairs has been **declared an institution of national importance.**
- The **Vice President of India is the ex-officio President of ICWA.**
- It is funded by the Ministry of External Affairs and enjoys full autonomy.
- Functions: It is devoted exclusively for the study of international relations and foreign affairs

Cell Broadcast System

- Recently, the Cell Broadcast System (CBS) has been resumed in India, by the Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DoT).
- It is a **telecom-enabled public warning system that enables authorities to broadcast simultaneous, geo-targeted alerts to mobile devices within a defined area.**
- It is indigenous technology developed by the Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) under the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), in **collaboration with the National Disaster Management Authority and the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)..**
- It uses common messaging protocols that have been incorporated by all the major handset makers around the world.
- Unlike SMS alerts**, CB messages are broadcast to all mobile phones in a specific area, ensuring rapid delivery even in congested networks.**
- Messages are **delivered in near real-time, reaching users within seconds** without any queuing delays.
- It offers precise geo-targeting capabilities, enabling alerts to be disseminated at the level of individual cell towers or clusters.

AIIA Launches AyurVarta Digital Dialogue Series

- The All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA), New Delhi, an autonomous institute **under the Ministry of Ayush, has launched 'AyurVarta',**
- a **special digital dialogue series aimed** at taking **authentic knowledge, scientific perspectives and contemporary relevance of Ayurveda** to wider audiences in India and abroad.
- The initiative has been **launched ahead of Ayurveda Day, which will be observed on 23 September.**
- The series will feature conversations with **leading experts on Ayurveda, contemporary healthcare challenges, scientific research, education, clinical practice** and the growing global relevance of Ayurveda.
- The inaugural episode of 'AyurVarta' featured a discussion between Professor (Vaidya) P. K. Prajapati, Director, AIIA, and Professor (Dr.) Mahesh Vyas, Dean, Ph.D., AIIA, on the theme "**Why is Ayurveda Day celebrated on 23 September?"**

Akashvani's FM Gold commemorates its Silver Jubilee

- **Akashvani's FM Gold** is celebrating its 25th anniversary, **marking 25 years since its launch on September 1, 2001**.
- Originally known as AIR FM-II, the service was introduced as an **infotainment channel combining news, current affairs and entertainment.**
- Some of its programmes include popular shows such as **Surkhiyon Mein, Spotlight, Market Mantra, Sports Scan and Countrywide, among others**.

67th Foundation Day of Doordarshan

- **Doordarshan** celebrated its **67th foundation day on September 15, 2026** .
- The celebration, held at Doordarshan Bhawan in Mandi House, was themed 'Doordarshan@67 – Kal Bhi Apna, Aaj Bhi Apna'
- Its **inception in 1959** as an experimental television service **under All India Radio** (now known as Akashvani).
- **1976**: Gained operational autonomy from All India Radio.
- **1982:** Introduced **color television** during Asian Games in Delhi.
- **1997:** Integrated with All India Radio under the unified public broadcasting framework of **Prasar Bharati**

DRI seizes more than 362 MT Pakistan-origin dry dates under 'Operation Deep Manifest'

- The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) has seized more than 362 metric tonnes of Pakistan-origin dry dates under **Operation Deep Manifest.**
- Under Operation Deep Manifest, DRI has been **consistently identifying, intercepting and seizing Pakistan-origin goods attempted to be imported** into India through third-country routing.

Centre Designates Paradip as Mega Port

- Paradip Port was **designated as a "Mega Port"** on 25 September 2026 **under Section 73 of the Indian Ports Act, 2025.**
- The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways granted the status **after an assessment of structural and operational capabilities against prescribed benchmarks.**
- The "Mega Port" category is a statutory designation under the Indian Ports Act, 2025. **Paradip Port became the only port on India's eastern coast to receive this status.**
- Other Ports with Mega Port Status
- Three other ports also received the same designation are **Deendayal Port in Gujarat, Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Mumbai's Nhava Sheva, and Mundra Port in Gujarat.**

SIR Exercise: Electoral Roll Revision and Concerns Within the ECI

WHY IN NEWS ?

- **The Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR)**, launched in Bihar in June 2025, has led to the **deletion of over 13 crore names from draft electoral rolls across 30 States and Union Territories**, triggering debate over the electoral roll revision process.
- **An investigation by The Indian Express** reported that **Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi raised concerns over aspects of the SIR process** during the period under review.
- **Chief Election Commissioner : Gyanesh Kumar**

ECI: Special Intensive Revision (SIR)

- **Phase I: Conducted in Bihar** as the pilot exercise.
- **Phase II: Covers 12 States/UTs**, involving nearly 51 crore electors; final rolls scheduled for 7 February 2026.
- **Phase III: Covers 16 States/UTs**, including **Karnataka, Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Telangana, Uttarakhand, Delhi and Chandigarh.**
- Key concerns: Verification requirements, potential disenfranchisement, migration and the short revision timeline.
- **Documents: Aadhaar and 13 other documents accepted for identity verification.**
- **Earlier revisions**: Intensive revisions were conducted in 1952-56, 1957, 1961, 1965, 1966, 1983-84, 1987-89, 1992, 1993, 1995, 2002, 2003 and 2004 in different parts of India.

What is Special Intensive Revision (SIR)?

- Special Intensive Revision (SIR) is an **intensive verification of electoral rolls conducted by the Election Commission of India.**
- It differs from routine summary revision **because it involves extensive field level enumeration and verification.**
- **Full form: SIR stands for Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.** It **involves systematic verification of voters at the household level.**
- Its primary objective is to **ensure that eligible citizens are included in the electoral roll while ineligible or duplicate entries are identified and removed,** in accordance with applicable electoral laws and procedures.

Election Commission of India

- **Established: 25 January 1950; an autonomous constitutional authority.**
- Mandate: Conducts elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and the offices of President and Vice-President.
- **Constitutional Basis: Article 324 provides its powers and responsibilities.**
- **Objective: Ensures free, fair and transparent elections based on universal adult suffrage under Article 326.**
- **Initially a single-member body, it became a multi-member Commission in 1993, consisting of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and two Election Commissioners.**
- The ECI comprises the **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and two Election Commissioners (ECs),** as provided under Article 324(2) of the Constitution.
- **The President of India determines the number of Commissioners from time to time.**
- **All three members enjoy equal powers, salaries, and status, and decisions are taken collectively through majority vote.**

Tenure & Removal of Election Commissioners

- **Tenure: 6 years or until 65 years of age, whichever is earlier.**
- **Constitutional Protection**: Article 324(5) safeguards the tenure and service conditions of the CEC.
- **Resignation: Election Commissioners may resign by submitting a written resignation to the President.**
- **CEC Removal**: Only in the same manner and on the same grounds as a Supreme Court Judge—**by special majority of Parliament for proven misbehaviour or incapacity.**
- **Other ECs: Can be removed by the President only on the recommendation of the CEC.**

PM Modi Unveils Logo for Birth Centenary Celebrations of Sri Vishwesha Tirtha Swamiji

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi officially unveiled the **logo for the Birth Centenary Celebrations** of the late spiritual leader **Padma Vibhushan Yatikula Chakravarti Sri Vishwesha Tirtha Swamiji.**
- PM Modi met with Sri Sri Vishwaprasanna Tirtha Swamiji, the **current seer of the Sri Pejavara Adhokshaja Matha based in Udupi, Karnataka**

Five new heritage sites and proposals added to India's UNESCO Tentative List

- Five new sites and serial and transnational proposals have been included in India's UNESCO Tentative List, **increasing India's count to 78.**
- Madhya Pradesh now accounts for 19 of India's 78 tentative list.

The newly added sites include:

- **The Buddhist murals of Bagh Cave Paintings**
- **Group of Temples of the Chambal Valley**
- **The Gupta-era Udaigiri Caves**
- **The tribal legacy of Ginnorgarh**
- It also includes the Sites of Satyagraha, which is a serial transnational proposal connecting India and South Africa.
- **Traces the evolution of Satyagraha from South Africa to India.**
- **Total components:** 9 sites — 2 in South Africa and 7 in India.

South Africa:

1. **Pietermaritzburg Station** – linked to Gandhi's 1893 experience of racial discrimination.
2. **Phoenix Settlement** – founded in 1904; prototype for later ashrams and centre of Satyagraha principles.

India:

3. **Mahatma Gandhi Satyagraha Smarak, Champaran** – associated with Gandhi's first Satyagraha in India (1917)
4. **Sabarmati Ashram** – centre of the freedom movement and starting point of the Dandi March (1930).
5. **Mani Bhavan –** Gandhi's Mumbai base; associated with major Satyagraha movements.
6. **Harijan Sevak Sangh** – linked to Gandhi's campaign against untouchability and social inequality. Founded in 1932, shortly after Gandhi signed the Poona Pact with Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
7. **Sevagram Ashram** – centre for ideas of Ahimsa, Swaraj and rural development.
8. **Aga Khan Palace** – detention site during the Quit India Movement; associated with Gandhi's 1943 fast.
9. **Gandhi Smriti** – Gandhi's final residence and site of his assassination on 30 January 1948.



The Buddhist murals of Bagh Cave Paintings

- **Location:** 9 rock-cut Buddhist caves on the southern slope of the Vindhyan Range, along the Baghni River, western Madhya Pradesh.
- **Geology:** Built in a rare sandstone outcrop amid a predominantly basaltic region, influencing their architecture and mural preservation.
- **Period:** Developed mainly between the 4th–6th centuries CE.

- **Cave 4 (Rang Mahal):** Most developed cave, with a 38-pillared hypostyle hall and 28 monastic cells, noted for paintings of Buddhist Jataka tales.
- Cave 4 preserves some of India's finest post-Ajanta Buddhist murals.
- **Technique:** Earth/lime plaster with silica, iron, alumina and lime; pigments included yellow/red ochre, terre verte, lapis lazuli, carbon and lime.
- **Shows continuity with Ajanta techniques**, with regional variations in surface preparation and execution.
- **Themes:** Royal courts, processions, dancers, musicians, attendants and everyday social life.

Group of Temples of the Chambal Valley: Bateshwar, Padavali and Kakarmath

- **Location:** Morena district, Chambal Valley, Madhya Pradesh.
- **Period:** 8th–11th centuries CE; represents early medieval temple architecture of Central India.
- **Architectural style:** Regional Nagara-style temple architecture.
- **Dynasties:** Developed **under the Gurjara-Pratihara and Kachchhapaghat dynasties.**
- **Regional school:** Three sites collectively showcase a distinct Chambal Valley temple-building tradition.
- **Key features:** Sandstone dry masonry, axial temple planning and elaborate sculptures integrated into the architecture.

Bateshwar Temple Complex



- **Period**: Mainly 8th–10th centuries CE, during the Gurjara-Pratihara period.
- **Style:** Wide range of Nagara-style temples, from simple flat-roofed shrines to temples with developed shikharas.
- **Construction**: Built using **finely dressed sandstone blocks without mortar.**

Padavali Temple Complex



- **Period & Dynasty:** 10th century CE, associated with the Kachchhapaghata rulers.
- **Architectural development:** Represents the evolution toward more elaborate Nagara temple architecture and sculpture.

Kakanmath Temple



- **Period & Ruler:** Early 11th century CE, built under Kachchhapaghata ruler Kirtiraj.
- **Architecture**: Built on a high platform using precisely interlocked sandstone blocks in dry masonry.
- **Key feature:** Prominent long shikhara.

The Gupta-era Udaigiri Caves



- **Location:** Sandstone hills near the Betwa and Bes rivers, about 6 km from Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh.
- **Period:** Mainly Gupta period (4th–5th century CE); comprises 20 rock-cut caves.
- **Architecture:** Caves feature square sanctums and mandapas, representing **early models of Hindu temple architecture in North India.**

- **Varaha Relief:** Cave 5 has a monumental Varaha (Vishnu) panel, depicting Vishnu rescuing Earth, with figures of gods, sages and Chandragupta II.
- **Gupta Inscriptions:** Sanskrit inscriptions (401 & 425 CE) provide evidence of Chandragupta II and Kumaragupta I.
- **Lion Capital Artifact:** The Udayagiri Lion Capital, dated around 2nd century BCE or Gupta period, reflects Mauryan influence and early imperial symbolism
- **Religious diversity:** Primarily Hindu, with Jain presence; iconography includes Vaishnavism, Shaivism and Shaktism.
- **Early Ganesha**: Cave 6 contains an early image of Ganesha holding a modaka.
- **Sculptures:** Include Narasimha, Durga–Mahishasura Mardini, Shiva Linga and reclining Vishnu.
- **Water & settlement:** Rock-cut tanks, channels and habitation remains indicate organised settlement and water management.
- **Astronomical significance:** Its location near the Tropic of Cancer has been associated with possible ancient solar/astronomical observations.
- **The tribal legacy of Ginnorgarh**
- **Type**: Extensive tribal hill-fort and palace complex on a hillock within **Ratapani Wildlife Sanctuary, Madhya Pradesh.**
- **Defence:** Strategically uses steep slopes, ravines and dense vegetation as natural defensive features.
- **Gond Kingdom:** Served as a major political and administrative centre of the Gadha/Garha Gond Kingdom from the early 16th to early 18th century.
- **52 Garhs:** Listed among the 52 Garhs (administrative units) under King Sangramsah.
- **Later history:** After Rani Durgavati's defeat (1564 CE), the region came under Mughal control while retaining Gond influence, creating a layered political and architectural history.
- **Rani Mahal:** Ruined 7-storey palace with domical, lime-plastered ceilings and multiple halls.
- **Gond paintings:** Animal, bird, floral and geometric motifs—rare examples of Gond courtly painting traditions.

New NCERT Social Science text replaces European revolutions with resistance movements in medieval India

- The new Social Science textbook for Class 9 students released by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) has removed several chapters on European revolutions and has instead prioritised India's medieval history, regional resistance movements, and the impact of successive foreign invasions in its new edition.
- The new textbook, Understanding Society: India and Beyond - Part Two, replaces the previous edition's chapters on European revolutions, particularly the French and Russian revolutions, with a detailed exploration of Indian sovereignty and resilience
- The new textbook introduces a comprehensive framework detailing the Indian subcontinent's response to expansionist powers between 1,000 and 1,700 CE.
- A chapter titled 'Resistance and Resilience' turns a sharp lens on the relationship between the Mughal state and the Sikh Gurus.
- The textbook describes "the brutality of the Mughal state" against the Gurus as having "few comparisons in history".

Eminent Personalities in News

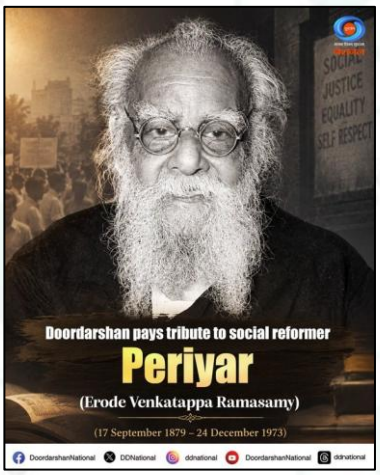


17 September- PM Narendra Modi's Birthday

- The **76th birthday** of Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 17th September 2026
- **Narendra Damodardas Modi was born on 17 September 1950 to a Gujarati family** in Vadnagar, Mehsana district, Bombay State (present-day Gujarat).
- **Narendra Modi is the current and 14th Prime Minister of India (since 2014)**
- Chief Minister of Gujarat: 2001 – 2014.

147th birth anniversary of Self-Respect Movement founder Thanthai Periyar observed

- Erode Venkatappa Ramasamy was born on 17 September 1879 in Erode to Venkatappa Naicker and Chinnathayee.
- He belonged to a prosperous Balija Naicker merchant family of Telugu origin and helped manage the family business after leaving school early
- Periyar joined the Indian National Congress in 1919 and actively participated in Mahatma Gandhi's Non Cooperation Movement.
- In 1921, he was imprisoned for protesting against toddy shops as part of anti liquor campaigns.**In 1924-25, he joined the Vaikom Satyagraha in Travancore**, demanding access to **public roads around the Vaikom Temple for marginalized communities.**
- **Founder of Self Respect Movement:** In 1925, he launched the Self Respect Movement to promote dignity, equality and self respect among lower castes and women.



- **Dravidian Movement Leadership: Known as the "Father of the Dravidian Movement,"** he advocated social justice, rationalism, linguistic rights and at times supported the demand for an independent Dravida Nadu.

Saratchandra Chattopadhyay

- Prime Minister of India paid tribute to **iconic Bengali novelist and short story writer Saratchandra Chattopadhyay** on his 150th birth anniversary.
- Born on September 15, 1876, Saratchandra Chattopadhyay was **one of India's most celebrated novelists, humanists, and short story writers.**
- Renowned for his **deep psychological realism, empathy for the marginalized, and bold exploration of women's inner lives against orthodox social codes**, his works have been translated into nearly every major Indian and several foreign languages, inspiring over 40 cinematic adaptations.

Contribution to the Freedom Movement:

- **Revolutionary Literature:** His **1926 novel Pather Dabi, centred on revolutionary resistance to British rule**, was banned by the colonial government.
- Served as **President of the Howrah District Congress** (1921–1936) and participated in the Non-Cooperation Movement and grassroots mobilisation.
- **Major Works: Parineeta, Devdas, Charitraheen, Nishkriti, Srikanta, Biraj Bou, and Sesh Prashna.**
- Honours: Received **the Jagattarini Gold Medal (1923)** and an honorary D.Litt. from the University of Dacca (1936).

4th Sept - Birth anniversary of Dadabhai Naoroji

- Born on 4th Sept 1825 - He is also known as the **"Grand Old Man of India".**
- He served as the **first Indian member of the British parliament.**
- **Served as Congress President: three times** in **1886 (Calcutta), 1893 (Lahore), and 1906 (Calcutta)**.
- He published the book **Poverty and Un-British Rule in India** in 1901.
- He formed an **Indian parliamentary committee** in the British Parliament in **1893** for lobbying for **reforms in India.**
- He was appointed to the **Royal Commission on Indian Expenditure** in **1895**

Mahanayak Uttam Kumar on his birth centenary

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid **rich tribute to Bengali film legend Uttam Kumar on his birth centenary.**
- Born on September 3, 1926, Uttam Kumar, whose **original name was Arun Kumar Chattopadhyay**, died on July 24, 1980.
- The Mahanayak of Bengali Cinema Arun Kumar Chattopadhyay, better known as Uttam Kumar, or the "Mahanayak" (Great Hero).
- His filmography boasts iconic roles in classics like **Agni Pariksha, Harano Sur, Saptapadi, Jatugriha, Nayak, Amanush, and Antony Firingee.**
- He received the inaugural **National Film Award for Best Actor for his performances in Antony Firingee and Chiriyakhana** (both 1967), a testament to his unparalleled range and skill.
- Further accolades include **BFJA Best Actor Awards and a Filmfare Best Actor Award.**

Acharya Vinoba Bhave Birth Anniversary

- Vinayak Narahari Bhave was born on **11th September 1895 in Gagode, Bombay Presidency** (Maharashtra).
- Acharya Vinoba Bhave was a **nonviolence activist, freedom activist, social reformer and spiritual teacher.**
- Being an avid follower of **Mahatma Gandhi,** Vinoba upheld his doctrines of **non-violence and equality.**

Awards & Recognition:

- Vinoba was the first recipient of the international **Ramon Magsaysay Award** for **Community Leadership in 1958.**
- He was also conferred with the **Bharat Ratna** (India's highest civilian awards) posthumously in **1983.**
- **Bhoodan Movement:**In 1951, Vinoba Bhave started his **peace-trek on foot through the violence-torn region of Telangana.**
- On 19th 1951, the **Harijans of the Pochampalli** village requested him to provide them with around 80 acres of land to make a living.
- Vinoba asked the **landlords of the village to come forward and save the Harijans.**
  - A landlord got up and offered the required land.
  - It was the beginning of the **Bhoodan (Gift of the Land) movement.**
- His important books include: **Swarajya Sastra, Geeta Pravachan, Teesri Shakti or The Third Power etc.**

Ramdhari Singh 'Dinkar' birth anniversary

- Dinkar, **born on September 23, 1908, in Simaria, Bihar**, was a prominent figure in Hindi literature.
- His works, such as **Kurukshetra, Rashmirathi, Hunkar**, and **Parshuram Ki Pratiksha, Krishna Ki Chaetavani**

- **Honors:** Padma Bhushan (1959), Jnanpith Award (1972)
- The **former Rajya Sabha member** died in 1974.

Ishwarchandra Vidyasagar 206th birth anniversary

- **Born: 26 September 1820**, in Birsingha, Bengal Presidency (now in West Bengal, India)
- **Known for:** Social reformer, educationist, and key figure in the Bengal Renaissance.

Major Contributions:

- Championed **widow remarriage** and worked to remove barriers to **women's education.**
- Modernized **Bengali prose** and reformed education systems.
- He studied Sanskrit grammar, literature, Vedanta, logic, astronomy, and Hindu law at Sanskrit College, Calcutta, earning the title **Vidyasagar ("Ocean of Learning") at 21.**

Notable Works of Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

- Borno Porichoy (1855): meaning "Introduction to the Letters,"
- Sitar Bonobas (1860)
- Jivancharita (1849),
- Mahabharata (1860)

Bhagat Singh 119th birth anniversary

- Born on **September 28,** 1907 in **Banga, Punjab (now in Pakistan),**
- Witnessed **the Jallianwala Bagh massacre at** the age of 12,
- **Joined the National College, Lahore**, founded by **Lala Lajpat Rai,** which emphasised **Swadeshi Movement** and provided a platform for revolutionary ideas.
- **Revolutionary Organisations:** Bhagat Singh became a **member** of the **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) in 1924**, later **renaming it** the **Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA) in 1928.**
- **Naujawan Bharat Sabha was founded by Bhagat Singh in 1926**, aimed at mobilising youth for the freedom struggle.
- **Major Actions:** Involved in the assassination of police officer **J.P. Saunders in 1928 (Lahore Conspiracy Case)** as retaliation for Lala Lajpat Rai's death due to police brutality.
  - Threw a **bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly** on 18th April 1929, with B.K. Dutt to protest against repressive British laws.
- **Arrest and Trial:** Arrested **in 1929** for the bomb incident and later charged with murder in the **Lahore Conspiracy Case**. He was **tried, convicted, and sentenced to death.**
- **Executed on 23rd March 1931,** along with fellow revolutionaries Sukhdev and Rajguru, **in Lahore**. Bhagat Singh is affectionately known as **Shahid-e-Azam,** the greatest of martyrs.
- **Literary Contributions:** Authored significant works, including **Why I Am an Atheist, The Jail Notebook and Other Writings**



National/ international festivals

PM Modi greets Netanyahu, people of Israel on Jewish New Year, Rosh Hashanah

- **Rosh Hashanah,** also known as the **Day of Judgment, is one of the major religious festivals of Judaism.**
- During the festival, Jews reflect on their relationship with God and commemorate the creation of the world.
- It marks the beginning of the **Jewish month of Tishri, which is the 7th month according to the Hebrew calendar.**
- It is believed by the Jewish community to be the day **when God created the world, including Adam and Eve.**
- Rosh Hashanah is also known as **Yom Hadin (Day of Judgment)** on which God opens the Books of Life and Death, which are then sealed on Yom Kippur.

Prime Minister extends greetings on the Parkash Purab of Sri Guru Granth Sahib Ji

- On this day in 1604, the Guru Granth Sahib was formally inaugurated and ceremoniously opened **at Golden Temple in Amritsar**, taking the form of the Adi Granth Sahib.
- Adi Granth Sahib: The Adi Granth, meaning "**the first book," is the early compilation of Sikh scriptures by Guru Arjan Dev (5th of 10 Gurus) in 1604.**
- The Adi Granth is the first version of the Guru Granth Sahib which serves as the holy scripture of the Sikhs.
- In 1708, before his departure, Guru Gobind Singh declared the **Adi Granth as the eternal Guru, commanding all Sikhs to regard the Guru Granth Sahib as their next and everlasting Guru.** It was then renamed Sri Guru Granth Sahib.
- The Adi Granth incorporated writings from 36 Hindu and Muslim authors, including Kabir, Ravi Das, Naam Dev, and Sheikh Farid.

Ganesh Chaturthi

- The **Ganesh Chaturthi in 2026 starts on Monday, September 14.**
- It is a **10-day festival, where Lord Ganesha is brought into homes and public pandals in India**
- Also referred to as Vinayaka Chaturthi, this festival commemorates the birth of Lord Ganesha who is worshipped as the Vighnaharta or the god who removes obstacles from people's paths
- Ganesh Chaturthi marks his birth and falls on Chaturthi Tithi of Shukla Paksha in Bhadrapada.
- The celebration will come to an end with the arrival of Anant Chaturdashi
- Freedom fighter Bal Gangadhar Tilak turned it into a big public celebration during the period of freedom movement.
- Since 1893, Bal Gangadhar Tilak started spreading the **sarvajanik Ganesh festival by publishing articles in his journal Kesari,** thus bringing together people in a common social place.

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla extends greetings on Hartalika Teej

- The festival symbolises **good fortune and unbreakable marital love.**
- Hartalika Teej Vrat is celebrated on the **Tritiya of Shukla Paksha in the Bhadrapada month**
- Goddess Parvati, devoted to Lord Shiva, was abducted by her friends to avoid her marriage to Lord Vishnu, as per her father's wish.
- **Parvati worshiped a clay idol of Lord Shiva, pleasing him, and they eventually married.**
- Women observe Swarna Gowri Vratha to seek blessings from Goddess Gowri for a happy married life.
- Prominent in North Indian states: Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, and Jharkhand.
- Known as **Gowri Habba in South Indian states: Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu.**

PM Modi, HM Amit Shah extend greetings to people on Samvatsari

- **Samvatsari is the final and most sacred day of the Shwetambar Paryushan festival.**
- Samvatsari, one of the most spiritually significant observances in Jainism, **reminds everyone that forgiveness and compassion strengthen every bond**
- On Samvatsari, often known as International Forgiveness Day, devotees perform the annual **Samvatsari Pratikraman**, reviewing their **conduct over the past year and offer Micchami Dukkadam** -- seeking forgiveness from every living being for any harm caused knowingly or unknowingly.

Prime Minister extends greetings on Nuakhai

- Nuakhai, a festival that **celebrates our farmers, the harvest and the spirit of togetherness.**
- It is an **important social festival of Western Odisha**.
- The **word nua means new and khai means food.**
- Objective: It is an agricultural festival which is observed to welcome the new rice of the season.
- It is observed on the **fifth day of the lunar fortnight of the month of Bhadrapada or Bhaadra (August–September).**

Rituals of Naukhai Festivals

- Nuakhai is understood to **have nine colours and as a consequence nine sets of rituals** are followed as a prelude to the actual day of celebration.
- People offer the **newly harvested crop called Nabanha to their respective presiding deities.**
- After offering the Nabanha, **people relish different types of delicacies prepared from the newly harvested crop.**
- The Nuakhai Juhar is a major ritual of the festival.

17th September Vishwakarma Puja

- This festival is dedicated to the Hindu god Vishwakarma, regarded in Hindu tradition as the divine architect or engineer of the gods.
- **In the Rig Veda, he is mentioned as the "divine carpenter" and is credited with Sthapatya Veda, the science of mechanics and architecture.**
- Credited with building mythological cities like Dwarka (Krishna's city), Lanka (Ravana's capital), Indraprastha (Pandavas' city) and weapons like Vajra (of Indra).
- Vishwakarma Puja is **celebrated on 'kanya sankranti'** (around 17–18 September)of the Hindu calendar that falls around mid-September as per the Gregorian calendar.
- **It falls on the last day of the Bengali month called Bhadra -** Bhadra Sankranti Puja
- This festival is celebrated across states, like Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka, West Bengal, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha and Tripura.
- In some regions (esp. North India), **it is also called Kanya Sankranti Puja.**
- **It is also celebrated in Nepal.**

Radha Ashtami

- The 5,254th birth anniversary of **Goddess Radha was celebrated across Mathura**
- The main celebrations were held at the **Sri Radha Rani temple in Barsana and the Ladooji temple in Rawal**, both considered key sites associated with the deity's birth.
- It is **traditionally observed on the Ashtami tithi (eighth day) of the Shukla Paksha (bright fortnight) in the Hindu calendar month of Bhadrapada**, falling exactly **fifteen days after Krishna Janmashtami.**

Anant Chaturdashi celebrated on 25th September

- **Anant Chaturdashi** is observed on the **Chaturdashi Tithi of Shukla Paksha in the month of Bhadrapada** and is **dedicated to Lord Vishnu in his Anant form.**
- The same day also marks the concluding phase of the 10-day Ganeshotsav,
- The Anant Vrat is a traditional vow dedicated to Lord Anant. Devotees may observe a fast, perform puja and listen to or recite the **Anant Chaturdashi Vrat Katha.**

State

Ladakh

Proposed Article 371(K)

- The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has proposed inserting a new constitutional provision, Article 371(K) (or Chapter K under Part XXI), to establish a directly elected governing body with legislative powers for the Union Territory of Ladakh.
- A proposed constitutional amendment under Part XXI of the Constitution (Temporary, Transitional and Special Provisions) intended to create a sui generis (unique) model of governance for the Union Territory of Ladakh.
- It provides for a directly elected UT-level governing body vested with legislative authority over specified subjects.

Background:

- Following the bifurcation of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir under the J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019, **Ladakh was carved out as a Union Territory without a legislative assembly.**
- The transition resulted in **governance largely led by bureaucrats and the Lieutenant Governor** rather than elected representatives, **sidelining the existing Autonomous Hill Development Councils** (LAHDC Leh and Kargil).
- In response, the Leh Apex Body (LAB) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) joined forces, demanding full statehood, protection under the Sixth Schedule, dedicated public service commissions, and parliamentary representation.
- **Aim:** To restore democratic governance in Ladakh, protect tribal rights, land and ecology, and address political alienation without granting statehood or Sixth Schedule status.

Key Features:

- Mandates the creation of a **territorial governing body elected through direct universal franchise,** transitioning Ladakh away from purely bureaucratic administration.
- Grants legislative authority over ecologically and culturally sensitive domains, **including land rights, transfer of property, culture and language, forests, environment, and natural resources.**
- Entails powers over subject matters otherwise reserved for presidential regulations for Union Territories under Article 240 of the Constitution.
- Mirrors the **protective mechanisms found in Articles 371A (Nagaland) and 371G (Mizoram),** where central laws on land and local traditions do not apply automatically without local legislative assent.

Kumik Declared Ladakh's First Heritage Village

- Kumik village in Zanskar was declared **Ladakh's first designated Heritage Village.**

- The declaration was made by the **Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh, Vinai Kumar Saxena,** during the launch of the Ladakh Zanskar Festival 2026.
- A Heritage Village is a settlement recognised for its cultural, architectural, religious, and traditional value.
- Such recognition is used in India for places with **preserved built heritage, living traditions, and local knowledge systems.**
- Kumik is known for its traditional mud houses, sacred spaces, agricultural practices, and long-preserved Buddhist traditions.
- Traditional mud architecture in Ladakh uses locally available materials such as earth, stone, and wood.
- **This building style is suited to cold desert conditions and high-altitude settlements.**

Two-day Drass Festival celebrated in Ladakh

- In Ladakh, the two-day Drass Festival was held on September 4 and 5, will provide a major platform to showcase the tourism, cultural and adventure potential of Drass, recently announced as a **new district.**
- Being organised under the Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyan, the festival will include awareness programmes, theatre performances and cultural events highlighting the dangers of drug and substance abuse.
- Programmes promoting patriotism and national unity will also form an important part of the celebrations.

Ladakh Develops World's Highest-Altitude Flower Fields

- Ladakh inaugurated **twin flower fields at Choglamsar and Stakna in Leh.**
- The fields stand at 10,600 feet, or about 3,265 metres, and are described as the **world's highest-altitude flower fields.**
- The project covers **40 acres and includes more than 25 lakh flowers.**
- The Choglamsar field includes **Lilium, Gladiolus and Tulips**, which are among the **commonly cultivated ornamental bulbous flowers i**n temperate regions.

Ladakh Hikes Village Heads' Honorarium to Rs 5,000

- **Monthly emoluments of village heads**, locally known as **'gobas',** in the Union territory of Ladakh have been hiked more than **three-fold from Rs 1,500 to Rs 5,000.**
- **Nambardars are village-level functionaries in Ladakh who are also called Gobas in some local areas.**
- The post is linked to grassroots administration and village-level coordination in the Union Territory.

Jammu & Kashmir

Kashmir Hosts Inaugural International Film Festival

- The inaugural International Film Festival of Jammu and Kashmir (IFFJK) began on 7 September 2026 at the Sher-i-Kashmir International Convention Centre (SKICC) in Srinagar.
- The four-day festival, **themed "Rang-e-Cinema", is scheduled from 7 September to 10 September** 2026.
- A floating cinema was installed on Dal Lake near the SKICC for festival screenings.



GI-tag 'Kaladi cheese' of J&K reaches commercial threshold for global consumption

- The Union Minister of State in PMO recently stated that the **"Kaladi", the GI-tagged traditional dairy product of the Udhampur district of Jammu and**

Kashmir, has reached the commercial threshold for local and global consumption.

- **Known as Kalari cheese or the "mozzarella of the Himalayas**",
- The local delicacy is **traditionally made by Gujjar shepherds in the mountains of Kashmir.**
- It is a traditionally ripened cheese made from cow's or goat's milk.
- **GI Tag: 2023.**

Himachal Pradesh

Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project

- The Chief Ministers of five states—**Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, and Rajasthan—along with Delhi**, signed a landmark agreement in New Delhi to implement the long-pending **₹15,000-crore** Kishau Multipurpose Project.
- A National Multipurpose Project involving a 232.6-metre concrete gravity dam and **422 MW hydropower plant on the Tons River, a major tributary of the Yamuna.**
- It aims to provide hydropower, irrigation and water supply to the Upper Yamuna basin.

States Involved:

- **Host States: Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand.**
- **Beneficiaries: Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan and Delhi.**
- **Upper Yamuna Agreement, 1994**: The project originated under the landmark May 12, 1994 Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) **signed among the five basin states to allocate 11.983 billion cubic metres (BCM) of utilizable Yamuna surface waters.**
- **Three Storage Projects: Kishau, Lakhwar and Renukaji** form key storage projects in the Upper Yamuna basin.

Ramjak Mountain

- A four-member team from Keralam recently scaled Ramjak, a **6,318-metre peak in the remote Lahaul region of Himachal Pradesh.**
- Ramjak Mountain is a high-altitude mountain peak located in the remote Lahaul region of Himachal Pradesh.
- It rises to around 6,318 metres (20,728 ft).
- The peak is **located near Shingo La, which is a popular trek route from Himachal to Zanskar.**
- **First ascent:** An expedition of the Indian Mountaineering Foundation (IMF) led by **Sangay Dorjee Sherpa achieved the first ascent in 2002.**

Pangwala Tribe

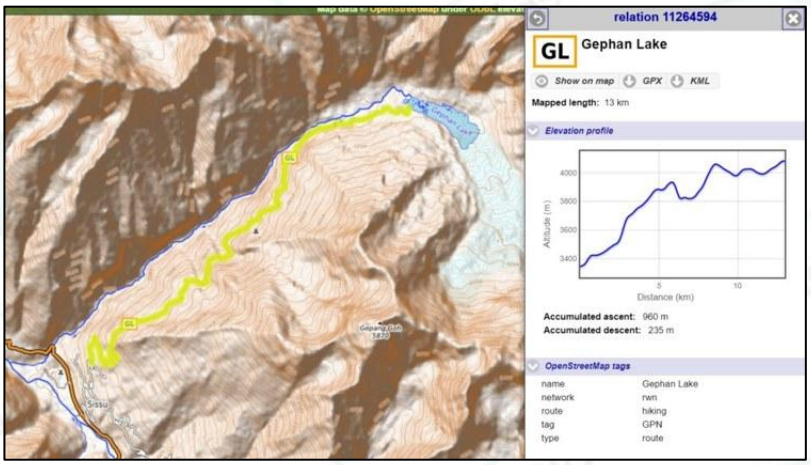


- A detailed study on the gut microbiome of the **Pangwala tribal community** has found that members living in the remote Pangi valley and those who have migrated to urban areas retain a remarkably similar "core microbiome" despite having substantial differences in lifestyle, diet, and environment.
- The **Pangwala are a Scheduled Tribe living** primarily in the Pangi Valley in the **Chamba district of Himachal Pradesh.**
- Located in the **Pir Panjal range of the Himalayas.**
- The Pangwala speak Pangwali, an Indo-Aryan language connected to the western Himalayan linguistic family.

- Families traditionally depend on terrace farming, livestock raising, and seasonal agricultural work.
- Crops may include barley, wheat, maize, potatoes, and peas suited for cooler mountain conditions.
- Sheep and goat herding are important in some areas, especially where grazing land is available in higher elevations.
- The Pangwala primarily **follow Hindu religious traditions, though elements of folk religion and local Himalayan spiritual beliefs** also influence everyday life.

Ghepan Lake

- The Lahaul-Spiti district administration recently decided to further strengthen monitoring and precautionary measures regarding the Ghepan Glacial Lake.
- Ghepang Ghat glacial lake, known locally as **Ghepan Lake, is a high-altitude glacial lake located in the Lahaul region of Himachal Pradesh.**
- **Named after Ghepan, the protector deity of Lahaul,** the lake has deep ties to local culture and faith.
- The lake is known for its enchanting turquoise blue waters and glacial surroundings.
- A total **of three hanging glaciers feed Ghepan Lake.**



- It is unusual to see this kind of setting of glaciers feeding alpine lakes at this height, as it happens deep in the Himalayas, above 15,000 feet.
- The lake is a challenging trekking destination, with the trek generally beginning from Sissu in the Lahaul Valley.

Uttarakhand

Uttarakhand Waqf Board proposes new nikahnama to align with UCC

- The Uttarakhand Waqf Board is preparing a revised nikahnama to align with the provisions of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC), with a key proposal that **daughters should have an equal share in their father's property even after marriage**
- **Contrary to Sharia law**, under which a daughter is legally entitled to a fixed share of her parent's inheritance — generally **half of a son's share when they inherit together**
- The **existing nikahnama contains columns for first, second and third marriages,** and the revised document would remove the need for such columns since, under the **UCC, a Muslim man cannot have more than one marriage.**
- Triple talaq, halala and iddat
- The proposed nikahnama will also state that **a Muslim woman cannot be given triple talaq.**
- Another provision **will deal with halala**, which Shams referred to in the context of cases where women are allegedly forced into the practice.

- It is a practice in which a woman, after receiving an irrevocable final divorce from her husband, marries another man, consummates that marriage, and then divorces or is widowed, allowing her to remarry her former husband.
- The proposed document will also address **iddat,** the period of **mourning observed by a Muslim woman after her husband's death.**
- The traditional period after a husband's death is **four months and 10 days**, but the proposed provision would state that a woman should be **free to decide how long she wants to observe it.**
- The Board also plans to address cases involving religious conversion for marriage.

Uttarakhand's first glacial lake early-warning system

- The Uttarakhand state is installing the first early-warning system at Vasundhara Tal in Chamoli to monitor it in real time.
- Location: High-altitude glacial lake in Chamoli district, Uttarakhand.
- Elevation: Located at approximately 4,795 m in the Raikana Valley.
- River Source: Acts as the source of the Dhauliganga River, a major tributary of the Alaknanda River.
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- Elevation: Located at approximately 4,795 m in the Raikana Valley.
- River Source: Acts as the source of the Dhauliganga River, a major tributary of the Alaknanda River.
- Snow Monitoring: Snow-depth and sub-surface temperature sensors track changes in snow conditions.
- Movement Detection: Tilt and accelerometer sensors detect ground movement and vibrations.
- Water-Flow Sensor: Measures variations in water discharge.
- Power & Communication: Operates on solar energy, with data transmitted via satellite due to the absence of mobile connectivity.
- Early Warning: A data logger and monitoring dashboard analyse readings and generate alerts when predefined thresholds are exceeded.

Punjab

Punjab launches 'Pehchaan' portal to identify unclaimed, unidentified bodies

- **To identify unidentified and unclaimed deceased persons kept in government mortuaries across the state**, Punjab has launched a digital public identification portal, "Pehchaan".
  - This is the first of its kind portal in the country**, which will help relatives living in India and abroad to identify their near and dear ones who have lost their lives in accidents or otherwise.**
  - Under the 'Pehchaan' initiative, facial photographs, permanent identification marks, including tattoos, birthmarks, and deformities, and detailed physical descriptions of every unidentified, unclaimed deceased person will be uploaded to the portal **within 48 hours of postmortem at any government mortuary in Punjab.**

12 September - Saragarhi Day observed in Punjab, tributes paid to martyrs of Battle of Saragarhi

- In Amritsar, Bhog of Akhand Path Sahib was performed at **Saragarhi Gurdwara in the memory of 21 British-Indian Sikh soldiers.**

- They gave their supreme sacrifice while fighting with 10,000 Afghan tribals to defend the Saragarhi Fort in Waziristan on September 12th, 1897.
- It was on this day, 129 years ago, when 21 brave Sikh soldiers under the leadership of Havaldar Ishar Singh of the Sikh Regiment fought to their last breath against the Afghan tribesmen in Samana village of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, presently in Pakistan.
- They killed hundreds of attacking tribesmen and foiled their attempts to capture the Saragarhi Fort.
- **They were honoured with the highest Indian military bravery award of those days, the Indian Order of Merit.**
- The award is presently equated to Paramvir Chakra.

Haryana

Haryana launches 'Har Ghar Diya' initiative under Seva Sankalp Abhiyan

- The **'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'** has been launched across the country today to mark Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday and 25 years in public service.
- **The 'Har Ghar Diya' initiative**, scheduled for this evening in Haryana, has infused new energy into the **lives of traditional clay artisans and potters across the nation, particularly in Punjab, Haryana, and Chandigarh.**

Haryana CM launches second phase of Deendayal Lado Lakshmi Yojana on PM Modi's birthday

- Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini has launched the **second phase of the Deendayal Lado Lakshmi Yojana.**
- **Eligible women will receive financial assistance of ₹2,100 per month.**
- **Women above 18 years of age who are permanent residents of Haryana and belong to Below Poverty Line (BPL)** families are eligible under the scheme
- The beneficiaries will receive funds directly in their bank accounts through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).

Maruti Suzuki Commissions First Green Hydrogen Plant at Manesar

- Maruti Suzuki India Limited commissioned its **first Green Hydrogen (GH_2) electrolyser plant at its Manesar facility in Haryana**.
- The plant has a capacity of 300 kW and functions as a pilot project for green hydrogen production and use in manufacturing operations.
- Green hydrogen is hydrogen produced using renewable electricity through electrolysis, a process that splits water into hydrogen and oxygen.

Delhi

Delhi Govt approves introduction of 'Grassroot Training Support Assistance' under Mukhyamantri Khel Protsahan Yojana

- The Delhi Government has approved the introduction of a 'Grassroot Training Support Assistance' component under the **Mukhyamantri Khel Protsahan Yojana.**
- Under the new initiative, eligible athletes training regularly at Delhi government sports centres and stadiums will receive financial assistance of two thousand rupees per month.
- The scheme will cover athletes in the **Under-14, Under-17, Under-19 and Under-21 categories.**

- The assistance will help athletes meet expenses related to nutrition, local travel, basic sports equipment and medical needs.

Delhi cabinet clears 'DURGA' scheme for 1,300 e-autos for women, transgender persons

- The Delhi Cabinet approved the **'DURGA' e-auto scheme, under which 1,300 pink electric autos will be allocated in the first phase to women and transgender persons**.
- the scheme would let **women and transgender persons become owners** and **drivers of electric autos, providing dignified self-employment** while also promoting safety, last-mile connectivity and clean transport.
- To be eligible for the scheme, **women applicants must be aged 20 to 40, be Delhi residents**, and hold a **valid voter ID, an Light Motor Vehicle (LMV) driving licence** and a **Public Service Vehicle Badge** . A woman with **more than three children will not be eligible for the scheme**
- Neither the applicant nor her family can own a registered transport vehicle or three-wheeler, and **combined family income for 2025-26 period must not exceed Rs 5 lakh.**
- Further, Transgender applicants **need a valid transgender certificate issued by a Delhi District Magistrate's office,** besides the age, residency, licence and badge conditions.
- The e-autos will carry a **mandatory three-year lock-in period, during which they cannot be sold or transferred**, and will bear 'DURGA' branding and identification features.

Delhi's Chandni Chowk Town Hall to Become Global Heritage Centre

- **The historic Town Hall building in Chandni Chowk,** which served as the **headquarters of the municipal corporation** for more than a century, is set to be revamped.
- An agreement was signed to conserve and redevelop the heritage building as a Global Heritage Centre,
- **Constructed in the 1860s, the Town Hall initially housed the Lawrence Institute**, which had **a museum, a reading room, and a library.**

Delhi government launches solar portal with subsidy up to Rs 1.56 lakh

- Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the **Delhi PM Surya Ghar registration portal.**
- The portal, **solar.delhi.gov.in, is linked to the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana** for rooftop solar installations in Delhi.
- The portal **provides registration for the scheme, information on authorised vendors, grievance redressal, and a solar calculator** for estimating system capacity and savings.
- PM Surya Ghar: **Muft Bijli Yojana is a Union government rooftop solar scheme for households**.

Short news

- **Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu** has directed the Delhi Police to establish a dedicated "**Pink Force**" of trained women personnel to enhance the **safety of women and children across the national capital.**

Uttar Pradesh

Maharani Avantibai Lodhi

- Defence Minister unveiled a statue of **Rani Avantibai Lodhi in Lucknow, drawing a direct parallel between the valor of 1857** warrior queens and modern Indian women armed forces personnel who executed **combat roles during Operation Sindoor.**

- Maharani Avantibai Lodhi (16 August 1831 – 20 March 1858) was the queen-regent of the princely estate of Ramgarh and a legendary warrior leader during the Indian Rebellion of 1857.
- She is revered alongside Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi, Rani Durgavati, and Jhalkari Bai as one of India's foremost Veeranganas (heroic warrior women).

Contribution to the 1857 Freedom Movement:

- **Collaborating with Gond ruler Raja Shankar Shah**, she spearheaded the regional anti-British coalition by sending glass bangles alongside letters to neighboring kings and zamindars.
- In late 1857, **she raised an army of 4,000 troops leading a charge against British Deputy Commissioner Waddington at the Battle of Kheri** near Mandla, forcing British forces to flee the district.
- On 20 March 1858, encircled by superior **British firepower at Sukhi-Talaiya between Balapur and Ramgarh, she chose death over dishonor and capture**, unsheathing her own sword and embracing martyrdom.

Cashless medical insurance of up to ₹5 lakh annually for advocates

- Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has announced a major welfare scheme **providing cashless medical insurance of up to ₹5 lakh annually for all active advocates practicing in the High Court and district courts** across the state
- The landmark announcement was made during a **ceremony at the Allahabad High Court Bar Association.**
- In addition to the ₹5 lakh annual health cover, the state government introduced **several significant financial and infrastructural upgrades for the legal fraternity**
- **Welfare Fund Boost:** The Advocate Welfare Fund assistance has been hiked **from ₹1.5 lakh to ₹5 lakh**
- **Extended Age Limit:** The age limit for **family financial assistance in the event of an advocate's death** has been increased from **60 years to 70 years.**
- **Fee Hikes: Fees for state government lawyers have been increased by more than 50%.**
- **Chamber Support:** The government will fund **furniture and equipment for over 10,000 advocates'** chambers, 400 State Law Officers will be **provided tablets.**

UP govt approves free transfer of 26 hectares of land for setting up regional hub of National Security Guard

- Uttar Pradesh cabinet has approved the **transfer of free land to the Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)** for the establishment of a **Regional Centre of the National Security Guard (NSG) in Ayodhya.**
- The approval has been given to the proposal to **transfer 26 hectares (or 65 acres) of barren land in Milkipur tehsil of Ayodhya to the MHA.**
- The NSG centre is being set up to **strengthen the security arrangements of Ram Temple and with a purpose of helping in dealing with any potential security challenge in Ayodhya,** further strengthening the rapid response capability in any emergency situation.

Uttar Pradesh organized the PM-SETU Industry Conclave

- Recently, the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE**), Government of India, in **collaboration with the Government of Uttar Pradesh** organized the **PM-SETU Industry Conclave in Lucknow.**
- PM-SETU (Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs) is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme launched to strengthen India's vocational training ecosystem.**
- It aims to **modernise the ITI ecosystem by upgrading 1000 government ITIs across India into modern, industry-aligned training institutions**

- It is implemented as a hub-and-spoke model, with 200 hub ITIs linked to 800 spoke ITIs.
- Each hub will be equipped with advanced infrastructure, innovation and incubation centres, production units, training of trainer facilities, and placement services, while the spokes will extend access and outreach.

Objectives

- To improve the quality of training delivery in Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) and National Skill Training Institutes (NSTIs);
- To modernize infrastructure and equipment as per industry standards;
- To introduce industry-aligned long-term and short-term courses, especially in new and emerging sectors;
- To strengthen industry linkage for demand-driven skilling and better employment outcomes; and
- To enhance the capacity of NSTIs for training of trainers.
- Financial outlay and Time Period: ₹60,000 crore, over a five- year period.
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship**

Components of PM-SETU Scheme

- Introduce new, demand-driven courses and revamp existing ones in collaboration with industry;
- Create pathways for long-term diplomas, short-term courses, and executive programs;
- **Strengthen 5 National Skill Training Institutes in – Bhubaneswar (Odisha), Chennai (Tamil Nadu), Hyderabad (Telangana), Kanpur (Uttar Pradesh), Ludhiana (Punjab), as Centres of Excellence with global partnerships.**
- The initiative is **backed by global co-financing from the World Bank and Asian Development Bank**

Uttar Pradesh CM launches Bharat Taxi, Krishak Samriddhi Yojana

- Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched **Bharat Taxi and Mukhyamantri Krishak Samriddhi Yojana**, taking two major **steps for taxi drivers and farmers.**
- Through '**Bharat Taxi', two-wheeler, taxi and three-wheeler drivers will be able to join on zero commission upon registration**.
- They will also **receive social security of 5 lakh rupees.**
- Its operations have started in **Lucknow, Gorakhpur, Varanasi and Prayagraj.**
- Under Mukhyamantri Krishak Samriddhi Yojana, **the interest rate on loans provided to farmers through the Uttar Pradesh Cooperative Gramya Vikas Bank has been reduced from 11% to 6%.**
- To ensure that **farmers do not face a shortage of funds for farming and** machinery, arrangements have been made for long-term loans.

UP International Trade Show 2026 began in Greater Noida

- **The fourth edition of the UP International Trade Show (UPITS)** will begin on 26th September at the **India Expo Centre and Mart in Greater Noida of Uttar Pradesh**.
- Union Home and Cooperation Minister **Amit Shah** and Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister **Yogi Adityanath will inaugurate the five-day event.**
- the exhibition will continue till September 29th,
- **Partner countries for this edition include Austria, Japan, Russia, Singapore, Belarus and Vietnam**

- A major highlight this year is the introduction of the '**One District, One Cuisine' initiative**, which will be featured alongside the '**One District, One Product' scheme to present the state's traditional culinary heritage to the world.**
- **The ABDM, launched in September 2021**, is aimed at **creating an interoperable and citizen-centric digital health ecosystem.**
- Its key digital building blocks include the **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA), Healthcare Professionals Registry (HPR) and Health Facility Registry (HFR).**

Madhya Pradesh

Union Minister Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia lays foundation stone of India's 7th Postal Training Centre in Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh

- Union Minister for Communications and DoNER, Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, laid **the foundation stone of the country's 7th Postal Training Centre at Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh**
- The new centre will serve as a **national-level training facility for postal employees from Madhya Pradesh and neighbouring states,** with a focus on equipping the workforce with modern skills and training in emerging technologies.
- This new centre will expand the **Department of Posts' network of six Postal Training Centres at Saharanpur, Vadodara, Mysuru, Guwahati, Madurai and Darbhanga,**

Mission Zero: Depalpur's Legacy Waste Transformation

- Depalpur, Madhya Pradesh, became the **first city under the Swachh Shehar Jodi initiative to achieve Zero Legacy Waste**, remediating 1,250 metric tonnes of legacy waste accumulated over five years under SBM-U 2.0.
- **Mission Zero**
- It is a s**cientific legacy-waste remediation and urban waste-management** initiative undertaken by Depalpur Nagar Parishad with Indore Municipal Corporation **under the Swachh Shehar Jodi initiative of Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0 (SBM-U 2.0).**
- It follows the Each One Teach One model, where experienced mentor cities transfer waste-management practices to mentee cities.

Gwalior to Get Asia's First Telecom Manufacturing Zone

- Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh is set to emerge as a major telecom manufacturing hub with **Asia's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ).**
- The proposed TMZ involves an investment of approximately ₹5,500 crore and is expected to generate over 18,000 direct jobs.
- **The site has been identified at Shrimant Madhavrao Scindia Counter Magnet City (SADA), Gwalior.**
- SADA was established as a Counter Magnet City to promote Gwalior as an industrial centre and **reduce development pressure on Delhi.**

Jharkhand

Jharkhand celebrates Karam festival with cultural programmes and traditional rituals

- **Karam festival**, a vibrant celebration of **Jharkhand's rich tribal culture, nature and the bond between brothers and sisters**, is being observed across the state on 22nd September 2026.

- Karam festival is considered a symbol of crop protection, respect for nature, and the enduring bond between brothers and sisters.
- On this occasion**, sisters observe a Nirjala fast, praying for the well-being and long life of their brothers.**
- It is traditionally celebrated on the **Ekadashi tithi (eleventh day) of the lunar fortnight in the month of Bhado/ Bhadra**, which corresponds to August-September in the Gregorian calendar.
- **Devotees come with jawa (hibiscus) flowers, and the pahan (priest) worships the Karam Raja.**
- Dancing and singing of traditional Karam songs follow.
- The festival concludes with the immersion of the Karam branch in a river or pond, and the jawa is distributed among the devotees.
- Towards the end of the Karam festival, **branches from sal or bhelua trees are often planted in the fields with the hope that the Karam Raja/ Devta will protect their crops,**

Jharkhand's traditional musical instrument Mandar gets Geographical Indication tag



- Jharkhand's **traditional folk percussion instrument**, the **'Mandar', has officially been granted the Geographical Indication (GI)** tag by the Geographical Indications Registry in Chennai.
- A traditional, **centuries-old double-headed barrel/cylindrical folk drum** (percussion instrument) crafted primarily from red clay and leather, recognized as one of the oldest musical heritage instruments of eastern India.

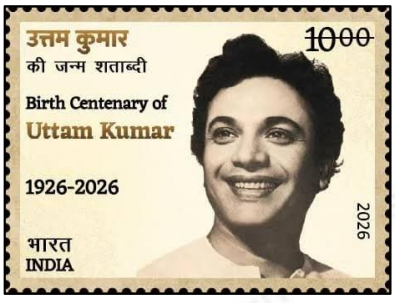
Odisha

India's 51st Doppler Weather Radar Inaugurated in Sambalpur

- India's **51st Doppler Weather Radar was inaugurated at Sambalpur in Odisha .**
- The radar is located at Jamadarpali in Sambalpur and functions as a **Make in India installation under Mission Mausam.**
- A Doppler Weather Radar is a **meteorological instrument that uses the Doppler effect to measure the movement of precipitation particles and wind within clouds.**
- It is used for **short-range weather monitoring, storm tracking**, and rainfall estimation.
- The Sambalpur radar provides meteorological data within a **250 km radius and has a 150-metre resolution.**
- The system updates observations every 10 minutes and is the third Doppler radar in Odisha after Paradip and Gopalpur.
- The new radar covers 13 districts in western Odisha and extends its observation area to parts of Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand.

West Bengal

Foundation laid for Film Centre and commemorative postage stamp released to mark legendary actor Uttam Kumar's birth centenary



- West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari laid the foundation stone of the **Uttam Kumar Film Centre near Eco Park in the New Town area in Kolkata .**

- The state government has allocated Rs 25 crore for the project, which will **have two theatres with a seating capacity of 750 each and another with 1,000 seats.**
- The Centre will also house laboratories and studios for animation and visual effects, besides facilities for film post-production.

Sikkim

Rangeet River

- Sikkim will organise a **three-day river festival** on the banks of **the Rangeet river near Jorethang** late this month, , seeking to blend **catch-and-release fishing with river conservation, adventure tourism and local culture.**
- The Rangeet, or Rangit**, is a major tributary of the Teesta River, the largest river in Sikkim.**
- It **originates from a glacier of Mount Kabru** at the lower Kanchenjunga region.
- Rangeet is fed by the melting snow of the Himalayas in early summer and the monsoon rains in June-September.
- The river joins the **Teesta at Teesta Bazaar on the periphery of West Bengal and Sikkim.**
- During its final few kilometres, it forms the boundary between the Sikkim and Darjeeling districts of West Bengal.
- The Rangeet Dam is built on this river, which started operating in 2000.

Assam

Assam Cabinet approves Rules for compulsory Muslim marriage registration

- The Assam Cabinet approved a rule that makes **registration of Muslim marriages compulsory in the State.**
- **The Assam Muslim Marriage Registration (Compulsory) Rules, 2026**, operationalise the registration framework under the Assam Compulsory Registration of Muslim Marriages and Divorces Act, 2024, which **replaced a piece of legislation enacted in 1935**
- **The colonial-era Assam Muslim Marriage and Divorce Registration Act** had provided for **voluntary registration**, although a 2010 amendment made registration compulsory.
- According to the new law, **the woman must be at least 18 years old and the man 21 years old at the time of marriage.**
- The 2024 Act also shifted the registration process from licensed Muslim registrars or qazis to government registration officials.

Union Minister Jyotiraditya M. Scindia Launches The Trailer of Documentary Series

- Union Minister for the Development of North-East Region Jyotiraditya M. Scindia launches the trailer of Documentary Series 'The Enchanting 8: A Culinary Journey Through the Northeast' in New Delhi.
- The documentary series brings the rich culinary traditions, diverse communities, and vibrant cultural heritage of the eight states of Northeast India into sharp national focus.
- The documentary series takes viewers on a food-led journey across all eight Northeastern States, exploring the region through its cuisine, communities, and people.

Arunachal Pradesh

Attunli Hydroelectric Project

- The **Expert Appraisal Committee (EAC) for River Valley and Hydroelectric Projects** recently recommended environmental clearance for SJVN Limited's 680 MW Attunli Hydroelectric Project in **Dibang Valley district of Arunachal Pradesh.**
- It is a **680 MW run-of-river hydropower project** in the Dibang Valley district of Arunachal Pradesh.
- The project envisages an 85-metre concrete gravity dam across the Tangon (Talo) river, along with a 7.955 km head race tunnel, a 93-metre surge shaft, and twin pressure shafts.
- It is **expected to generate around 2,728 million units annually.**
- The project was initially conceived by Attunli Hydro Electric Power Company Limited, **a joint venture of Jindal Power and the Hydro Power Development Corporation of Arunachal Pradesh**, before **being allotted to Satluj Jal Vidyut Nigam (SJVN).**
- SJVN is a collaborative venture between the **government of India and the state government of Himachal Pradesh.**

Arunachal's Keyi Panyor plans to be India's first 'bio-happy district'

- Arunachal Pradesh's Keyi Panyor, **one of India's youngest districts, is being developed as the country's first 'bio-happy district'.**
- The initiative revives the concept of "**Biohappiness", coined by legendary agricultural scientist M.S. Swaminathan**, and aims to build a sustainable development model rooted in ecology, livelihoods, and public health.
- The Bio-Happy District project will **study local farming systems, traditional knowledge, and biodiversity-rich landscapes of the region.**

Nagaland

Raja Mircha

- In a recent post, Nagaland Tourism and Higher Education Minister shared a video of chillies and had a **hilarious warning for anyone brave enough to try Raja Mircha.**
- Raja Mircha, also known as **Naga King Chilli or Bhut Jolokia**, is a variety of chilli pepper cultivated mainly in Nagaland state.
- It is counted among the **world's hottest chillies and is known for its extraordinary pungency and intense, fruity aroma.**
- **It ranks among the top 10 hottest chillies in the world.**
- The chilli changes colour from green to a vibrant red as it matures.
- It became the first chilli variety from Nagaland and the **first product of any kind from the state to receive a GI tag, in 2008.**
- The GI tag makes the name "Naga Mircha" exclusive to chillies grown in the region

Manipur

Traditional Heikru Hidongba Boat Race Festival Celebrated in Manipur

- **The Heikru Hidongba festival**, popularly known as the **traditional boat race festival**, was celebrated in the valley districts of Manipur.
- The festival is celebrated on the 11th day of the **Manipur calendar month 'Langban' (September) to bring prosperity to the community.**

- Before the boat race, religious rituals were performed, along with paying obeisance to God for bountiful blessings.

Mizoram

Mizoram launches statewide school cleanliness competition, 'Mizoram Green Schools League'

- Mizoram launched a statewide school cleanliness competition, the **'Mizoram Green Schools League',** aimed at inculcating habits of hygiene and **environmental responsibility among students.**
- The competition, jointly organised **by the Urban Development and Poverty Alleviation (UD&PA) and School Education departments under the Swachh Bharat Mission 2.0,** will be held at the block, district and state levels.



Mizoram's Saitual Becomes First District in State to Achieve 'Surakshit' HIV Status

- North-eastern **Mizoram's Saitual,** bordering Manipur, has become the only district in Mizoram to **attain 'Surakshit' status** under the National AIDS Control Organisation (NACO)'s Mobilisation AIDS Suraksha (MAS) campaign after **achieving all three of the 95-95-95 HIV treatment** and prevention targets.
- Under the UNAIDS-linked 95-95-95 targets, **95% of all people estimated to be living with HIV should know their status, 95% of those diagnosed should receive antiretroviral therapy (ART), and 95% of those on treatment should achieve viral load suppression**.
- Districts under the MAS campaign are classified into **four categories** based on their performance: **Sangharshee** for those yet to achieve any of the three targets, **Saksham** for those meeting two**, Surakshit** for those achieving all three, and **Surakshit+ for districts that also achieve zero mother-to-child transmission of HIV.**
- The MAS campaign, launched in February, aims to break the chain of HIV transmission by achieving the 95-95-95 goals across the country.

Mizoram launches first 'Pluck & Pay' festival to boost rural tourism

- Mizoram has launched its **first 'Pluck & Pay' festival in Khawzawl district** in the eastern part of the state, offering visitors an **opportunity to harvest farm produce themselves and pay farmers directly** as the state seeks to expand tourism-led livelihood opportunities in rural communities
- **The three-day festival, being held from September 23 to 25**

Rajasthan

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla pays respect to Amrita Devi Bishnoi and martyrs protecting Khejri trees in Khejadli village of Rajasthan

- Recently, Lok Sabha Speaker has **paid respects to Amrita Devi Bishnoi and all the martyrs** who laid down their lives for the **protection of Khejri trees in Khejadli village of Rajasthan during the 18th century.**
- Khejri is considered a **sacred tree in Rajasthan.**
- It is also called jant or janti in areas like Alwar, Sikar, Jhunjhunu,
- **Khejri is called the state tree of Rajasthan.**

- It is found growing in **arid and semi-arid parts of Rajasthan, Gujarat, Haryana, Punjab, Delhi** and some parts of southern India
- The tree is frost and drought resistant and tolerates extreme temperatures ranging from 40–45 0C in summer to less than 10 0C in winter.
- It is capable of growing in areas of rainfall ranging from 100–600 mm.
- The tree can **withstand the hottest winds, the driest season and stay alive where other plants cannot survive.**
- It is a deciduous tree with finely divided, feathery leaves and small yellow flowers.
- It is a **nitrogen-fixing tree which enhances the fertility of the soil.**
- The fruit is used to make the very **popular local dish 'Sangri'**
- **The bark of this tress is used medicinally for a range of ailments.**

Gujarat

Ministry Launches Hub-and-Spoke Flights from Ahmedabad

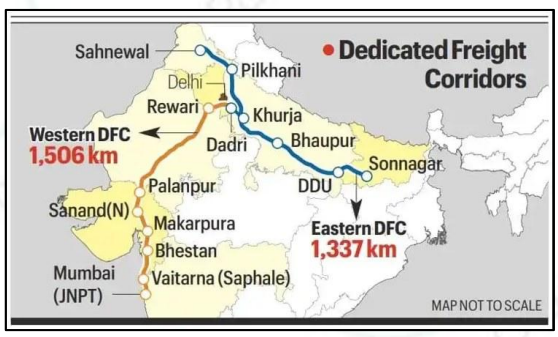
- **Ahmedabad became the third Indian city to be equipped with hub-and-spoke international flight services** as the services were launched from Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport (SVPI)
- The other **two cities that offer the services are Amritsar and Varanasi.**
- 'hub and spoke' is an airline operational system under which **passengers from smaller cities (spokes) are brought to a major central airport (hub), where they are transferred to connecting international flights**.
- Under this facility, **all baggage, customs and immigration-related checks of passengers will be completed at the originating airport itself,** eliminating the need for repeated security checks or check-in at the hub airport.
- Automated baggage transfer and simplified procedures will save passengers' time and reduce airlines' operating costs.

Gujarat to host 11th Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit in January next year

- The 11th Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit 2027 will take place from 10th to 12th January 2027 in Gandhinagar.
- The theme of this summit is **Viksit Gujrat – Shaping Global future**

India to Host World Circular Economy Forum 2026 in Gandhinagar from Sep 15-18

- India will host the **World Circular Economy Forum 2026 at Gandhinagar in Gujarat**, from 15th to 18th September.
- The forum will be organised under the theme **"Circular Economy: Transition for People and Prosperity."**
- The forum will enable **global collaboration and greater engagement with the Global South**, facilitate the mobilisation of circular finance and private-sector investment, encourage policy dialogue and cross-sectoral partnerships, and advance innovation, digitalisation and technology for circularity.



The Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC)

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated in Vadodara were **the last three sections of the Western Dedicated Freight**

Corridor (WDFC), together covering 326 kilometres and developed at a cost of over Rs 20,700 crore.

- These three sections between **Gujarat and Maharashtra — New Sanand (N)-**New Makarpura, New Umbergaon-New Saphale, New Saphale-New **Jawaharlal Nehru Port Trust (JNPT) — mark the completion of the 1,506-km WDFC**, which runs from **JNPT in Navi Mumbai to Dadri (Uttar Pradesh) near Delhi.**
- DFC, special freight corridors, are one of the biggest infrastructure projects undertaken by the Railways.
- **The 1,337-km EDFC runs from Ludhiana (Punjab) to Sonnagar (Bihar), and caters mostly to coal and mineral traffic from eastern India.**

Alternative fuel for Railways: After Hydrogen, India gets its first LNG-powered train

- After launching the country' first hydrogen train on July 17, 2026, Indian Railways has now **introduced another alternative-fuel train based on Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG).**
- The LNG-powered train was **launched from Sabarmati in Gujarat on September 27.**
- The new train uses a **LNG-diesel dual-fuel system, allowing its engine to run on both LNG and diesel.**
- the first LNG-diesel dual-fuel DEMU train operates **between Sabarmati and Mahesana Junction**

LNG train in India

- The **new LNG train follows the hydrogen train as another alternative-fuel railway project**.
- The LNG train **is not a completely LNG-only train**. It uses a dual-fuel system, **meaning the same engine can operate using both LNG and diesel.**
- The system can use LNG to replace around 40 per cent of diesel consumption.
- The LNG system is expected to reduce fuel costs as well as emissions of **CO_2, NOx and particulate matter.**

India's first port-based e-methanol plant to come up in Gujarat's Kandla

- the government laid the foundation stone for **its first port-based e-methanol production facility at Kandla, Gujarat involving an investment of ₹2,300 crore.**
- **E-Methanol - A low-carbon e-fuel produced using renewable energy, green hydrogen and recycled CO_2.**
- Applications: Shipping, heavy industry and chemical manufacturing.

Maharashtra

Shri Amit Shah will address the inaugural session of Hindi Diwas 2026 and the 6th All India Official Language Conference in Mumbai

- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah will inaugurate Hindi Diwas 2026 and address the **6th All India Official Language Conference in Mumbai on September 14.**
- The two-day conference will bring together **scholars, litterateurs, educationists, Members of Parliament, senior government officials and distinguished personalities** from various fields to deliberate on the development of **Hindi as the Official Language, people's language and link language,** besides its coordination with other Indian languages.
- **Amit Shah will present the Rajbhasha Gaurav and Rajbhasha Kirti Awards for 2025-26.**
- The awards will honour institutions and individuals who have made outstanding contributions to the field of Official Language.

Books, publications and exhibition

- Several books and publications will be launched during the conference, including a special commemorative issue of the **Department of Official Language's journal Rajbhasha Bharati, centred on Vande Mataram.**

- Other publications include Bharatiya Gyan Tantra: Srot aur Swaroop, Shiv Anadi Hain, Anant Hain, and Andheron Se Ujalon Tak, a compilation of writings by prison inmates.

11th Ayurveda Day 2026 to be Celebrated in Nagpur

- The 11th Ayurveda Day celebrations will be held on 23 September 2026 in **Nagpur, Maharashtra.**
- with "**Ayurveda for a Healthier Tomorrow**" **'स्वस्थ भविष्य के लिए आयुर्वेद' as its theme.**
- reflecting the vision of connecting India's rich Ayurvedic heritage with the evolving healthcare needs of the future.

PM Modi to inaugurate and address the Global Fintech Fest – GFF 2026 in Mumbai

- In Mumbai, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated **Seventh edition Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026, being held from 8th to 11th September 2026**
- The theme of GFF 2026 is "**Potential to Impact: Agentic AI, Tokenisation, Quantum – Trusted, Connected, Global Systems for Inclusive Finance."**
- GFF 2026 has been designed as a convergence point for policy, regulation, technology, capital and industry on a common platform.

Barakuru

- A historically significant **Siditale hero stone has been recently discovered at Barakuru** during an epigraphical survey of the **Panchalingeshwara Temple.**
- Barakuru, also known as Barkur, is an ancient **historical port town located in Udupi district, Karnataka.**
- It is situated on the banks of the river Sita. The town is about 5 km east of the Arabian Sea Coast.
- The place was called by several names in ancient times as Varakula, Barakanur, and Barahkanyapura.
- **The port town was a busy commercial centre almost from the 2nd century B.C.**
- Evidence of Megalithic and Mesolithic ages has been discovered recently.
- The maritime port enjoyed massive economic prosperity, trading extensively with foreign nations across the wide Arabian Sea.
- The Alupa rulers converted this commercial centre into a political centre by making it their capital during the 10th-11th centuries A.D.
- In later times, **the city became the provincial headquarters of the Hoysalas and then the Vijayanagara Empire.**
- The town's main attractions are the temples with typical tiled roofs.
- Barkur was also a Jain settlement in the ancient days.

16th Aero India to be held in Bengaluru from February 8-12, 2027

- The 16th edition of Aero India**, Asia's largest air show and one of the world's leading aerospace and defence exhibitions**, will be held at Air Force Station Yelahanka in Bengaluru from February 8 to 12, 2027.
- Organised by the **Department of Defence Production under the Ministry of Defence (MoD)**
- the five-day event is expected to bring together leading global aerospace and defence companies, policymakers, technology experts, innovators, industry representatives and defence personnel.

Postage stamp on Gooty Fort

- The Union Ministry of Communications and Department of Posts recently forwarded the **proposal** for a **commemorative postage stamp on Gooty Fortit to the Union Minister of Communications for final approval.**
- Gooty Fort, also known as **Ravadurg and Gutti Kota,** is an ancient hilltop fortress located in the town of Gooty in the **Anantapur district of Andhra Pradesh**
- Inscriptions found here appear to be from the reign of the **Western Chalukya king Vikramaditya VI Tribhuvanamalla (1076 CE – 1126 CE).**
- It was also the **site of a major battle between the Western Chalukyas and the Cholas under Vira Rajendra** (1063 CE – 1070 CE) when the latter laid siege to the fort.
- The area later was taken over by the Vijayanagar empire and once was the abode of one of the most powerful Hindu rulers of all time, Krishnadevaraya.
- **The Qutb Shahi dynasty succeeded the Vijayanagar empire** and **subsequently fell into the hands of the Mughals when their capital of Golconda was annexed.**
- With the onset of the British invasion of India, the important fort fell into the hands of the British East India Company.
- **It is a blend of Hindu-Islamic architecture**.
- It was made of granite rocks, and the domes were constructed with fine stone, mortar, and lime, ensuring sustainability.
- **Built in the shape of a shell, this fort actually comprises 15 small forts with different gateways**.
- There are several temples within the fort, like the Lakshmi Narasimha Temple, Nageswara Swami Temple, Hanuman Temple, Jyothimma Temple, and the Ramaswamy Temple.
- There is also a Dargah inside the fortification.

FICCI FRAMES 2026 Begins in Mumbai

- FICCI FRAMES 2026, the **26th edition of Asia's media and entertainment convention,** is being held on 29-30 September 2026 at the **Grand Hyatt in Mumbai, Maharashtra.**
- The theme **"India's Media Moment: Creating Value in an Age of Infinite Content"**
- FICCI FRAMES is an annual convention organised by the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry for the media and entertainment sector.

Short News

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated **the 'Ganesh Gyanarthi Exhibition'** organised by the Asiatic Society of Mumbai, calling for the preservation, digitisation and wider dissemination of India's rich knowledge traditions.

Goa

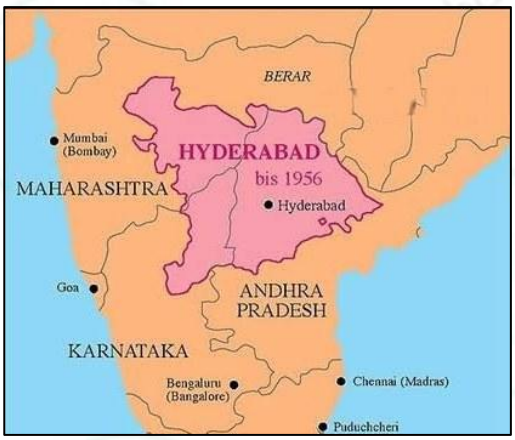
Amit Shah chairs 28th Western Zonal Council meeting in Goa

- A key meeting of the Western Zonal Council was held in Panaji, with Union Home Minister Amit Shah chairing its 28th meeting.
- The Western Zonal Council comprises Goa, Gujarat and Maharashtra, along with the Union Territory of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

- Five zonal councils, including the Western Zonal Council, were established under **sections 15 to 22 of the States Reorganisation Act, 1956.**
- Mr. Shah is the chairman of the Western Zonal Council, while the Goa Chief Minister is its current vice-chairman.
- **The vice-chairmanship rotates annually among the Chief Ministers of the member states.**
- The council has a Standing Committee at the level of chief secretaries.

Telangana

17 September Hyderabad Liberation Day



- marking the integration of the **erstwhile Hyderabad State into the Indian Union in 1948.**
- The princely state of **Hyderabad**, ruled by the **Nizam Mir Osman Ali Khan**, was the largest princely state in India at the time of Independence (1947).
- The Nizam resisted accession to India, supported by his militia, the **Razakars**, who indulged in violence and communal atrocities.
- India could not allow an independent Hyderabad in the heart of the country due to **strategic and security concerns**.
- On **13 September 1948**, the Indian Army launched **"Operation Polo"** (also called the **Hyderabad Police Action**).
- **Within five days**, on **17 September 1948**, Hyderabad surrendered, and the state was integrated into India.

Andhra Pradesh

SHORT NEWS

- The NTR District, Andhra PradeshCollector G. Lakshmisha launched 'Operation Trishul' to create a safer environment by targeting three major areas: combating drug use, preventing road accidents, and checking crimes against women.

Karnataka

Karnataka Cabinet Approves Tulu as Second Administrative Language in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi

- The Karnataka Cabinet approved **Tulu as the state's second additional administrative language for Dakshina Kannada and Udupi districts.**
- The decision was announced after a Cabinet meeting in Mangaluru, and the **government fixed an annual allocation of Rs 82 lakh for translation and training linked to administrative use of Tulu.**
- **Tulu is a Dravidian language with a recorded history of more than 2,000 years.**
- It is spoken by about one crore people globally, with **major usage in the undivided Dakshina Kannada and Udupi region of coastal Karnataka.**
- Gondhal becomes the **fourth Marathi-language film to be selected as India's official Oscar entry.**
- It follows **Shwaas (2005), Harishchandrachi Factory (2009) and Court (2015).**

- Last year, **Neeraj Ghaywan's Homebound**, starring Ishaan Khatter, Vishal Jethwa and Janhvi Kapoor, was **chosen as India's official entry but did not make the Academy's shortlist.**
- The 99th Academy Awards are scheduled to take place on March 14, 2027, at the Dolby Theatre in Los Angeles.

What is Gondhal about?

- Set in **rural Maharashtra**, Gondhal unfolds over a **single night against the backdrop of the traditional midnight Gondhal ritual**, a performance that brings together music, dance, mythology and religious elements.

Rising cost of metals, falling demand spell trouble for Bidriware

- Recently, it was observed that **Bidriware, the centuries-old metal craft, is facing fresh pressure from the rising prices of silver, copper, and zinc.**
- It is a form of **metal handicraft which has been made for centuries by artisans from Karnataka's Bidar district.**
- It is renowned for its intricate, handcrafted designs.
- It has obtained a **Geographical Indications (GI) tag.**
- The origin of Bidriware as a craft is attributed mostly to the **Bahamani Sultans who ruled the region during the 14th and 15th centuries.**
- It was first brought to India by the **noted Sufi Khwaja Moinuddin Hasan Chisti in the form of utensils.**
- The art form developed in the kingdom was a **mix of Turkish, Persian and Arabic influences**, which were intermingled with the local styles, and thus a unique style of its own was born
- **It is made primarily from a zinc-copper alloy, while silver is used for intricate inlay work.**
- Craftsmen engrave delicate floral and geometric patterns on the surface and inlay silver into them.



- Fine wire or flattened strips of pure silver are then carefully hammered into these grooves.

GI-Tagged Gulbarga Tur Dal Exported to Maldives from Karnataka

- **The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority** facilitated the **export of GI-tagged Gulbarga Tur Dal from Karnataka to the Maldives.**
- **Gulbarga Tur Dal is associated with the Kalaburagi region of Karnataka.**
- The product **received Geographical Indication registration in 2019** under India's GI framework for region-specific goods.

Short news

- The Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) launched **'e-Aasthi 2.0', an upgraded property-record and e-Khata management system** aimed at simplifying property-related services, reducing paperwork and physical visits to government offices.

Kerala

Hazard Perception Test

- Kerala will become the **first State in India to introduce a mandatory computer-based Hazard Perception Test (HPT) for driving licence applicants** from December 2026.
- **A computer-based road-safety assessment** that uses **simulated traffic situations** to test whether driving licence **applicants can identify potential hazards** at the appropriate time.
- The provision for such an assessment already exists under the Central Motor Vehicles Rules.
- Aim: To move driver testing beyond knowledge of traffic rules and **vehicle handling towards real-world hazard recognition, anticipation and safer decision-making.**

Key Features:

- Applicants **must clear HPT within 30 days of passing the learner's test** before appearing for ground and road tests.
- **The test consists of 10 one-minute videos**, each depicting at **least two potential road hazards**.
- Candidates must **identify hazards by pressing a button at the appropriate moment**; delayed or missed identification leads to loss of marks.
- **Each correct response carries 10 marks,** with candidates required to **score at least 60 out of 100 to qualify.**

Paniya Tribe



- The Kerala State Human Rights Commission recently directed authorities to **urgently rehabilitate Paniya tribal families** living in makeshift tarpaulin shelters at **Vaniyampuzha, across the Chaliyar River** in Pothukal panchayat, Kerala.
- **The Paniya (Paniyan) tribe is one of the major Scheduled Tribes of Kerala.**
- They are predominantly **found in Wayanad and also in parts of the Kannur, Kozhikode, and Malappuram** districts of Kerala.
- The Paniya community is the **largest single scheduled tribe population in Kerala.**
- The word "Paniyan" is derived from "pani" which is a Malayalam word, meaning work.
- The **people of this tribal community are majorly labourers**, and their past history also suggests the same
- In the contemporary period, **Paniyan tribes own their individual lands and also produce crops like rice and ragi.**
- The Paniya speak the Paniya language, which belongs to the Dravidian family, closely related to Malayalam.
- There is a **resemblance between the Paniya people with the people of Africa,** and as per some scholars, the Paniya people are of African origin.
- **According to some scholars, Kapiri (Africa or the Cape) is the land of origin of the Paniyan tribes.**
- They have developed a unique style of making their houses.
- A Paniyan village comprises rows of huts all constructed from bamboo with thatched roofs.
- **These houses of Paniyan tribes are either single- or double-storied.**
- **The Paniyas worship a deity called Kali and banyan tree.**



Tamil Nadu

17th Kathakali Festival Inaugurated at Kalakshetra Foundation in Chennai

- The 17th Kathakali Festival, organised by the **Kalakshetra Foundation under the aegis of the Ministry of Culture**, Government of India was inaugurated at the **Bharata Kalakshetra Auditorium, Thiruvanmiyur, Chennai.**
- The three-day festival, themed **"Kadha Rasa Sangama – Confluence of Essence of Stories",**
- Brings together three prominent Kathakali institutions—**Sadanam Academy, Kerala Kalamandalam and Margi Theatre**—to present three distinctive productions from 18 to 20 September 2026.
- **Established in 1936 by Rukmini Devi Arundale, the Kalakshetra Foundation** has played a significant role in the preservation, practice and dissemination of India's classical arts and traditional cultural heritage.

Vice President releases commemorative postage stamp marking 75 years of Dinamalar in Chennai



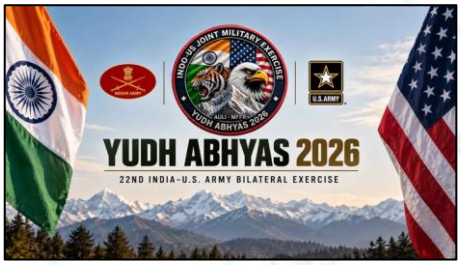
- Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan released a commemorative postage stamp to mark the **75th anniversary of Tamil daily Dinamalar.**
- the newspaper was founded in **1951 by T. V. Ramasubbaiyer**

Defence

Army

22nd India-US Yudh Abhyas Begins in Two-Theatre Format

- The 22nd edition of Yudh Abhyas, the **annual India-US bilateral military exercise, is scheduled from 9 September to 28 September 2026.**
- The exercise is being conducted in a **two-theatre format across Bikaner in Rajasthan and Auli in Uttarakhand.**
- Yudh Abhyas is a recurring military exercise between the Indian Army and the United States Army.
- **Yudh Abhyas began in 2004**
- The exercise is used for joint training in tactical drills, interoperability, and field operations in varied terrain.
- **The Mahajan Field Firing Ranges are located in Rajasthan and are used for desert warfare training.**



- **Auli in Uttarakhand is a high-altitude training area used for mountain warfare exercises.**

Rudra Raptors Exercise

- The **Indian Army's Konark Corps** recently conducted the **'Rudra Raptors' exercise in Jaisalmer.**
- It is a high-intensity joint military exercise conducted by the Konark Corps of the Indian Army.
- **It was conducted in the forward areas of the desert sector in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan.**
- Theme: **"One team, one purpose, absolute battlefield dominance"**
- The exercise witnessed **joint integrated training and active participation from the elite helicopters of 'Thar Raptors' such as AH-64E Apaches, and tanks of the 'Black Mace' Brigade.**

- Black Mace Brigade is the Rudra all-arms formation under Konark Corps, which the Army validated during **Exercise Akhand Prahar in 2025 as a combined-arms unit grouping armour**, mechanised infantry, artillery, air defence, and support elements under one headquarters.

Exercise Super Garuda Shield

- The **United States and Indonesia kicked off their annual joint military drills, Super Garuda Shield**, spanning until September 11 across multiple Indonesian regions.
- Super Garuda Shield is a **flagship annual multilateral joint military exercise hosted by the Indonesian National Armed Forces (TNI)** and co-led by the **United States Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM).**
- **Originally established in 2006 as a bilateral army exchange (Garuda Shield)**
- Participating & Observer Nations: 13 additional international partners, including Japan, South Korea, Australia, Canada, the United Kingdom, France, Singapore, and others across the Indo-Pacific and NATO partner networks.

India-Mongolia Exercise Nomadic Elephant Begins in Pithoragarh



- The **18th edition of the Exercise Nomadic Elephant 2026** commenced at the **Foreign Training Node in Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand.**
- It is an annual joint military exercise conducted alternatively in India and Mongolia.
- **The last edition of the exercise was conducted at Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia.**

60-member Indian Armed Forces contingent departs for KAZIND-2026 in Kazakhstan

- A 60-member contingent of the **Indian Armed Forces has departed for Oskemen, Kazakhstan**, to participate in the **ninth edition of the India-Kazakhstan Joint Military Exercise KAZIND-2026**.
- The exercise is scheduled to be conducted from September 28 to October 11, 2026.
- **The Indian contingent comprises primarily personnel from a battalion of the Garhwal Rifles**
- KAZIND-2026 will focus on **joint counter-terrorism operations in semi-urban and mountainous terrain**,

Air Force

Exercise Veer Guardian

- The **Japanese Self-Defense Force (JASDF) contingent recently touched down in Jodhpur ahead of Exercise Veer Guardian 2026.**
- Dates : 09 Sep to 22 Sep 26.
- It is a **bilateral air exercise between the Indian Air Force and the Japanese Air Self-Defense Force (JASDF).**
- The first edition of the exercise was held in 2023 at Hyakuri Air Base, Japan.
- **Location: Jodhpur, Rajasthan**
- It will focus on improving the tactical proficiency of participating units and deepening mutual understanding between the two air forces.
- **Japan is participating with three F-2A fighter aircraft from the 8th Air Wing at Tsuiki Air Base, along with approximately 110 personnel.**
- This is the first time that the Mitsubishi F-2 fighter aircraft will participate in an exercise in India

IAF Sarang Team Reaches Egypt for El Alamein Airshow

- The **Indian Air Force (IAF) Sarang Helicopter Display Team** arrived in Egypt on 6 September 2026 for the **second edition of the El Alamein International Airshow.**
- The airshow is scheduled from **8 to 10 September 2026 at El Alamein International Airport in Egypt.**
- The Sarang Helicopter Display Team is the world's only five-helicopter display team. **It operates the indigenously manufactured Advanced Light Helicopter (ALH) Dhruv**, which is built in India for military and utility roles.
- The Sarang team is set to perform its signature manoeuvre called the **Dolphin Leap and a new aerial manoeuvre named the Spot Stall Turn**

Dronathon 2026 to Test IAF Drone Warfare

- The Indian Air Force (IAF) will organise Dronathon-2026 at the **Pokhran range in Jaisalmer, Rajasthan, from 14 September to 16 September 2026.**
- The three-day military aviation event will focus on Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAS) and Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems (CUAS) for defence applications.
- **Unmanned Aerial Systems are aircraft systems that operate without an onboard human pilot.**
- UAS usually include the air vehicle, ground control station, communication links, and payloads such as cameras, sensors, or weapons.

IAF to Host Second Edition of Tarang Shakti

- The Indian Air Force (IAF) will host the second edition of the **multinational air exercise Tarang Shakti at Jodhpur** in Rajasthan from 26 September to 12 October 2026.
- More than 40 countries are expected to take part in the exercise, and over 30 countries are expected to send delegates or observers.
- Tarang Shakti is a **multinational air exercise conducted by the Indian Air Force.**
- The exercise brings together air forces from multiple countries for **joint training, operational familiarisation, and coordination in air operations.**
- Indian Air Force will **deploy Rafale and Sukhoi-30 fighter jets, airborne early warning** and control aircraft, transport aircraft, and air-to-air refuelling tankers.

Mission Pegase 26

- As part of Mission Pégase 26, the French Air and Space Force recently **deployed four Rafale F4 fighters, three A330 MRTT Phénix multi-role tanker transport aircraft, and two A400M Atlas aircraft to Jodhpur.**
- **Mission Pegase 26 is the seventh edition of France's long-range air projection exercise.**
- It is being conducted from September 8 to October 15.
- Route: Greenland, Canada, Alaska, Japan, South Korea, Indonesia, India, Qatar, Réunion, and then Egypt.
- **Pegase 26 is following a route linking the Arctic, Indo-Pacific, and Middle East.**
- Stated aims: Operational readiness, strategic partnerships, freedom of air navigation.
- **India is a key stop on the Indo-Pacific leg of Pegase 26.**
- **In India, the French contingent will participate in Tarang Shakti**

Navy

INS Mysore Joins Samudra Laksamana 4/26 in Malaysia

- Indian Naval Ship (INS) Mysore arrived recently at Lumut Naval Base in Malaysia to participate in the **bilateral exercise Samudra Laksamana.**
- It is a joint naval exercise between the **Indian Navy and the Royal Malaysian Navy (RMB).**
- The 4/26 edition is the fourth iteration of the exercise and includes **professional interactions, tactical briefings, and cross-ship visits.**
- The exercise aims to strengthen bonds and enhance interoperability between the Indian and Royal Malaysian Navy.
- **INS Mysore, along with RMN Ships KD Lekir and KD Gagah Samudera**, will participate in the 2026 edition of the exercise.

About INS Mysore

- INS Mysore (D60) is a **Delhi-class guided missile destroyer of the Indian Navy.**
- It was built at **Mazagon Dock Limited in Mumbai. It was commissioned on 2 June 1999.**

INDIA - SRI LANKA ANNUAL BILATERAL MARITIME EXERCISE (SLINEX-26)

- The 13th edition of the India-Sri Lanka bilateral maritime exercise, **SLINEX-26, is underway at Visakhapatnam** from September 17 to 21, with the Indian and Sri Lankan navies participating in the exercise.
- **The exercise began with the Harbour Phase and will be followed by the Sea Phase.**
- The Indian Navy is participating with **INS Kavaratti, an indigenous Anti-Submarine Warfare Corvette, and INS Jyoti, the Fleet Tanker.** The Sri Lanka Navy is represented by SLNS Sindurala.
- **Conceptualised in 2005**, SLINEX has evolved into an important platform for strengthening maritime cooperation, interoperability and mutual understanding between the two navies.
- **The Harbour Phase is being conducted under the aegis of the Eastern Naval Command.**

The 24th edition of India-France Maritime Exercise Varuna 2026

- **INS Trishul arrived at Toulon, France**, on 22 Sep 2026 to participate in the **24th edition** of the **bilateral maritime exercise 'VARUNA' between the Indian Navy and the French Navy.**
- **The exercise series began in 1983 and received the name "Varuna" in 2001.**
- Toulon is a **major French naval base on the Mediterranean coast** and serves as a key port for French naval operations.

Other Countries Missile, Test & Exercises

Patriot Missile System

- **Lockheed Martin** recently announced it received a **shipment of critical components from General Motors** for Patriot interceptors, emphasizing the urgency to ramp up production amid ongoing international conflicts.
- Patriot, short for Phased Array Tracking Radar for Intercept on Target, **is a mobile surface-to-air missile defense system**.
- It was originally developed by **U.S. weapons maker Raytheon Technologies.**
- The system **can intercept aircraft, tactical ballistic missiles, and cruise missiles,** depending on the interceptor used.
- The system was **first used in combat during the 1991 Gulf War**, with batteries protecting Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, and Israel, and later used during the U.S. invasion of Iraq in 2003.

- **Nineteen countries now operate the Patriot system, including the U.S., Germany, Poland, Ukraine, Japan, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and Egypt.**

US Navy Selects VAMPIRE System for Coastal Defence

- The United States Navy selected the **VAMPIRE counter-unmanned system for coastal and littoral defence**.
- VAMPIRE stands for **Vehicle-Agnostic Modular Palletized ISR Rocket Equipment** and is developed **by L3Harris Technologies,** a defence company headquartered in Melbourne, Florida.
- The system is used for **kinetic engagement against aerial, ground, and sea-based threats with laser-guided rockets.**
- The sensor **supports digital target tracking and laser designation.**
- The system employs 70 mm AGR-20A Advanced Precision Kill Weapon System rockets, which are also known as APKWS rockets.

LORA Missile

- Germany successfully tested **the LORA missile in the North Atlantic overnight, military officials said recently.**
- The LORA (**Long Range Artillery**) is a **short-range, road-mobile, ground- and sea-launched ballistic missile developed and operated by Israel**.
- It is believed to have entered service in Israel in 2007.
- It is designed to **strike high-value targets deep inside enemy territory.**
- It is a single-stage, solid-propellant missile.
- It has a diameter of 0.624 m and a length of 5.2 m, with a launch weight of approximately 1,600 kg.
- It can carry a **payload of up to 600 kg** and can deploy a single high explosive (HE) warhead or submunitions.
- **It has a range of 280 km.**
- It uses Inertial Navigation System/Global Positioning System and TV for terminal guidance, with possible in-flight maneuvering capability

Geran-2

- New satellite imagery is shedding light on **Russia's expanding Geran-2 drone production** at the Alabuga Special Economic Zone in Tatarstan.
- **It is a long-range one-way attack drone, often referred to as a kamikaze drone.**
- It is essentially a domestically manufactured **Russian version of the Iranian-designed Shahed-136.**
- The Geran is mainly used for **long-range strike, both as a primary system and as a low-cost complement** to the much more sophisticated cruise and ballistic missiles.
- **A Shahed/Geran drone costs between €25,000 and €40,000 — a tiny fraction of a ballistic missile.**
- The Geran-2 drones are launched in swarms to maximize the probability of success against strategic infrastructures.

US CENTCOM and Jordan Conduct Exercise Eager Lion 2026

- **Exercise Eager Lion 2026** began on 15 September 2026 at Fort Carson in Colorado.
- **Exercise Eager Lion is a biennial military exercise between the United States and Jordan.**
- Eager Lion 2026 is the **12th iteration of the exercise, and it is the first time that the United States is hosting the drill.**

- **Established in 1993**, the State Partnership Program pairs state National Guards with militaries of other nations to promote global security cooperation.

Combined Exercise

Indian Coast Guard Joins QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission

- **Indian Coast Guard (ICG) ship Shaunak** recently **sailed from Chennai for Perth, Australia**, as part of the QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission, aimed at enhancing maritime interoperability among **India, Australia, Japan, and the United States.**
- ICGS Shaunak is an Indian Coast Guard ship, specifically **an Offshore Patrol Vessel (OPV) of the Samarth-class.**
- It has been designed and built **indigenously by Goa Shipyard Ltd.**
- **ICGS Shaunak was commissioned on February 21, 2017.**
- It is based at Visakhapatnam under the administrative and operational control of the Commander, Coast Guard Region (East).
- It is deployed extensively for EEZ surveillance and other duties to safeguard the maritime interests of India.

QUAD-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission

- It brings together personnel from the four QUAD countries (India, United States, Japan, and Australia) for shipboard activities and professional exchanges.
- It is aimed at enhancing interoperability, improving coordination, and strengthening mutual trust among the maritime forces.

Defence Procurement & MoU

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh Launches India's Advanced Ocean Research Vessel 'ORV Sagar Manthan'

- Union Minister for Earth Sciences Dr Jitendra Singh launched **India's advanced Ocean Research Vessel (ORV) 'Sagar Manthan' at Rishi Bankim Shipyard in Kolkata**,
- The vessel, Yard 3041, has been designed, engineered and constructed by defence public sector **undertaking Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) for the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR) under the Ministry of Earth Sciences.**
- the vessel would gradually **replace the 43-year-old ORV 'Sagar Kanya'**, which was procured from Germany in 1983.
- The new vessel is being constructed under Vertical-4, Deep Ocean Survey and Exploration, of the government's Deep Ocean Mission
- The vessel is **scheduled for delivery in 2028.**

INS Kulish

- Recently, **Indian Navy's guided missile corvette INS Kulish** reached Ream Naval Base in **Cambodia** as part of the **Eastern Fleet's operational deployment.**
- **INS Kulish is a Kora-class corvette of the Indian Navy.**
- The **Kulish meaning is Thunderbolt in Sanskrit.**
- It was built from 1995-2001 and commissioned in 2001.

- Designed by: It has been designed & built within India by Indian shipbuilders **Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers [GRSE].**
- Their primary weapon is the **Russian-origin Kh-35 Anti-Ship Cruise missile.**
- It has state-of-the-art sensors and electronic equipment, and is capable of **operating at extended ranges up to 2,500 nautical miles** without replenishment.
- Displacement Capacity: The ship has a displacement of 1,500 tonnes.
- It is powered by twin diesel engines generating a maximum speed of 25 knots.

Next-Generation Missile Vessels

- The **Cochin Shipyard Limited** recently laid the keel for the **first of six Next Generation Missile Vessels (NGMV)** being built for the Indian Navy, marking the shipbuilder's entry into construction of advanced weapon-intensive platforms.
- The NGMVs are envisaged as **high-speed vessels equipped with an array of weapons and sensors, being built for the Indian Navy.**
- **Delivery of the vessels is scheduled to commence from March 2027.**
- The primary role of the ships would be to provide **offensive capability against enemy warships, merchantmen, and land targets.**
- The vessels are intended **for maritime strike and anti-surface warfare operations and will also provide the Navy with sea-denial capability,** particularly around strategically **important maritime choke points.**
- In defensive operations, the ships are expected to support local naval defence and the protection of offshore development areas.

Indian Air Force conducted a successful drop trial of the indigenously designed and developed Long Range Glide Bomb (LRGB), Khagantak-243

- Recently, the Indian Air Force conducted a successful drop trial of the indigenously designed and **developed Long Range Glide Bomb (LRGB), Khagantak-243.**
- Khagantak-243 is a **300-kg-class airborne long-range stand-off precision-guided glide bomb**.
- Developed By: It is jointly developed by Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) and JSR Dynamics.

Features of Khagantak-243

- It is designed to be **launched from a fighter aircraft and glide towards its target after release.**
- Unlike conventional free-fall bombs, glide bombs allow aircraft to engage targets from a stand-off distance without having to fly directly over them.
- **Range: It can cover a range of 144 km to 180 km when released from an altitude of 12 km at Mach 0.8.**
- The bomb features a cylindrical body, swivel-type mid-body glide wings and five aft control surfaces that help it navigate towards its target.

Hyderabad Startup's Ahuti Mk II Becomes India's Fastest Multirotor UAV



- **Apollyon Dynamics, a defence technology startup** incubated at BITS Pilani Hyderabad Campus, entered the **India Book of Records for developing India's fastest multirotor unmanned aerial vehicle.**

- Its electric interceptor drone, **Ahuti Mk II, recorded a certified top speed of 498 km/h,** which exceeded the earlier Indian multirotor benchmark of 325 km/h.
- A multirotor UAV is an unmanned aerial vehicle that uses multiple rotors for lift and control.
- Ahuti Mk II was designed as **a high-speed interceptor drone rather than a surveillance or photography platform.**

Indian Army Sets Up AASHVAST Lab for Drone Security

- The Indian Army has established a specialised facility in New Delhi to **examine the electronic and software components of military drones, with a particular focus on identifying potential security vulnerabilities** and detecting embedded Chinese components.
- The facility, known as **AASHVAST (Assessment and Analysis of Electronic Systems Hardware for Vulnerabilities and Security Threats).**
- It forms part of efforts to **strengthen the reliability of mission-critical defence electronics and improve their resilience against cyber and electronic threats**.
- AASHVAST has been designed as an air-gapped, read-only facility, meaning the system operates offline and does not write information onto the equipment being examined.

Tata Advanced Systems, Javelin Joint Venture sign pact for co-production of anti-tank missiles in India

- Tata Advanced Systems Limited (TASL) and the Javelin Joint Venture (JJV) — a partnership between Raytheon, an RTX business, and Lockheed Martin — have signed a memorandum of understanding to explore the co-production of the Javelin All Up Round (AUR) missile in India.

Army sets up cyber labs to scan military drones amid Chinese components concerns

- Indian Army to deploy six AASHVAST labs nationwide for mandatory drone and CCTV cybersecurity screening to counter operational vulnerabilities.
- **AASHVAST stands for Assessment and Analysis of Electronic Systems Hardware for Vulnerabilities and Security Threats.**
- It is a specialized testing and validation system developed to examine military electronics for hidden security weaknesses.
- The primary goal is to ensure that critical military systems operate exactly as intended and do not contain unauthorized components or malicious code.
- It is developed by the private firm for the Directorate General of Electronics and Mechanical Engineering (DG EME)

Satellite Smart Anti Airfield Weapon

- Recently, the Ministry of Defence has inked a contract **with Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)** for the procurement of **160 Satellite Smart Anti Airfield Weapons (SAT-SAAW)** along with associated equipment for Indian Air Force (IAF).
- It is an **air-to-ground precision guided glide bomb which can be launched from platforms like Jaguar, Hawk & Su-30 MKI.**
- It has the capability to **neutralise enemy airfields from a long stand-off range.**
- It is indigenously designed and developed by **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).**

- The SAT variant uses **satellite navigation** (GPS/NavIC) integrated with an onboard Inertial Navigation System (INS) **to hit stationary targets with high accuracy (typically within 7 meters)** in all weather conditions, day or night.
- **The SAT-SAAW will be delivered between 2027-2028 and 2028-2029.**

Japan calls on India to fast-track internal process on UNICORN naval radar agreement

- Japan recently called on India to fast-track internal official processing of the agreement on the UNICORN (Unified Complex Radio Antenna) naval radar system.
- UNICORN, also known as NORA-50, is a shipborne integrated antenna system.
- It is a mast with integrated communication systems that is engineered to dramatically enhance a warship's stealth and situational awareness.
- Developed jointly by three Japanese companies (NEC Corporation, Sampa Kogyo K.K., and The Yokohama Rubber Co., Ltd.), the system is already in service aboard Japan's Mogami-class frigates.
- India and Japan signed a Memorandum of Implementation (MOI) on 15 November 2024 for the co-development of UNICORN masts.
- It is the first military hardware co-development pact between the two countries.
- Japan will provide the design and engineering support, while India will handle integration, adaptation, and co-production through Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL).

Defence Conferences

Colombo Security Conclave Table Top Exercise Ends in Visakhapatnam

- The three-day Table Top Exercise of the **Colombo Security Conclave concluded on 12 September 2026** at the Eastern Naval Command in Visakhapatnam.
- The exercise began on 9 September 2026 and focused on a **coordinated response to illicit maritime activities in the Indian Ocean Region**.
- The Colombo Security Conclave is a regional maritime security grouping in the Indian Ocean Region.
- Its framework covers cooperation on maritime security, counter-terrorism, transnational crime, and humanitarian assistance and disaster relief.

Second Edition of Naval Commanders' Conference 2026 Begins in New Delhi

- The Commanders' Conference 2026/02 (the second edition of 2026 Indian Navy's biannual Conference) is scheduled over a period of three days from 29 Sep 2026 to 01 Oct 2026 at Nausena Bhawan, New Delhi.
- The conference is the apex-level forum of the Indian Navy and brings together senior naval leadership, including operational commanders and area commanders.

Miscellaneous

The 1991 Agreement on Advance Notice on Military Exercises, Manoeuvres and Troop Movements

- India summoned Pakistan's Charge d'Affaires in New Delhi to **lodge a strong protest after Pakistan Navy Ship Hunain collided with an Indian warship in the North Arabian Sea.**
- India stated that the incident constituted a **violation of Article 10** of the **1991 India–Pakistan bilateral agreement**, citing the **Pakistani vessel's high-speed and unsafe manoeuvring in international waters.**
- The 1991 Agreement on Advance Notification of Military Exercises, Manoeuvres and Troop Movements was signed on 6 April 1991 as a bilateral military confidence-building measure (CBM).

- The agreement establishes notification protocols and operational distance safeguards concerning military activities by the armed forces of both countries.
- **Background of the Agreement**
- **Brasstacks Fallout (1986–87):** India's large-scale military exercise near the **Rajasthan border heightened Pakistani security concerns** and exposed risks of unannounced military build-ups.
- **Earlier CBMs:** Followed the **1988 Agreement on Non-Attack against Nuclear Installations**, encouraging greater military transparency.
- Objective: Prevent miscalculations, military accidents and inadvertent escalation arising from misunderstood troop movements and military exercises near the border.
- The Agreement Requires scheduled **prior written notifications before conducting major military drills—** ranging from 15 days for specific naval/air exercises, 60 days for corps-level maneuvers, up to 90 days for army-level exercises.
- Exercise Details: Both sides must share key operational details, including assembly areas, **direction of movement, troop strength and duration.**
- **Airspace Safety:** Combat aircraft must maintain a 10-km separation from each other's airspace/ADIZ, with a 5-km buffer near specified forward airfields.

Combined Operational Review and Evaluation (CORE) Programme

- The 5-day Combined Operational Review and Evaluation (CORE) Programme 2026 concluded at the **Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi, bringing together top brass from the Tri-Services alongside civil bureaucrats to evaluate modern warfare dynamics.**
- A **premier civil-military strategic training** and evaluation initiative designed to bridge operational perspectives between senior leadership of the Indian Armed Forces and key civil administrative ministries.
- **Launched in: Instituted in September 2025 by HQ IDS as a permanent,** high-level civil-military interface on contemporary warfare and national security challenges.

India Develops BrahMos Belt Strategy

- BrahMos Belt Strategy refers to the emerging network of BrahMos missile **partnerships between India and Southeast Asian countries located around the South China Sea.**
- The idea is being discussed as India expands BrahMos exports to countries such as the **Philippines, Vietnam and Indonesia**, while other countries including **Thailand and Malaysia** have shown interest.

What is the BrahMos Belt Strategy?

- The BrahMos Belt Strategy is not a formal military alliance or treaty. It is a term used by strategic experts to describe **India's growing network of BrahMos missile cooperation with countries around the South China Sea** that have maritime security concerns.
- **The Philippines became the first foreign buyer of BrahMos in 2022**. India has subsequently expanded cooperation with other Southeast Asian countries, **including Vietnam and Indonesia.**
- **BrahMos missile is a supersonic cruise** missile jointly developed by **India and Russia.** It is designed for precision strikes against land and maritime targets and is known for its high speed, accuracy and versatility.
- **The name BrahMos is derived from the Brahmaputra River of India and the Moskva River of Russia.**
- Supersonic Speed: It can travel at around **Mach 2.8–3, making it much faster than conventional subsonic cruise missiles.**

Operation Sohan: Two terrorists killed in joint operation by Army, CRPF, J&K police in Udhampur

- Two terrorists were neutralised during an **overnight counter-terrorism operation in Jammu and Kashmir's Udhampur district.**
- The operation, **code-named Operation Sohan,** was launched during the intervening night of September 16 and 17 following confirmed intelligence inputs about the presence of terrorists in the general area of Brattal, the Army's White Knight Corps.

'VIMARSH' DRDO-Industry Synergy Meet: Raksha Mantri unveils key policy initiatives

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday unveiled a series of policy initiatives aimed at **lowering technical and financial entry barriers for MSMEs and deep-tech start-ups** and launched a framework for sharing DRDO-developed software source codes with licensee industries at the DRDO-Industry Synergy Meet 'VIMARSH 2026'.
- **centred on the theme 'Varta se Vikas',**
- The initiatives include **direct funding, incubation support and dedicated access to DRDO testing facilities for MSMEs and start-ups.**
- A standardised and secure framework for **sharing software source codes with licensee industries** was also launched to accelerate software-defined defence capabilities and address technology obsolescence.
- **The DRDO also signed a contract with the Quality Council of India for System for Advance Manufacturing Assessment and Rating (SAMAR) version 2.0** to benchmark the manufacturing maturity of domestic defence enterprises

Rajnath Singh Unveils RAKSHA Defence Diplomacy Document

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh released **'RAKSHA',** a comprehensive document outlining **India's strategic roadmap and vision for global defence partnerships over the next decade.**
- The defence diplomacy framework, unveiled in New Delhi, seeks to align India's national security objectives with proactive global cooperation while promoting long-term stability, mutual growth and a rules-based international order.
- The document identifies **four key pillars** of India's defence diplomacy strategy – strategic partnerships, capacity building, indigenous defence exports and maritime security.
- Under strategic partnerships, the framework focuses on **deepening bilateral and multilateral security cooperation with partner countries.**
- It also emphasises enhanced capacity building through joint military exercises, training programmes and the sharing of best practices with friendly nations.
- The document provides a clear and actionable vision for the next 10 years, recognising defence diplomacy as a key pillar of India's foreign policy

Rajnath Singh set for 3-day Sri Lanka visit, first by an Indian Defence Minister in 38 years

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh **will undertake an official visit to Sri Lanka from September 8 to 10**, marking the first such visit by an **Indian Defence Minister to the island nation in 38 years.**
- Mr. Singh will hold consultations with Sri Lanka's top leadership on a range of bilateral, regional and defence-related issues, and also interact with members of the Indian diaspora in Colombo.
- **The last Indian Defence Minister to visit Sri Lanka was K.C. Pant, who travelled to the country in 1988 while serving in Rajiv Gandhi's Cabinet**.

- During the visit, the Defence Minister is expected to meet **Sri Lankan President and Defence Minister Anura Kumara Dissanayake, Prime Minister Harini Amarasuriya** and Secretary to the Ministry of Defence Air Vice Marshal (Retd.) Sampath Thuyacontha.

Project Vijayak (BRO) Celebrates 16th Raising Day

- On September 21, 2026, Project Vijayak of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its 16th Raising Day in Kargil, Ladakh.
- Since its **inception in 2010**, Project Vijayak has been instrumental in **constructing and maintaining over 1,400 km of roads and 80 major bridges across Ladakh.**

20 September Railway Protection Force (RPF) Raising Day

- The **Railway Protection Force** was constituted by an **Act of Parliament in 1957** for providing **security to Railway property**.
- Subsequently, the force was **empowered to enquire, arrest and prosecute** the offenders involved in unlawful possession of railway property **in 1966.**
- Given the **status** of **"An Armed Force of the Union**" on **20th September 1985** by amending the RPF Act by the Parliament.
- The Railway Protection Force (RPF) is a **central paramilitary force under the Ministry of Railways**
- **Establishment:** The RPF's **origins trace back to 1854** when **East Indian Railways appointed staff** designated **as 'Police'** for its own force.

Operation Drishti

- Under Operation Drishti, AFMS surgeons performed **220 sight-restoring surgeries at an underground surgical centre in Tangdhar, Kupwara,** along the LoC during the 10th Mega Eye Surgical Camp.
- **A flagship humanitarian medical outreach initiative launched by the Indian Armed Forces** to deliver free, high-tier super-specialty ophthalmic interventions, diagnostics, and sight-restoring micro-surgeries to underprivileged populations and military veterans living in remote, inaccessible, and border areas.
- **Organisation: Led by the Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS) in coordination with the Indian Army's Chinar Corps.**

L&T Unveils First Silicon Carbide Chip Platform

- L&T Semiconductor Technologies, a wholly owned subsidiary of Larsen & Toubro, **unveiled its first silicon carbide (SiC) product platform on 18 September 2026 at SEMICON India 2026.**
- L&T Semiconductor Technologies (LTSCT), a **wholly-owned subsidiary of Larsen & Toubro,** signed a **strategic, long-term partnership with Hon Young Semiconductor Co. Ltd. (HYS), a Foxconn Technology Group unit.**
- Silicon carbide is a wide-bandgap semiconductor material used in high-voltage and high-temperature power devices.

Eastern Naval Command to organise 11th edition of Vizag Navy Marathon in Visakhapatnam on Dec 13

- The 11th edition of the **Vizag Navy Marathon will take place in Visakhapatnam** on December 13, 2026, as part of the Navy Day celebrations.
- **Starting Point: Vishwapriya Function Hall at RK Beach**

- Categories: 42 km (Full Marathon), 21 km (Half Marathon), 10 km, and 5 km
- **Title Sponsor: State Bank of India (SBI)**
- **Prize Money: Around ₹10 lakh**

Science & Technology

Satellite & Space Projects

ISRO

ISRO Launches GSLV-F17 with EOS-05 Satellite

- ISRO has launched the EOS-05 (formerly GISAT-1A) aboard the **GSLV-F17 rocket from Sriharikota**.
- The mission serves as the **operational replacement for the lost GISAT-1 mission to place a continuous geo-imaging satellite over the Indian subcontinent.**
- OS-05 (formerly GISAT-1A) is an ISRO geo-imaging satellite built on the I-2K platform. **Operating in Geosynchronous Orbit (~35,786 km),** it enables near-real-time monitoring of India, surrounding oceans and border regions, succeeding the lost GISAT-1 mission.
- **Nodal Agency & Launcher**: Developed by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), launching via GSLV-F17 (GSLV Mk II) from the Second Launch Pad at SDSC-SHAR, Sriharikota.
- Orbit: Placed into a **high-altitude Geosynchronous Orbit (~35,786 km)**, matching Earth's rotation to overcome the multi-day revisit gaps typical of Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellites.
- **Primary Objective**: Deliver persistent spatial, spectral, and thermal monitoring over **the Indian landmass, oceans, and border zones for disaster mitigation, agriculture, and strategic defense.**

TRISHNA Mission

- The PSLV is scheduled to launch the **Indo-French TRISHNA mission next year which is a collaborative endeavor between ISRO and CNES.**
- The TRISHNA (Thermal Infra-Red Imaging Satellite for High-resolution Natural Resource Assessment) mission, is a collaborative endeavor between the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the French Space Agency Centre National d'Etudes Spatiales (CNES).
- It is engineered to deliver high spatial and high temporal resolution monitoring of Earth's surface temperature, emissivity, biophysical and radiation variables for surface energy budgeting at regional to global scale.

Objectives:

- Detailed monitoring of the energy and water budgets of the continental biosphere for quantifying terrestrial water stress and water use.
- High-resolution observation of water quality and dynamics in coastal and inland waters.
- A comprehensive assessment of urban heat islands detection of thermal anomalies linked to volcanic activity and geothermal resources.
- Precise monitoring of snow-melt runoff and glacier dynamics.
- Provide valuable data on aerosol optical depth, atmospheric water vapor, and cloud cover.
- The satellite will operate in a **sun-synchronous orbit** at an altitude of 761 km.
- This orbit will provide a spatial resolution of 57 meters for land and coastal areas and 1 km for oceanic and polar regions.

- **The mission is designed for a 5-year operational life.**
- TRISHNA's data will contribute to several global initiatives, such as GEOGLAM for agricultural monitoring, the UN's Sustainable Development Goals and targets, and the Global Water Watch.
- Some of the mission's outputs will serve as Essential Agricultural Variables (EAVs), and Essential Climate Variables (ECVs) for the global community.

Assam to Establish ISRO Advanced Radar Research Centre

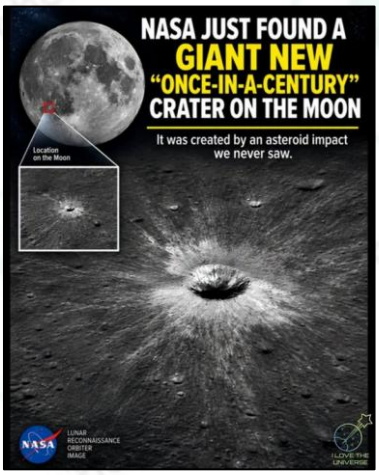
- The foundation stone for the Indian Space Research Organisation's Advanced Radar Research Centre was laid at Chandrapur **near Guwahati in Assam**
- The centre is being **developed under Project NETRA,** which stands for **Network for Space Object Tracking and Analysis**, and it is linked to India's space situational awareness framework.
- **Project NETRA is ISRO's programme for space object tracking and analysis.**
- The project covers detection of satellites, debris, and other objects in orbit, along with orbit determination and collision-avoidance support.
- The centre is expected to track **objects as small as 10 cm within a range of 2,000 km.**

ISRO, ESA Extend Space Cooperation Until 2032

- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (Isro) and the European Space Agency (ESA)** have announced the **renewal of their existing cooperation till 2032.**
- Some of the recent engagements between the European and the Indian space agencies have been for missions **Aditya-L1, Proba-3, and the upcoming Chandrayaan-5, to name a few.**
- The **original cooperation agreement** between ISRO and ESA **came into force in January 2002.**

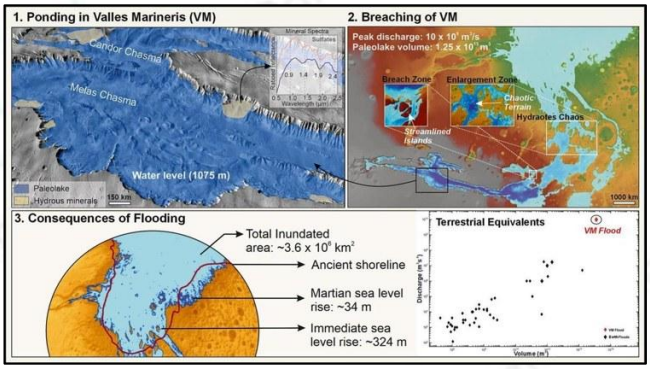
NASA

NASA Finds New Moon Crater Larger Than Roman Colosseum



- **NASA's Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter (LRO)** identified a new impact crater on the Moon's near side that formed between 11 April and 22 May 2024.
- The crater has been named **McGetchin after Thomas McGetchin of the Lunar and Planetary Institute in Houston**, and it measures about 222 metres across and up to 43 metres deep.
- The Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter is a **NASA spacecraft launched in 2009 to map the Moon's surface and environment**.
- Impact craters form when asteroids, comets, or meteoroids strike a planetary surface at high speed.

Valles Marineris



- A vastly larger **outburst flood occurred on Mars during the Late Hesperian to Early Amazonian**, when the breaching of paleolakes in **Valles Marineris, the largest canyon system** in the Solar System, unleashed a massive deluge.
- Valles Marineris, or Mariner Valley, is a **vast system of interconnected canyons on the planet Mars.**

- The system was discovered during, and named for, the Mariner 9 mission in 1971.
- It is one of the larger canyons in the solar system.

Other Countries Space Prog.

AstroRad

- An Israeli company named **StemRad** has, along with **Lockheed Martin**, recently developed a vest called **AstroRad for spaceflight.**
- It is a wearable, radiation-shielding vest designed for space travel.
- It **protects astronauts' vital organs from dangerous space radiation beyond low-Earth orbit (LEO**).
- It reduces Radiation Exposure Induced Death (REID) while eliminating the possibility of Acute Radiation Syndrome (ARS) **due to solar particle events**

Medicine & Research

A 'peptide party'

- Recently, a **'peptide party' in Bengaluru was cancelled** after Karnataka Food Safety and Drug Administration officials shut down the gig.
- **Peptides are the fundamental building blocks of proteins, shorter chains of amino acids.**
- These are smaller, often containing anywhere from two to 50 amino acids.
- The amino acids in a **peptide are connected to one another in a sequence by bonds called peptide bonds.**
- The **human body naturally produces many peptides;** common ones in the public domain include
- Insulin, which the pancreas makes to regulate the body's blood sugar
- Endorphins, which are released by the central nervous system to block pain signals and relieve stress
- Growth hormone releasing hormone which triggers the pituitary gland to make and release growth hormone.
- Synthetic proteins have also been created in laboratories for therapeutic uses which includes **synthetic insulin and GLP-1 receptor agonists popular as weight-loss drugs.**

Cold allodynia

- A team of researchers from the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), **Bengaluru, and Kolkata-based institute TCG-CREST have identified the "brain circuit**" that involves the sensations associated with a certain **side effect of chemotherapy known as "cold allodynia".**
- Cold allodynia is a condition in which the sufferer **may feel pain or distress from even a regular level of cold temperatures.**
- It is one of the side effects that are part of **"chemotherapy-induced peripheral neuropathy",** which includes many chemotherapy-induced neural side effects such as temperature sensitivity, a feeling of pins and needles, or pain etc.
- Cold allodynia specifically is known to be one of the side effects of oxaliplatin, a commonly used chemotherapy drug that contains platinum.

US FDA Approves AstraZeneca Breast Cancer Drug Etcamah

- The US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) granted accelerated approval **to AstraZeneca's Etcamah, also known as camizestrant**, for adults with advanced or metastatic hormone receptor-positive, HER2-negative breast cancer with an ESR1 mutation.

- **Hormone receptor-positive breast cancer is a subtype that depends on oestrogen or progesterone signalling for tumour growth.**
- HER2-negative breast cancer lacks overexpression or amplification of the human epidermal growth factor receptor 2 gene.

New Discovery

Astronomers Discover Youngest Known Planet Elias 2-24 b

- Astronomers have **confirmed Elias 2-24 b as the youngest known planet**, with an estimated age of less than 1 million years.
- The planet orbits Elias 2-24, **a star located about 450 light-years from Earth**, and it remains embedded in the dusty gas-and-debris disk from which it formed.
- Elias 2-24 b lies in a prominent gap within the protoplanetary disk of its host star.
- The planet is still **accreting material from its surrounding disk.** Protoplanetary disks are rotating structures of gas, dust, and debris around young stars, and they are the sites where planets form.
- **PDS 70 and WISPIT 2 are other young planetary systems used in planet-formation studies.**

Technology

Gallium Nitride Monolithic Microwave Integrated Circuit Technology

- Recently, the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** has successfully demonstrated and implemented **indigenous Gallium Nitride Monolithic Microwave Integrated Circuit (GaN MMIC) Technology.**
- It is a **tiny, super-powerful computer chip** built on a special chemical material that handles **extremely high-frequency wireless signals without melting.**
- It's an all-in-one chip that combines tiny parts—like transistors, resistors, and capacitors—onto a single piece of material to manage invisible wireless waves (microwaves).
- It is designed for applications up to the X-band frequency range.
- Origin: DRDO developed the GaN MMIC technology in 2024 and helped **India quietly entered an elite club of seven countries — US, Russia, France, Germany, South Korea, China**

Why is GaN Important?

- It is a material with exceptional thermal and electrical properties, making it critical for advanced defence applications such as sensors, radars, satellites, and missiles.
- A single indigenous GaN chip, measuring 3.5 x 3 mm can deliver up to 30 watts of power and operate at speeds 300 times faster than silicon.

TCS Launches Custom SoC Design Services

- Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) launched **Custom System-on-Chip (SoC) Design Services for automotive Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs) and** semiconductor ecosystem players.
- The service covers semiconductor engineering, Very Large-Scale Integration (VLSI) design, hardware-software co-design, and system validation for custom silicon development.
- **A System-on-Chip is an integrated circuit that combines multiple electronic functions on a single chip.**

India Inaugurates Green Forge Complex at BRIC-NABI Mohali

- India inaugurated its **first-of-its-kind Green Forge Complex at the Biotechnology Research and Innovation Council-National Agri-Food Biotechnology Institute (BRIC-NABI) in Mohali, Punjab.**
- The facility is linked to genome and trait engineering, controlled environmental testing, and the BioE3 policy for biotechnology-led biomanufacturing.

Green Forge Complex

- The Green Forge Complex is a **controlled research facility for testing genetically modified (GM) crops** under simulated environmental conditions.
- It uses **chambers that vary light, humidity, and temperature to assess crop performance** before field cultivation.
- BioE3 stands for **Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment.**

Google Launches AlphaGenome Atlas for Human DNA

- Google DeepMind launched the **AlphaGenome Atlas as an open-access database for human DNA analysis.**
- The resource contains 1 petabyte of precomputed artificial intelligence predictions for all 9 billion possible single-letter mutations in human DNA.
- The human genome contains **about 3 billion base pairs, and single-letter mutations are also called point mutations or single-nucleotide variants.**
- The AlphaGenome Atlas is designed to **map both coding DNA**, which carries protein-making instructions, **and non-coding DNA**, which forms about 98% of the human genome.
- **The UK Biobank is a large biomedical database** that includes genetic data from more than 54,000 participants in the cited analysis.

Astra AI Model

- Recently, OpenAI has released its newest frontier artificial intelligence (AI) model GPT-6 Astra.
- It is a new frontier artificial intelligence (AI) model released by OpenAI.
- It is a model built for end-to-end work, rather than only answering prompts.
- It can operate computers and browsers, fill online forms, update customer records, organise calendars, conduct web research, draft material inside documents and email, analyse scientific data, generate plots, build websites, install and test software, and troubleshoot problems visible on a screen.

NIELIT and Intel India Launch Agentic AI Skilling Programmes

- **The National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT),** under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and **Intel India** launched the **Agentic AI Skilling Programmes**
- The initiative is linked to training youth across India in **artificial intelligence skills for work with systems that can reason, plan and execute tasks.**
- **Agentic AI is a class of artificial intelligence systems that can perform multi-step tasks with limited human intervention.**
- NIELIT and Intel India organised a National Leadership Dialogue at the India Habitat Centre in New Delhi on the theme **“Preparing the Future Workforce for the Agentic AI Era”.**

SARAL AI

- The **CSIR-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** has taken a new step towards strengthening science communication by leveraging SARAL AI.

- **SARAL AI is an initiative of Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) New Delhi.**
- It **converts research published in its journals into engaging and accessible videos.**
- It is an AI-based platform that demystifies and converts complex research publications and patents into podcasts, short videos, posters, business briefs.

OPU-IVF Calf Born in Badri Cattle in Major Indigenous Breed Conservation Milestone

- The Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare said that a "healthy" Badri female calf has been successfully born through Ovum Pick-Up and In Vitro Fertilization (OPU-IVF) technology.
- **Badri is an indigenous cattle breed, which is found in Uttarakhand**
- The achievement has been accomplished through a collaborative effort between **ICAR-National Dairy Research Institute (ICAR-NDRI), Karnal, and GB Pant University of Agriculture and Technology, Pantnagar, Uttarakhand,** with financial support from the Uttarakhand Biotechnology Council, Haldi.

India's first mainstream plug-in hybrid SUV and PHEV

- **MG Hector Tomahawk is India's first mainstream plug-in hybrid SUV.**
- Unlike battery electric vehicles (BEVs) such as the **Tesla Model S or the Tata Nexon electric that need to be plugged in before the battery is discharged,** technologies such as HEVs and PHEVs bring together the best of both worlds.
- For instance, **HEVs, or conventional hybrid electric vehicles combine a conventional internal combustion engine (ICE) system, like in a regular petrol car**, with an electric propulsion system to produce a hybrid drivetrain that substantially lowers fossil fuel usage.
- The PHEVs, or plug-in hybrid electric vehicles have a hybrid drivetrain **that uses a combination of the internal combustion engine (ICE) and electric power for motive power, but is backed by rechargeable batteries, quite like the HEVs.**
- A plug-in hybrid car has a comparatively bigger battery and offers a longer electric range than a traditional HEV.
- PHEV combines the positive attributes of internal combustion (range on long journeys) with those of plug-in electrics (a cleaner engine that typically costs less to run) in a single vehicle, resulting in a combination of features superior to those of a regular HEV.

Miscellaneous

IIT Madras Pravartak, Swayam Plus launch multi-cloud programmes on computing and cybersecurity skills

- **The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras Pravartak Technologies Foundation**, in collaboration **with SWAYAM Plus,** an initiative of the Union Education Ministry, has **introduced a Multi-Cloud Foundation with Security Programmes,**
- with an aim to **incorporate practical cloud computing** and cybersecurity skills among students, graduates and working professionals.
- The programme **integrates textbook learning with real-life application to help students understand how common cloud concepts get implemented** across the three major cloud providers, namely Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud Platform (GCP).

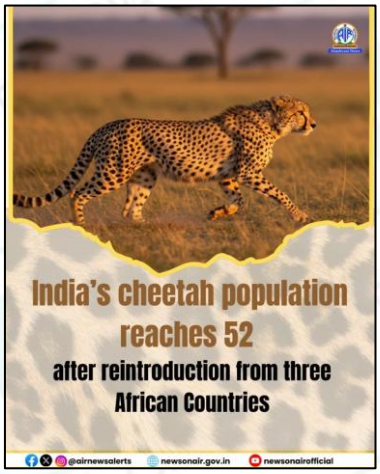
IMC 2026 Launches Viksit Tech 47 Platform

- **The India Mobile Congress 2026** launched **Viksit Tech 47** as a platform for identifying and supporting Indian technology companies and leaders.
- The initiative is linked to the 10th edition of India Mobile Congress, scheduled from 7 to 10 October 2026 at the Yashobhoomi Convention Centre in New Delhi.
- India Mobile Congress is an annual technology event in India that focuses on telecommunications, digital infrastructure, and emerging technologies.

Environment

Population Census, Reports, and Initiatives

The Cheetah

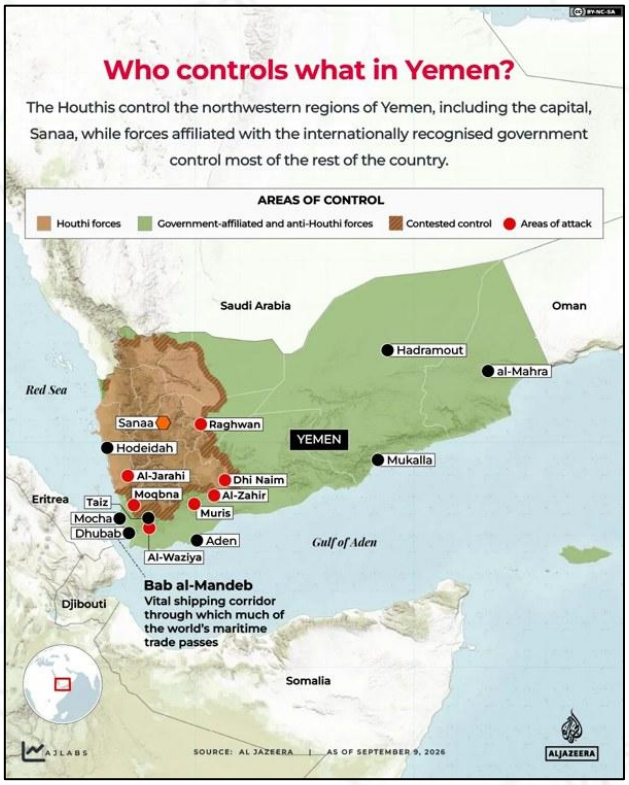


- According to the four-year status review of Project Cheetah released by Kuno National Park, **India's cheetah population has risen to 52, including 32 cubs born on Indian soil.**
- The programme has entered the consolidation phase, with **49 cheetahs in Kuno National Park (17 free-ranging) and three in Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary.**
- It is universally recognized as the **fastest living terrestrial animal** on Earth, capable of accelerating from **0 to 100 km/h in approximately three seconds.**
- Prefers open savannahs, dry grasslands, semi-arid scrub forests and bushlands that provide unobstructed visibility and open terrain for high-speed pursuit.

Conservation Status:

- **IUCN Red List:** Listed globally as Vulnerable (VU).
- **The Asiatic subspecies is listed as Critically Endangered (CR).**
- **CITES: Appendix I.**

UNCCD COP17: Advancing Global Drought Resilience and Land Restoration



- The 17th Conference of the Parties (COP17) to the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) concluded in **Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia.**
- Held under **Restoring Land, Restoring Hope,** the summit focused on rangeland conservation, drought financing and community-led restoration, amid deadlock over a binding global drought treaty.
- The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD), **established following the 1992 Rio Earth Summit**, is the sole **legally binding international agreement linking environment and development** to sustainable land management.
- **COP17 coincided with the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists**, placing pastoral

communities and fragile open ecosystems at the center of the global Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) agenda.

Key Highlights of UNCCD COP17:

- The convention warned that **approximately 40% of the world's land surface is already degraded, directly affecting billions of livelihoods** and threatening global water and food security.
- **Host Nation's Commitment:** Mongolia, where nearly **77% of land is affected by degradation, showcased its national Billion Trees Campaign** (launched in 2021 to plant 1 billion trees by 2030) to combat regional desertification.
- **AI-Powered Drought Resilience Index**: Launched as the world's first comprehensive technical diagnostic tool, utilizing artificial intelligence and vulnerability mapping to track national preparedness and **drive proactive drought mitigation.**
- **Drought Resilience Investment Facility**: Co-launched by the **UNCCD and Luxembourg as the first global catalytic financing platform**, deploying public capital to de-risk investments and mobilize commercial funds for water security and climate-resilient agriculture.

India's Stance & Interventions at COP17:

- **First-Ever Guide to Grasslands &Open Natural Ecosystems (ONEs)**: India unveiled a specialized policy guide to mainstream the ecological conservation of ravines, arid deserts (Thar), cold deserts, and Deccan savannahs.
- **Bonn Challenge Restoration Progress:** India reported bringing 21.76 million hectares of degraded and deforested land under active restoration, progressing steadily toward its **national pledge of restoring 26 million hectares by 2030.**

India's Domestic Initiatives to Combat Desertification:

- **National Action Plan to Combat Desertification (NAPCD):** First formulated in **2001 and updated in 2023**, it serves as the nodal umbrella mechanism converging ministerial land restoration programs.
- **PM Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)** – Watershed Component: Integrates ridge-to-valley watershed treatments, runoff harvesting, and **in-situ moisture conservation to build local drought-proofing.**
- **ISRO's Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas**: Deploys remote sensing and Geographic Information System (GIS) analytics to monitor temporal shifts in land degradation and guide targeted district-level interventions.
- **Aravalli Green Wall Project:** An afforestation and ecological green corridor initiative aimed at checking eastward desert expansion from the Thar **across Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat, and Delhi.**
- **Mission Amrit Sarovar**: Focuses on excavating and rejuvenating at least 75 water bodies per district **to recharge shallow aquifers and ensure local water security.**

UN Climate Week opens in Azerbaijan to delibrates upon climate actions ahead of COP31

- The **fourth United Nations Climate Week has opened in Azerbaijan's capital, Baku** from September 7 to September 11, 2026.
- Baku Climate Action Week 2026 is **being held alongside the UNFCCC gathering**, bringing together investors, businesses, civil society groups and other non-state actors.
- The dialogue, **involving the presidencies of COP29 (Azerbaijan), COP30 (Brazil) and incoming COP31 (Turkey)**, is aimed at building political momentum for improved climate reporting and identifying gaps in **support for developing countries.**

WWF Global Conservation Conference Inaugurated in Jaipur

- Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Shri Bhupender Yadav, **inaugurated the Global Conservation Conference of the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) at Jaipur, Rajasthan.**
- Chief Conservation Officer at WWF-International, Shri Daudi Samba; and, CEO of WWF-India, Shri Ravi Singh.
- **The World Wide Fund for Nature, or WWF, is an international non-governmental organisation founded in 1961.**
- WWF works on wildlife conservation, habitat protection, climate action, and sustainable use of natural resources across multiple countries.

The Kathmandu Declaration

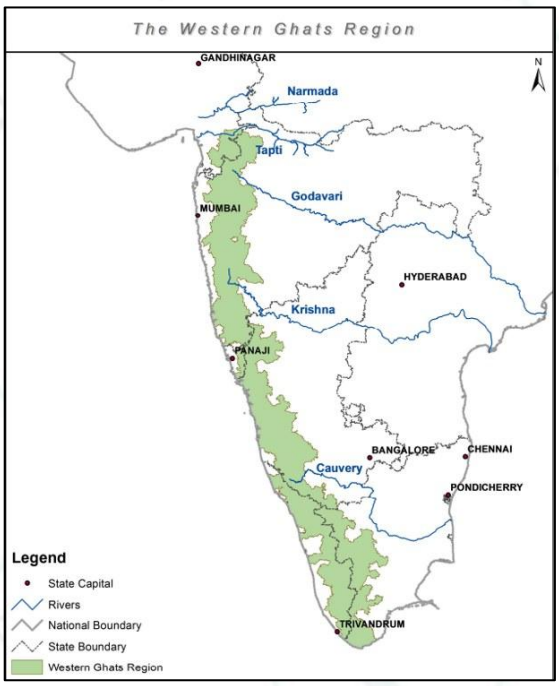
- Member countries of the **South Asia Wildlife Enforcement Network (SAWEN)** adopted the landmark **'Kathmandu Declaration'** by consensus during the closing session of **SAWEN's first General Assembly in Kathmandu, Nepal.**
- A multilateral regional consensus declaration **adopted by environmental ministers and heads of delegations** from South Asian nations to reinforce joint operational mechanisms against illegal wildlife trade (IWT) and related transnational organized crime.
- Adopted under the aegis of the South Asia Wildlife Enforcement Network (SAWEN).

South Asia Wildlife Enforcement Network (SAWEN):

- A specialized regional intergovernmental wildlife law enforcement agency comprising **eight South Asian member countries**: **Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka**. Its permanent **Secretariat is based in Kathmandu, Nepal.**
- **Established in: Formally launched on January 30, 2011.**

The Kasturirangan Report on the Conservation of Western Ghats

- The **Karnataka Legislature unanimously rejected the Centre's seventh draft notification on the Western Ghats Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA)** in its present form, seeking to restrict the ESA to notified forests and conduct a cadastral survey before final demarcation.
- **Submitted in April 2013** by the 10-member High-Level Working Group (HLWG) chaired by **former Planning Commission member Dr. K. Kasturirangan,**
- the **report was constituted by the Ministry of Environment and Forests (MoEF)** to examine the **earlier Madhav Gadgil-led Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP) report** and formulate a balanced, pragmatic roadmap reconciling ecological conservation with regional development.



Summary of the Report

- Covered 188 talukas across **6 Western Ghats states—Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu**—over 1,64,280 km².
- Identified 41% natural landscape and 59% cultural landscape, inhabited by nearly 50 million people.
- **Recommended about 60,000 km²** (37%) as **Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA)**, covering nearly 90% of the contiguous natural landscape.

- Used 24-metre satellite data and landscape fragmentation analysis, with revenue villages as the basic administrative unit.

Key Recommendations

- **Complete ban on new mining, quarrying and sand mining in ESA**; existing leases to be phased out within 5 years or at lease expiry.
- **Ban on new thermal power plants**. Run-of-the-river hydropower allowed with cumulative impact assessment, 3 km spacing, basin impact below 50%, and minimum 30% ecological flow during lean seasons.
- Red-category industries completely prohibited; Orange-category industries allowed with strict regulation.
- **No new townships** or large-scale area development projects; construction projects of 20,000 m² or more prohibited.
- **Permissible infrastructure projects require Category A clearance under EIA Notification,** 2006; **projects within a 10-km ESA buffer also subject to EIA regulations.**

The UN Declaration on Sea Level Rise

- At the 81st UN General Assembly, world leaders adopted the **UN Declaration on Sea Level Rise by consensus**, addressing threats to the **sovereignty, legal rights and survival of low-lying coastal nations and Small Island Developing States (SIDS).**
- A landmark, consensus-based international political declaration that establishes **global principles for safeguarding the continued statehood, permanent maritime entitlements, and human rights of nations** facing land inundation due to climate-induced sea-level rise.
- **Organisation**: Adopted under the auspices of the **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** following a high-level process initiated under General Assembly Decision 78/558, **co-facilitated by Australia and Cabo Verde.**

Key Features:

- Affirms that **sovereign statehood, legal personality**, and UN membership **remain intact even if a nation's territory is submerged by rising sea levels.**
- Establishes that **lawfully deposited UNCLOS maritime boundaries remain fixed and permanent**, removing any requirement to revise or retract limits as coastlines retreat.
- **Guarantees that populations displaced across borders retain protections under international human rights law,** preserving their nationality, dignity, and right to self-determination.

India Issues First PRAMAAN Certificates

- Union Environment, Forest and Climate Change Minister Bhupender Yadav handed **over India's first PRAMAAN (Programme for Recognition and Accreditation of sustainable Management practices for Agroforestry And Natural forestry resources)** certificates under the Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme (IFWCS).
- The certificates were **presented to the Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation (APFDC) for its plantations spread over 33,000 hectares,** and to **Govind Mohapatra, a bamboo farmer associated with the Odisha Bamboo Development Agency (OBDA).**
- **Andhra Pradesh become the first state to receive PRAMAAN certification** for environmentally sustainable cultivation practices.

- Independent audits by accredited certification bodies form the basis of certification, while the accreditation architecture is benchmarked against international frameworks to facilitate recognition among buyers and regulators in India and overseas.

The scheme provides three certification categories.

- **Forest Management Certification applies to forests and plantations managed under approved standards**.
- **Trees Outside Forests Management Certification** applies to trees grown outside recorded forest areas, including farm forestry and agroforestry systems.
- **Chain of Custody Management Certification** applies to tracking certified material through processing and trade.

What is PRAMAAN?

- PRAMAAN is a **nationally accepted framework for certification of forests, wood and non-timber forest products.**
- The initiative seeks to **strengthen linkages between certified forests and agroforestry products and domestic and international markets.**
- The IFWCS-PRAMAAN certification is also aimed at **enhancing the social and ecological values of India's forests, agroforestry systems and wood-based industries.**

India highlights progress in forest cover, restoration and climate action at COFO 28

- India showcased it's forest and landscape restoration at the Twenty-eighth Session of the FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization) Committee on Forestry (COFO 28) held in Rome.

About FAO Committee on Forestry

- It is FAO's (Food and Agriculture Organization) highest global intergovernmental body on forestry.
- It guides the organisation's work and fostering international collaboration, policy dialogue, and technical guidance on forest-related issues.
- It was established by the Conference at its Sixteenth Session in 1971.

Governance

- Meetings: It convenes biennially (every two years) at the FAO headquarters in Rome, Italy
- It reviews the programmes of work of the Organization in the field of forestry and reviews forestry problems of an international nature, evaluating said problems with a view to concerted action by Member Nations and the Organization.

Conservation Areas

Melghat, Pench Tiger Reserves emerge as most successful sites for Vulture reintroduction

- The **Melghat and Pench tiger reserves in Maharashtra** have **emerged as India's most successful reintroduction sites** for captive-bred vultures, recording high survival rates, the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)
- The BNHS and Maharashtra Forest Department signed an MOU for the vulture release programme, and jointly released nine white-rumped vultures and five long-billed vultures in December 2025 at Pench Tiger Reserve, recording a 78 per cent survival rate over nine months.
- Similarly, they released 15 long-billed vultures in January 2026 in Melghat Tiger Reserve and recorded a 60 per cent survival rate in eight months.

Pilibhit Tiger Reserve tourism season extended by one month from Nov 1 to Jun 30

- Tourists will now be able to **visit the Pilibhit Tiger Reserve (PTR) for nearly eight months**, with the tourism season extended from **November 1 to June 30.**
- It is situated in the **Pilibhit and Lakhimpur Kheri districts of Uttar Pradesh**, forming part of the Terai Arc Landscape, in the upper Gangetic Plain.
- **It lies along the India-Nepal border in the foothills of the Himalayas.**
- **The River Gomti originates from the PTR**, which is also the catchment of several others like Sharda, Chuka, and Mala Khannot.



Natural Disasters

Barrier Lake

- The newly formed barrier lake on the Nepal-Tibet border poses an immediate, catastrophic threat to Nepal.
- **A barrier lake is more commonly known as a landslide dam or lake.**



Formation of Barrier Lake

- It is created in **a river valley when landslide debris completely blocks a stream or river.**
- The displaced material effectively becomes a natural dam, trapping water upstream and creating a temporary reservoir.
- It is commonly formed in places with high, steep mountains and narrow river valleys that witness activity such as rock, soil and mud avalanches, slides, or flows.
- This instantly plugs the river flow.
- **Water rapidly accumulates behind this natural blockage.**
- As water pressure mounts, the loose debris dam can erode or suddenly collapse.
- **This triggers the lake burst, sending a catastrophic wall of water downstream.**
- The timescale of a breach can vary from days to even decades after the formation of a dam.

Hawaii declares emergency as Hurricane Lowell strengthens to Category 4

- Hawaii is under a state of emergency with powerful Hurricane Lowell set to bear down on its western islands.
- The hurricane was a Category 4 with winds up to 150 mph early
- In mid-August, Hurricane Lala deluged eastern Hawaii's Big Island

Anak Krakatau Volcano



- Recently, **Indonesia's Anak Krakatau volcano** erupted prompting the cancellation of all flights at Jakarta's Soekarno-Hatta International Airport.
- Location: **It is a stratovolcano located in the Sunda Strait, between Java and Sumatra in Indonesia.**
- It is a part of the **Ring of Fire, a chain of volcanoes in the Pacific Ocean.**
- Anak Krakatau, or **"child of Krakatau", is linked to the famed Krakatau, whose 1883 eruption triggered a period of global cooling.**
- It emerged from the sea in 1927.

Japan on high alert as Typhoon Dujuan heads towards Tokyo

- Typhoon Dujuan approaches Japan's Pacific coast, bringing torrential rain, powerful winds, and flash floods to Tokyo
- the Category 1 typhoon is passing just off the southeastern tip of Honshu
- maximum sustained winds near the center of 40 meters per second (144 kph), with gusts up to 55 meters per second (198 kph)

Hurricane Polo Reaches Category 5 off Mexico

- **Hurricane Polo** has grown into one of the most powerful Pacific cyclones in decades, **and it was expected to skirt Mexico's southwestern coast as a Category 5 storm.**
- Polo was an "extremely dangerous" storm with maximum sustained winds of 165 mph (265 kph),

Kallakkadal (Swell Surge)

- INCOIS issued a **red alert for Kerala's coast over 1–1.5 m waves and severe Kallakkadal swell surges.**
- KSDMA **suspended fishing and beach tourism amid coastal flooding and erosion risks in Kerala**, southern Tamil Nadu and Lakshadweep.
- **Kallakkadal is sudden coastal flooding caused by long-period ocean swells arriving without local storms or rainfall.**
- The Malayalam term means "**sea that arrives like a thief", reflecting its unexpected onset.**
- **Prone Regions**: Primarily affects **Kerala's coastline, particularly Thiruvananthapuram, Kollam, Alappuzha** and Ernakulam, along with Lakshadweep and southern Tamil Nadu.



How It Forms

- **Storm Generation**: Powerful storms and winds over the Southern Ocean/South Atlantic generate high-energy swells.
- **Long-Distance Propagation**: Swells travel thousands of kilometres **across the Indian Ocean, retaining significant energy.**
- **Coastal Amplification: In shallow waters, wave height increases, pushing seawater inland.**
- **Tidal Influence: Impact intensifies when swells coincide with astronomical high tide.**

27th September NDMA observes 22nd Formation Day

- The National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) is commemorating its 22nd Formation Day.

- The theme for this year's Formation Day **is "Risk Reduction in Action".**
- The National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) is **India's apex statutory body for disaster management.**
- The NDMA was formally constituted on **27th September 2006**, by the Disaster Management Act, 2005.
- **The Prime Minister is its chairperson and it has nine other members.**

Fauna in News

New cat species 'Tilcayo' identified in Bolivia, first in over a century



- Recently, a **new cat species was identified in Bolivia**, first in over a century and researchers named it as **Leopardus Tilcayo.**
- It is a **type of tiger cat**, a group of small felines in the genus Leopardus that are **native to South America.**
- It was found in **Bolivia's lush Yungas forest**, a mountainous region where **forests are often covered by clouds and surrounded by high humidity.**
- The cat is called Tilcayo by local communities.
- Appearance: It measures about **18 inches (46 cm) long and weighs around 3 pounds** (1.4 kg), making it **smaller than the average domestic cat.**
- Its fur is light brown with irregularly shaped rosettes across its body.

Buellia maharajensis

- Researchers have discovered a new species of lichen, **Buellia maharajensis, in Mathikettan Shola National Park.**
- It is a new species of lichen.
- It is the **fourth lichen variety discovered within Mathikettan Shola National Park, Kerala.**
- It **grows directly on rock surfaces** and was recorded at an elevation of approximately 1,351 m..

Tetragonula nagalandensis

- Recently, scientists have discovered a new species of **stingless honey bee** and named it **Tetragonula nagalandensis.**
- It is a species **of stingless honey bee discovered in Nagaland.**
- It brings the total number of known stingless bee species in the **country to 19.**
- Unlike **common honey bees that build hives in trees or buildings, these bees are subterranean, living under the soil.**
- Its home is also unique; as it builds compact clusters of brood cells protected by several thin layers of wax and organic material to survive the damp, underground environment.

Pneumocystis jirovecii

- According to the findings of a study by researchers, **Pneumocystis jirovecii fungi that can cause severe pneumonia in people** with weaker or weakened immune systems appears to **have become resistant to a drug that never intended to kill it.**
- It is an **opportunistic fungal pathogen**.
- It can cause pneumonia in patients with impaired immune systems, such as those with AIDS or who are receiving immunosuppressive drugs.

- It is a ubiquitous organism transmitted by aerosol route and causes no disease in immunocompetent patients.
- Initially classified as a protozoa, it has been considered a fungus since the 1990s based on molecular analyses.
- Its life cycle primarily consists of trophic (eg, trophozoites) and cystic forms.

What is Pneumocystis pneumonia (PCP)?

- It is a **lung infection that mainly affects people with weakened immune systems**. The fungus Pneumocystis jirovecii causes it.
- Signs and symptoms of Pneumocystis pneumonia: Fever, Chills, Cough, Shortness of breath (dyspnea), Fatigue etc.
- Transmission: P. jirovecii is transmitted from one person to another through the air when someone coughs, sneezes or talks.
- Treatment: It is **treated with high doses of the antibiotic trimethoprim-sulfamethoxazole (TMP-SMX).**

Black Robin Named New Zealand's 2026 Bird of the Year

- The **endangered black robin, also known as karure**, was named New Zealand's Bird of the Year on 21 September 2026.
- Bird of the Year is an annual public vote run by Forest & Bird, a New Zealand conservation organisation.
- The black robin is a small passerine bird **native to the Chatham Islands, which lie about 800 kilometres east of mainland New Zealand.**
- The black robin was reduced to five birds in 1980, including one breeding female known as Old Blue

Miscellaneous

PFOS

- PFOS, a widespread **industrial 'forever chemical'**, weakens the **body's ability to fight viral infections, a study has found recently.**
- PFOS (Perfluorooctane Sulfonate or Perfluorooctane Sulfonic Acid) is a **synthetic chemical used to make products resistant to stains, grease, soil, and water.**
- It is an organic perfluorinated compound, consisting of **an eight-carbon backbone and a sulfonate functional group.**
- It is part of a class of chemicals called per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFASs).
- PFAS, also known as the Forever Chemicals, are **a large chemical family of over 10,000 highly persistent chemicals that don't occur in nature.**
- PFOS is very stable in the environment and **hard to break down. PFOS also moves easily through groundwater.**
- PFOS is of particular concern because **it can accumulate up the food chain in aquatic systems and can lead to high concentrations in predatory fish consumed by anglers.**
- It can cause serious health effects, including cancer, endocrine disruption, accelerated puberty, liver and immune system damage, and thyroid changes.

The International Whaling Commission (IWC)

- India reaffirmed its commitment at the 70th meeting of the **International Whaling Commission (IWC-70) in Hobart, Australia.**

- The premier global intergovernmental organization charged with the **conservation of whales, dolphins, and porpoises (cetaceans) and the global management and regulation of whaling activities.**
- Established under the International Convention for the Regulation of Whaling (ICRW), signed in Washington, D.C., on December 2, 1946.
- **It maintains its operational secretariat in Impington, near Cambridge, United Kingdom.**
- **Joined by India in 1981, which has consistently supported conservation frameworks and opposed commercial hunting quotas.**
- **Legally Binding Schedule:** Sets catch limits, whale sanctuaries and hunting restrictions, including the Indian Ocean and Southern Ocean Sanctuaries.

International

Projects & Agreement

India-Mercosur Preferential Trade Agreement

- Recently, India and MERCOSUR signed **the First Additional Protocol to the India–MERCOSUR Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA)** to facilitate acceptance of electronic Certificates of Origin.

MERCOSUR Group

- The Southern Common Market (MERCOSUR for its Spanish initials) is a South American regional economic organization.
- It is the fourth largest integrated market after the European Union (EU), North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA), and ASEAN.
- It was created in **1991 by signing the Treaty of Asunción.**
- Objective: Free movement of goods, services, capital and people and it became a customs union in January 1995.

Member countries

- It originally comprised **Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay, and Uruguay as its members.**
- **Bolivia and Venezuela joined it later. (Venezuela has been suspended since December 1, 2016).**
- **Mercosur also counts Chile, Colombia, Ecuador, Guyana, Peru, and Suriname as associate members.**
- **Headquarters: Montevideo, Uruguay.**
- Its official **working languages are Spanish and Portuguese.**
- The group's presidency rotates every six months among its full members.



India and MERCOSUR

- **The India-MERCOSUR PTA was signed on 25 January 2004** and **entered into force on 1 June 2009.**
- The Agreement provides preferential tariff concessions **on 450 tariff lines by India and 452 tariff lines by the MERCOSUR side.**

NCRTC presents India's first regional rapid transit system Namo Bharat at InnoTrans 2026 in Berlin

- **The National Capital Region Transport Corporation (NCRTC)** is showcasing India's **first Regional Rapid Transit System, Namo Bharat,** and its role **in transforming mobility in the National Capital Region** at InnoTrans 2026 in Berlin.

- The international transport technology fair is being held from September 22 to 25.
- **The 82-kilometre Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut Namo Bharat corridor, connecting Sarai Kale Khan in Delhi with Modipuram in Meerut, is being presented at the event.**
- The entire corridor became operational in February this year.
- The system aims to improve regional connectivity, reduce congestion and pollution, and provide wider access to employment and economic centres.

Summits & Conferences

26th SCO Summit begins in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

- The 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit begins in **Bishkek, the capital of Kyrgyzstan**.
- The SCO Summit 2026 Bishkek **is hosted by Kyrgyzstan** during its 2025-2026 rotating chairmanship.
- It is being held to **mark the 25th anniversary of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation.**
- The theme of this year's SCO summit **is '25 Years of the SCO: Together Towards Sustainable Peace, Development and Prosperity'.**
- The SCO has **10 member countries**, including India, China and Russia.
- The SCO originated as the **Shanghai Five in 1996. China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan** formed the grouping to address regional security and border related concerns.
- **Establishment:** The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation was formally established on **15 June 2001 in Shanghai, China.**
- **India has been a full member of the SCO since 2017.**

Prime Minister's Address: Prime Minister Narendra Modi is addressing the 26th SCO Summit.

- His **intervention highlights India's priorities concerning security, connectivity and opportunity**.
- **Security Priority:** India has consistently stressed that terrorism, separatism and extremism must be addressed without double standards. Modi called for collective opposition to terrorism in all its forms.
- **Security, Connectivity, Opportunity**: Modi described the three major pillars of India's SCO approach **as "Security, Connectivity and Opportunity."**

SCO Names Lahore Tourism and Cultural Capital

- Lahore in Pakistan was **designated as the Tourism and Cultural Capital** for the 2026–27 term by the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO).
- The decision was finalised at the 26th meeting of the SCO Council of Heads of State in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, and **the chairmanship of the SCO was transferred to Pakistan for the 2026–2027 period.**
- **Lahore is the capital of Punjab province in Pakistan** and is known for **Mughal-era monuments, Sufi shrines, and colonial architecture.**
- The city includes the **Lahore Fort, Shalimar Gardens, Badshahi Mosque, and the Walled City**, which are major heritage sites in South Asia.
- Pakistan adopted the theme "**Turning Vision into Action: Connectivity, Innovation and Shared Prosperity**" for its SCO chairmanship.

Introduction to BRICS

- **The Concept:** In **2001, Jim O'Neill,** a chief economist at Goldman Sachs, coined the acronym **"BRIC"** (Brazil, Russia, India, and China). He predicted these **four rapidly developing economies** would **dominate** the global economy **by 2050.**
- **First Formal Meeting:** The **foreign ministers** of the **four BRIC nations** held their first high-level meeting on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in **September 2006**
- **The Inaugural Summit (2009):** The very first official BRIC Summit took place on **June 16, 2009, in Yekaterinburg, Russia**
- **Expansion to BRICS (2010):** In **December 2010, South Africa was officially invited** to join the group, expanding the acronym to **BRICS**. South Africa attended its first summit as a full member in Sanya, China, in 2011.
- **The New Development Bank (2014):** During the **6th BRICS Summit in Fortaleza, Brazil**, the bloc **signed the treaty** to **establish** the **New Development Bank (NDB)**
- **Headquartered in Shanghai**, the NDB was created as an alternative to the Western-led World Bank and IMF to fund infrastructure in developing nations.
- **The Historic Expansion (2023):** At the **15th BRICS Summit in Johannesburg, South Africa**, the bloc announced a massive expansion plan. They **invited six new nations** to join
- **By 2026**, the alliance fully integrated its expanded **11 official member nations** alongside a newly formalized **"Partner Country" tier** to accommodate growing global interest.

18th BRICS Summit 2026

- Took place on **September 12–13, 2026**, at the **Bharat Mandapam** in New Delhi - marking 20 years since the grouping's founding.
- **Host and Chair**: **India** assumed the role of Chair of BRICS for the **4th time** on **January 1, 2026** (Previously - **2012, 2016, and 2021**).
- **Theme:** Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation, and Sustainability
- It concluded with the unanimous adoption of the **New Delhi Declaration**, establishing new economic, trade, and diplomatic frameworks for the newly expanded group.
- **Attendance:** Leaders from the **11 member nations** (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Iran, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Ethiopia, the UAE and Indonesia) alongside partner countries and invitees
- With 11 members, **BRICS represents around 49.5% of global population**, **40% of global GDP** and **26% of global trade.**
- **Official Partner System:** The summit **formalized the "Partner Country" tier** rather than granting full membership to new applicants.
- **10 nations** were officially recognized as partners: Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan, and Vietnam.
- **17th BRICS Summit (2025)** – Brazil
- **19th BRICS Summit (2027) – China**

Heads of State & Government Attending:

- **India (Host):** Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- **China:** President Xi Jinping
- **Russia:** President Vladimir Putin
- **South Africa:** President Cyril Ramaphosa

- **Iran:** President Masoud Pezeshkian
- **Egypt:** President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi
- **Ethiopia:** Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed
- **Indonesia:** President Prabowo Subianto

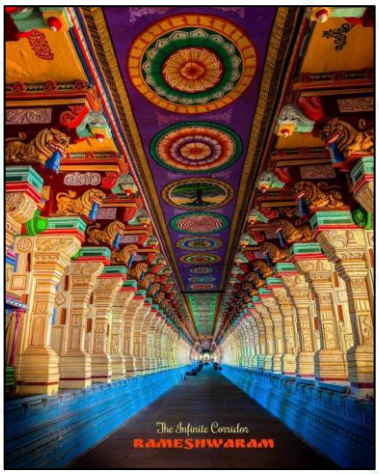
High-Level Envoys & Representatives

A few member states chose to be represented by senior cabinet ministers or royal family members rather than their direct heads of state:

- **Brazil:** Represented by Foreign Minister **Mauro Vieira** (**President Lula da Silva** remained in Brazil to oversee local elections).
- **UAE:** Represented by the Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, **Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan**.
- **Saudi Arabia:** Represented by **Foreign Minister Prince Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud.**

Modi greets BRICS leaders against backdrop of Tamil Nadu's Ramanathaswamy temple

- The Ramanathaswamy temple stands in the town of **Rameswaram on Pamban Island.**
- It is one of India's most important religious sites and is counted **among the 12 Jyotirlingas .** According to tradition, Lord Ram worshipped Lord Shiva at this site on his return from Lanka.
- The Ramanathaswamy Temple in Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu, is a masterwork of Dravidian architecture. It is celebrated globally for having the **longest pillared corridor** in the world.
- The **famous outer corridor** is largely credited to the **18th-century ruler Muthuramalinga Sethupathi**, the zamindar of the Ramnad estate.



Its key features:

- 1,212 pillars, each rising to approximately 6.9 metres.
- The combined length of the temple's corridors is commonly cited as about 3,850 feet, or roughly **1.17 km.**
- It is regarded as the **longest temple corridor in the world.**
- **BRICS leaders plant** great banyan tree **saplings at Bharat Mandapam**



PM Modi releases two stamps marking 20 years of BRICS journey

- The commemorative stamp, bearing the inscription **"BRICS: Two Decades of Cooperation, 2006–2026"** / "ब्रिक्स: सहयोग के दो दशक, 2006–2026"

PM Modi gifts Russian translation of 'Thirukkural' to President Putin at BRICS Summit

- The **Thirukkural** is an ancient and timeless **Tamil literary classic** composed by the poet-philosopher **Thiruvalluvar** over 2,000 years ago.
- The text—which **focuses on ethics, righteous statecraft, and human virtues**—emphasized the civilizational ties and deep philosophical respect between India and Russia.



BRICS adopt New Delhi Declaration on first day of summit

West Asia Conflict:

- BRICS adopted balanced language on the conflict instead of assigning direct responsibility, accommodating differing positions within the grouping.

The declaration called for:

- Maximum restraint and avoidance of actions that aggravate the conflict.
- Dialogue and diplomacy for a durable peace.
- Respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity of states.
- Protection of civilians and civilian infrastructure.
- Continuity of trade, supply chains and energy flows.
- BRICS expressed serious concern over attacks on civilian infrastructure and peaceful nuclear facilities under IAEA (International Atomic Energy Agency) safeguards.

Gaza and Palestine - BRICS called for:

- Maintenance of the **ceasefire** and unhindered humanitarian access.
- Opposition to forced displacement of Palestinians.
- Protection of civilians and civilian infrastructure.
- Opposition to starvation as a method of warfare.
- Support for **UNRWA** (United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East).
- A **two-state solution**, with a Palestinian state based on the 1967 borders and East Jerusalem as its capital.
- Palestinian self-determination, right of return and full UN membership.
- **Lebanon:** The declaration also called for adherence to the Lebanon ceasefire, Israeli withdrawal from remaining Lebanese territory and an inclusive political transition in Syria

Terrorism

- BRICS strongly condemned terrorism in all its forms and manifestations and specifically **condemned the April 2025 Pahalgam terrorist attack**, in which 26 people were killed.
- It highlighted terror financing, safe havens, extremism and radicalisation among youth, international counter-terrorism cooperation, zero tolerance for terrorism, and rejection of double standards in countering terrorism.
- Terrorism should not be associated with any particular religion, nationality, civilisation or ethnic group. It also recognised the role of the **BRICS Counter-Terrorism Working Group (CTWG).**

Trade

- Amid rising tariffs and trade tensions, BRICS **opposed unilateral coercive measures** that are inconsistent with international law, the UN Charter and WTO principles.
- It **called for a fair, stable and predictable global trading environment** that supports sustainable development.
- BRICS **opposed unilateral** Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanisms **(CBAMs)** when they are punitive, discriminatory or protectionist.
  - A Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) is a fee or tariff applied to imported goods - such as steel, aluminum, and cement - based on the greenhouse gases emitted during their production

BRICS did not announce a common BRICS currency.

- Instead, it adopted a gradual approach towards increasing the use of local currencies in cross-border transactions.

Key points include:

- Interoperability of national payment systems.
- Faster, cheaper and safer cross-border payments.
- Greater use of local currencies for trade and investment.
- Technical work by the BRICS Payment Task Force.
- Expansion of local-currency financing by the New Development Bank (NDB).
- Continued work on a proposed New Investment Platform.
- Exploration of **India's proposed BRICS Risk Lab at GIFT City**.

BRICS Support for UNSC Reform

- BRICS reached consensus on global governance reforms, strengthening multilateralism and **supporting India's bid for a permanent UNSC seat**.
- The UN Security Council has 15 members: 5 permanent members—China, France, Russia, UK and US—and 10 non-permanent members.
- Its structure largely reflects the geopolitical order of 1945, despite the UN expanding from 51 to 193 members.



BRICS countries have agreed to establish a collaborative, non-binding and farmer-centric BRICS AGRIN

- **BRICS AGRIN** - Strengthen cooperation among member countries regarding agricultural inputs, seeds, germplasm, and genetic resources - to be called **Brics Grain Exchange**
- BRICS also welcomed the launch of a **Global Forum on Farmers' Rights in Seed Systems.**

A rare Himalayan ingredient gucchi mushroom has found its way onto the BRICS Summit 2026.

- Appearance: These are **recognisable by their honeycomb-like caps,** which range from pale yellow to dark brown. **Their stems are typically pale and hollow.**
- **Distribution: It is found in parts of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand.**
- **Habitat:** The mushroom typically grows in mountainous coniferous forests, **where a combination of soil conditions, moisture, temperature fluctuations and seasonal snowmelt** creates a suitable environment.
- **It cannot easily be mass-cultivated.**
- Mountain communities **collect gucchi by hand, often trekking through steep and rugged terrain**.
- Fresh morels or mushrooms contain substantial moisture. They are **commonly dried to preserve them** and extend their shelf life, but the process significantly reduces their weight.
- They **may or may not grow in the same spot the next season**, which only makes the process of collection more tedious.
- It is known to be **one of the most expensive mushrooms.**
- Health Benefits: Gucchi mushrooms contain protein, **dietary fibre and various antioxidant compounds. They are also reported to contain vitamin D**

The BRICS 'POWER' Framework

- Ahead of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, Chinese Ambassador Xu Feihong proposed a **'POWER' framework for Greater BRICS**, calling for stronger Global South cooperation, closer India-China coordination, and collaboration on AI and supply chains.
- The BRICS grouping—following its historic expansions (BRICS+)—has evolved from an economic dialogue forum into a leading multilateral platform for the Global South, offering an **alternative to traditional Western-dominated institutions such as the G-7.**

India Hosted BRICS Chief Justices' Forum

- The Supreme Court of India announced that India hosted the **three-day BRICS Chief Justices' Forum in New Delhi.**
- The forum began on 4 September 2026 and was scheduled to continued until 6 September 2026
- **Chief Justice of India Justice Surya Kant opened the forum**
- BRICS is an intergovernmental grouping that originally **included Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa.**
- **As India (2026 chair) and China (incoming 2027 chair)** hold successive presidencies, the proposed 'POWER' architecture outlines five foundational pillars to guide political, financial, technological, and developmental cooperation across emerging markets.
- The Five Pillars of BRICS 'POWER':

P — Principle (Sovereign Equality & International Law):

O — Openness (Safeguarding Multilateral Trade):

W — Win-Win (Development-Centric Global Agenda):

E — Engine (Propelling Global Growth & Industrialization):

- **R — Responsibility (Successive Presidencies & Global South Leadership):**

Global Dryland Congress 2026 is underway in New Delhi

- Asia, Africa and the Americas will converge in New Delhi for the three-day Global Dryland Congress 2026.
- The Congress, themed '**Transforming Dryland Agriculture with South-South Cooperation'**, is being jointly organised by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research **(ICAR) and the International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT).**

Seoul Hosts 27th World Knowledge Forum

- The **27th World Knowledge Forum opened in Seoul, South Korea.**
- The three-day forum, organised by Maekyung Media Group, runs **until 10 September 2026 and focuses on artificial intelligence, co-intelligence, and global economic change.**
- The World Knowledge Forum is an **annual international conference held in South Korea.**
- The theme "**The Promethean Moment: Architecting the Co-Intelligence Order**".

Ministry of Culture will organize the BRICS Theatre Festival 2026 from 12 to 14 October 2026

- The Ministry of Culture will organise the BRICS Theatre Festival 2026 from October 12 to 14 in New Delhi as part of India's BRICS Presidency 2026.
- The **three-day festival, themed "Shared Stories, Shared Futures"**
- The festival will feature participants from **India, Thailand, Indonesia, Russia, Vietnam, Iran, South Africa, Kazakhstan and Ethiopia.**
- The festival will be **inaugurated at the National School of Drama (NSD) on October 12.**

Films and Cultural Currents

Marathi film Gondhal becomes India's Oscars 2027 entry

- Marathi cinema has secured a place in India's Oscar campaign this year, with **Santosh Davakhar's Gondhal selected as the country's official entry for the 99th Academy Awards.**
- The film chosen from a field of 33 submissions **for the Best International Feature Film category.**
- The Marathi thriller, which draws **heavily from Maharashtra's traditional Gondhal ritual and folk-performance tradition, had already received a major festival recognition** before its Oscar selection.
- The film's director Davakhar won the Silver Peacock for Best Director at the 56th International Film Festival of India (IFFI) in 2025.

Malayalam movie HALF screened under Midnight Madness section at Toronto film festival



- **Malayalam film HALF** was screened under the Midnight Madness section of the prestigious Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF)
- It was the **first Malayalam film to be screened in the section at TIFF**, and it evoked an enthusiastic response from the audience,

'Kamathipura Express,' starring Vipin Sharma, wins 2026 Bronze Student Academy Award

- **Kamathipura Express**, a Warsaw Film School production starring **Indian actor Vipin Sharma**, has won the **2026 Bronze Student Academy Award in the Narrative category.**
- The Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences named the film among the winners of the 53rd Student Academy Awards, selected from 2,972 entries submitted by 894 colleges and universities worldwide.
- **The film, directed by Leon Korzyński.**
- The win makes Kamathipura Express eligible to compete in the Live Action Short Film category at the 99th Academy Awards.
- The Student Academy Awards ceremony was held for the first time in association with the Toronto International Film Festival (TIFF).
- **Angh, directed by Naga filmmaker, wins Platform Prize 2026 at TIFF**
- Indian film Angh has won the coveted Platform Prize at the 2026 Toronto International Film Festival.
- The film, directed by **Theja Rio, is set and rooted in Nagaland.**
- **Angh has also now directly qualified for the Best International Feature Film at the Academy Awards.**
- TIFF's Platform Prize is one of only six international festival awards with a direct pathway to the Oscars.
- **This means that Angh will be vying with other national entries, including India's Gondhal**, for a nomination in the Best International Feature Film category at the 2027 Oscars.

International Legal News

The Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA)

- The Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA) ruled that the **Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) remains in force and restricted certain works on the Ratle Hydroelectric Project.**
- India rejected the ruling, calling the arbitration illegally constituted and its decision null and void.

The Indus Waters Treaty

- **Origin:** Signed in 1960 between **India and Pakistan** with the help of the **World Bank, which is also a signatory.**
- **Objective:** To determine the distribution of the waters of the Indus and its tributaries between India and Pakistan.

Division of water:

- **Eastern Rivers:** (Ravi, Beas, and Sutlej) for India's unrestricted use.
- **Western Rivers:** (Indus, Jhelum, and Chenab) are allocated to Pakistan but India allowed for specific non-consumptive uses like navigation, flood protection or flood control, Domestic use, Agricultural use, Generation of hydro-electric power etc.
- **According to Article III (1)** of the Treaty, "India is under obligation to let flow" waters of the Western Rivers to Pakistan.

UK Recognises India's Carbon Credit Scheme

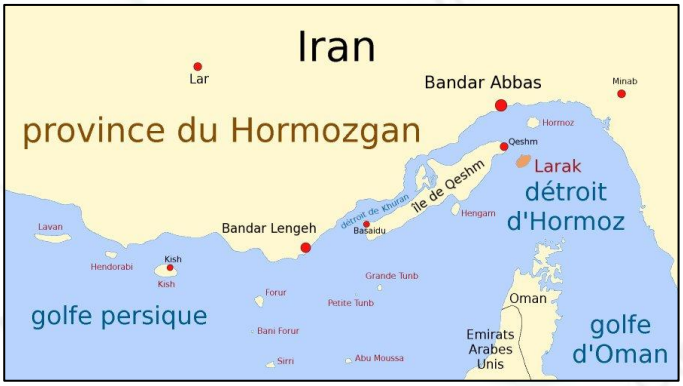
- The United Kingdom has officially recognized **India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) as a qualifying carbon pricing framework** under its **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM).**
- A national market-based mechanism designed to establish the Indian Carbon Market (ICM) by pricing greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, **issuing tradable Carbon Credit Certificates (CCCs), and driving industrial decarbonization.**
- Notified by the Government of India in June 2023 under powers conferred by the Energy Conservation (Amendment) Act, 2022, with detailed compliance regulations adopted in July 2024.
- Aim: To accelerate the **decarbonization of the Indian economy, fulfill India's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) under the Paris Agreement**, and incentivize emission cuts across energy-intensive sectors through a transparent carbon-trading exchange.

Thailand allows visa-free entry and stay up to 30 days for Indian tourists

- Thailand is set to introduce **new entry rules for tourists from more than 60 countries, including Indian passport holders**, effective **September 15, 2026**.
- The new regulations will replace the **60-day visa-exemption scheme introduced in 2024**, under which eligible Indian travellers could **stay in Thailand visa-free for up to 60 days.**

Mocha Port

- The Iran-aligned Houthis recently took control of the Yemeni port city of Mocha, advancing strategically down the Red Sea coast.
- **Mokha, or Mocha, is a historic town located in southwestern Yemen, on the Red Sea.**
- It was **long famous as Arabia's chief coffee-exporting center** and the source of the term mocha.
- It is the **chief port on the northern approach to the Bab el-Mandeb Strait** and is situated about 75 km north of Perim (Mayun) Island, where the strait reaches its narrowest point.



Larak Island

- Recently, Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles at US bases in Jordan after the Larak Island strike.
- Larak Island is a **small island located in the Straits of Hormuz.**
- It is to the south of Hormuz Island approximately 45 kms southeast of Bandar Abbas and 18 kms southeast of the eastern end of Qeshm Island.
- **Larak's importance is closely tied to the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow waterway linking the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman.**

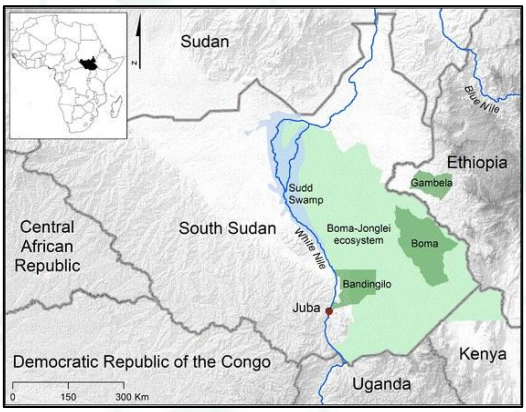
Key Facts about Straits of Hormuz



- It is a **narrow waterway between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula,** specifically the **United Arab Emirates, and Musandam (Oman).**
- The Gulf of Oman is on the strait's east, while the Persian Gulf is on the west.
- It is the only sea channel linking the oil-rich Persian Gulf (west) with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea (southeast).
- **Iran is located on the north coast, while the UAE is on the south coast.**
- Islands: Some of the islands located in the Strait of Hormuz are

  Hengam, Hormuz, and Qishm

The Badingilo-Boma Landscape



- The **Boma-Badingilo Migratory Landscape was officially inscribed as South Sudan's first-ever UNESCO World Heritage Site.**
- South Sudan's first World Heritage property under the natural heritage criteria.
- A contiguous transboundary wilderness and wildlife corridor network **centered on Boma National Park and Badingilo National Park.**

'Nazrul Borsho' is being observed in Bangladesh

- **Nazrul Borsho, or Nazrul Year**, is being observed in Bangladesh **from May 25, 2026 to May 25, 2027 to commemorate the 127th birth anniversary of the country's national poet**.
- Nazrul, popularly known as the "Bidrohi Kobi" (rebel poet), was born in 1899 in Churulia in present-day West Bengal
- The year-long observance of 'Nazrul Borsho' seeks to highlight his literary, musical and cultural legacy through programmes across Bangladesh and international initiatives.



Giorgia Meloni Becomes Italy's Longest-Serving Postwar Prime Minister

- Giorgia Meloni became the longest continuously serving postwar Prime Minister in the history of the Italian Republic on 4 September 2026 after **completing 1,413 consecutive days in office.**
- She assumed office on **22 October 2022 and leads the right-wing Brothers of Italy party, known in Italian as Fratelli d'Italia.**

- She is the **first woman to serve as Prime Minister of Italy.**
- The postwar period in Italy began after the end of the Second World War in 1945.
- Meloni surpassed the previous postwar continuity **record of 1,412 days set by Silvio Berlusconi** during his second administration.

US Names India, China and Pakistan in Drug Transit List

- The US named included **India, China and Pakistan in its list of "major drug transit or major illicit drug producing countries**" for fiscal year 2027,
- while separately identifying **Afghanistan, Bolivia, Burma and Colombia** as countries that **failed demonstrably to meet their international counternarcotics obligations**.
- India was named among the 23 countries named in the FY2027 determination.
- The annual presidential determination, submitted to the US Congress , covers 23 countries and is used in US counternarcotics policy.

U.S. House passes Russia sanctions Bill seeking to impose up to 100% tariffs on India, others



- **US House of Representatives** passed the **Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, 2026**, which could empower the US President to impose **tariffs of up to 100%** on countries buying Russian oil and natural gas.
- **India angle:** The legislation is significant for India as **Russia is a major source of India's crude oil imports**.
- **Presidential discretion:** The latest version allows tariffs of up to **100% on the five largest buyers** of Russian oil and natural gas.
- **Earlier proposal:** The original version had proposed tariffs of up to **500%**, making the latest proposal substantially lower.

World's First Artificial Energy Island in Belgium



- Belgium is currently building the **Princess Elisabeth Island**, the world's first artificial energy island, located 45 kilometers off its coast in the North Sea.
- The project is **designed as a 5-hectare offshore energy hub for grid connection infrastructure linked to offshore wind power.**
- Princess Elisabeth Island is planned as a multi-purpose energy island for the Belgian electricity grid.
- The project is **associated with Elia Transmission Belgium,**
- The project is expected to **become operational in 2031.**

What is Switzerland's 'neutrality initiative'?

- The 'neutrality initiative' was a Swiss constitutional proposal aimed at embedding a much stricter, unyielding definition of military and economic non-alignment into the country's Federal Constitution.
- The initiative sought to redefine and lock the parameters of Swiss foreign policy into the constitution under three main conditions:
  - **"Perpetual and Armed" Neutrality**
  - **No Military Alliance Cooperation**
  - **Banning Independent Economic Sanctions**

Disease and Calamities

Fiji Declares National HIV Emergency Amid Sharp Rise in HIV Infections

- **Fiji Declares National HIV Emergency** after a sharp rise in HIV infections, **prompting the government to expand testing, treatment and prevention measures.**
- The development has brought renewed attention to the **growing HIV burden in the Pacific island nation and the gaps in diagnosis and treatment.**

What is HIV?

- **Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV)** is a virus that **attacks the body's immune system, particularly CD4 cells**, which help the body fight infections.
- **Without treatment, HIV can progressively weaken the immune system** and may **lead to Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome (AIDS),** the most advanced stage of HIV infection.
- **Antiretroviral treatment can suppress HIV** and help people living with the virus lead healthy lives.

How is HIV Transmitted?

- HIV is **transmitted through certain body fluids** when they enter the body of another person.
- **Sexual transmission**: Through exposure to infected sexual fluids.
- **Blood transmission:** Through infected blood.
- **Injecting drug use:** Through sharing contaminated needles or syringes.
- **Mother-to-child transmission**: During pregnancy, childbirth or breastfeeding.
- HIV is not transmitted through ordinary social contact, such as hugging, shaking hands or sharing everyday spaces.

Initiatives, Programmes and Alliance

India, US Secure Undersea Cable Networks under TRUST Initiative

- India and the United States have **expanded cooperation on undersea cable networks under the US-India TRUST (Transforming the Relationship Utilising Strategic Technologies) Initiative.**
- The partnership **covers subsea systems that carry more than 95% of global digital traffic and support international communications**, financial services, cloud computing, and the global digital economy.
- The undersea cable partnership falls within this framework and involves government and industry stakeholders.
- TRUST stands for **Transforming the Relationship Utilising Strategic Technologies.**
- Undersea or submarine cables are fibre-optic cables laid on the seabed for long-distance data transmission.
- **The Indo-Pacific region contains major cable routes linking Asia, Europe, and North America.**

India and Liberia Launch Maritime Safety Group

- **India and Liberia** launched the **"Group of Friends on Safety & Security of Shipping & Seafarers" in New York**
- The initiative was announced **during the United Nations General Assembly High-Level Week, and India and Liberia will serve as co-chairs of the group.**
- Its stated objectives include technical standards for vessels, compliance with maritime rules, environmental stewardship, protection of commercial sea lanes, and welfare of seafarers.

India co-hosts launch of global partnership to advance sickle cell care

- Recently, India co-hosted the launch of **OneSCD on the sidelines of the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA 81) in New York.**
- It is a **global partnership to advance equity and transform Sickle Cell Care.**
- It is a multilateral coordination mechanism designed to strengthen and support existing country-led Sickle Cell Disease (SCD) programs and help scale proven approaches to care.
- **Hosted By**: It was hosted by the Government of the Federal **Republic of Nigeria** and **co-organized with UNICEF, WHO, Africa CDC, the World Coalition on Sickle Cell Disease, and St. Jude Children's Research Hospital.**

Sickle Cell Disease

- It is a group of **inherited blood cell disorders that affect hemoglobin, the molecule in red blood cells (RBCs) that delivers oxygen to cells throughout the body.**
- The most common and severe type of SCD is sickle cell anemia.
- **Normally, RBCs are disc-shaped and flexible enough to move easily through the blood vessels.**
- People with SCD have atypical hemoglobin molecules called hemoglobin S**, which can distort RBCs into a sickle, or crescent, shape.**
- Signs and symptoms of sickle cell disease usually begin in early childhood.
- **Early stage: Extreme tiredness or fussiness from anemia (low number of RBCs), painfully swollen hands and feet, and jaundice.**
- Later stage: Severe pain, anemia, organ damage, and infections.
- **Treatments: A bone marrow transplant (stem cell transplant) can cure SCD.**

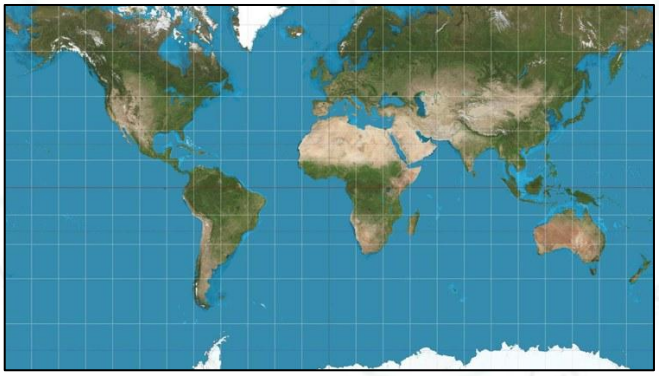
Miscellaneous

UN backs resolution on Africa's map size

- The United Nations General Assembly approved an African-led resolution on 4 September 2026 to promote maps that show continents in more accurate relative sizes.
- The resolution supports the **use of the Equal Earth projection** and **moves away from the 16th-century Mercator projection** in educational and public mapping contexts.
- The **Mercator projection was developed in 1569 by Gerardus Mercator, a Flemish cartographer.**
- It preserves direction and local shape, which made it useful for marine navigation, but it enlarges landmasses near the poles and distorts relative area.

Equal Earth Projection

- The Equal Earth projection is an **equal-area map projection introduced in 2018**. It keeps the proportional area of continents and countries closer to their actual size, which makes it suitable for thematic maps and school atlases.
- **The resolution, led by Togo and backed by the African Union, was adopted by 164 votes in favour, with 6 abstentions and 1 vote against.**
- **The United States, the only country to vote against the resolution,**



- It is not legally binding and it "in no way challenges the use of the Mercator projection for maritime and aerial navigation, for which it remains fully suited,

Index & Reports

National

India Electric Mobility Index 2025 announced by NITI Aayog; Delhi emerges top performer in adopting Electric Mobility

- Delhi has retained its **top position in India's Electric Mobility Index 2025**
- The Index was **launched by the NITI Aayog**
- This is the second edition of the Index and it measures the **progress of States and Union Territories in achieving their Electric Mobility goals.**
- The IEMI tracks, evaluates and scores all Indian States and UTs out of 100 across 16 indicators under **three core themes, Transport Electrification Progress, Charging Infrastructure Readiness and EV Research and Innovation Status.**
- It aims to inform decision-making, foster healthy competition among states, and promote sharing of best practices.
- **Maharashtra and Karnataka, at second and third position,** have emerged as the only two top-performing states in the large state category in advancing their e-mobility ecosystem compared to the previous year.
- **Chandigarh and Goa were the other top-performing States and Union Territories**

State of Global Water Resources Report

- **India's groundwater levels are declining persistently**, according to the **State of Global Water Resources 2025 report** published by the **World Meteorological Organization (WMO)** recently.
- It is annually published by the World Meteorological Organization (WMO).
- It provides a comprehensive quantitative overview of global water resources, with a focus on hydrological variability and trends.

Report Highlights:

- Satellite observations and hydrological models showed that **42% of global land area had below-normal water storage in 2025.**
- The measure covers water in rivers, streams and lakes, groundwater, soil moisture, snow and ice.
- For the fourth consecutive year, every major glaciated region on Earth lost ice mass.
- **Central Asia, western Canada and the United States** were among the regions **recording particularly severe glacier losses.**
- **2025 was one of the driest years for the world's rivers in 35 years,** with normal flows recorded across just 36% of global river basin area.
- Persistent groundwater deficits were observed during 2022–2025 in parts of the Americas, Europe, the Middle East, India, southern Africa and Australia, with over-abstraction identified as an important driver in several regions.
- **Asia and Africa together** accounted for at least **half of all recorded water-related extreme events** and more than 80% of reported associated deaths over the past five years.

India-Specific Findings:

- India **recorded below-normal terrestrial water storage in 2025**, particularly across the northern part of the country.
- Among India's major river systems, **the Ganges, Godavari, Krishna and Indus recorded above-normal to much-above-normal discharge in 2025.**
- However, the higher river flows did not translate into a broad recovery of India's deeper water reserves.
- The WMO found persistent groundwater deficits in India during 2022-2025, with widespread below-normal to much-below-normal groundwater levels, particularly in northwestern India.

Domestic Tourism Expenditure Survey

- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation's (MoSPI) released Domestic Tourism Expenditure Survey.
- **The previous survey was conducted from July 2014 to June 2015.**
- The latest Domestic Tourism Expenditure Survey **covered 2.46 lakh households from across the country, except villages in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands** which are difficult to access.
- Of the surveyed households, **1.43 lakh were from rural areas and 1.04 lakh from urban.**
- Overall, the 2025-26 survey showed holidaying was the **main purpose for 22% of trips, pilgrimage and religious trips 48%,** and **health and medical reasons were behind almost 30% of them.**
- **Tamil Nadu accounted for 23.8% of overnight holiday trips, followed by Maharashtra (9.6%), and Karnataka (8.6%).**
- Tamil Nadu **also led in the 'pilgrimage and religious' category** and was responsible for 14.8% of these trips, **followed by Uttar Pradesh (13.6%), and Rajasthan (9.2%).**
- The **largest contributors to health and medical trips** were **Uttar Pradesh (12.1%), West Bengal (10.9%), and Bihar (8.9%).** The most money was spent on health and medical trips.
- While 'pilgrimage and religious' was the main reason for **nearly half of all overnight trips, 'social' and 'shopping' were the leading purposes for nearly 60% of all same-day trips.**

International

GIFT City Rises to 37th Position in Global Ranking

- GIFT City has climbed **nine places to rank 37th globally in the 40th edition of the Global Financial Centres Index ,** while entering the top 15 financial centres in the Asia-Pacific region.
- **GIFT City, which was ranked 46th in GFCI 39th edition**, is now the **only Indian financial centre among the top 15 in the Asia-Pacific region.**
- The latest ranking also placed GIFT City 26th globally in FinTech, up three places from 29th in the previous edition.

14 Indian B-schools among world's top 100 in FT Masters in Management ranking; IIM Bangalore leads

- Fourteen Indian B-schools, including **seven Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs), have secured a spot among the world's top 100 in the Financial Times (FT) Masters in Management (MiM) 2026 ranking**
- Among the Indian institutions, **the best-ranked is IIM Bangalore, followed by SP Jain Institute of Management & Research (SPJIMR), Mumbai.**
- IIM Bangalore, ranked 21st, improved from its 28th position in 2025 and 41st rank in 2024.
- **SPJIMER has been ranked 26th worldwide**, followed closely by IIM Ahmedabad at the 27th position.

- **XLRI secured the 33rd rank, while IIM Calcutta was placed at 39th globally**.
- Further down the list are IIM Kozhikode (54), IIM Indore (62), Management Development Institute Gurgaon (67), IIM Lucknow (72), Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies (NMIMS) Mumbai (73), IIM Udaipur (83), Institute of Management Technology (IMT) Ghaziabad (86), International Management Institute (IMI) Delhi (90) and TA Pai Management Institute Karnataka (98).
- At the global level, **the University of St Gallen in Switzerland continued to hold the top position** in the FT Masters in Management 2026 ranking.
- **Nova School of Business and Economics in Portugal secured the second rank**, while **Shanghai Jiao Tong University's Antai College of Economics and Management in China** was placed third.

Top 10 performing banks in the world in 2026: Forbes

- Forbes recently released the report for '**Top Performing Banks in the World in 2026' in collaboration with market research firm Statista.**
- The business magazine also mentioned that the ranking is a first, as it was obtained **on the basis of objective financial data through data providers like the S&P Capital IQ platform.**
- **Eligibility criteria** for inclusion in this ranking required banks to be **licensed deposit-taking institutions whose core business relied on lending to retail or corporate clients**, report under reconcilable national accounting standards, **publish financial statements for the most recent fully available** and audited fiscal year, **provide a minimum of three consecutive years of financial data, and possess more than $3 billion in assets.**
- The final bank rankings were calculated using four core metrics: **profitability (30 per cent), capital and funding resilience (25 per cent), asset quality and efficiency (25 per cent), and growth and earnings quality (20 per cent).**
- Prior to calculating the final scores, eligible **banks were divided into six asset-size tiers to ensure fair performance comparisons within their specific peer groups.**
- **Singaporean banks OCBC ($525B) and DCB ($698B) topped the list, ranking No. 1 and No. 2, respectively.**
- **HDFC Bank ($518B), the only Indian bank in the top 10, ranked No. 3**.
- China Merchants Bank, JPMorgan Chase, and Nordea Bank ranked No. 4, 5, and 6, respectively.
- Wells Fargo, UniCredit, and PNC Financial Services ranked seventh, eighth, and ninth, respectively. Rabobank closed out the top 10.

Rank	Bank	CEO	Assets ($B)	Headquarters
1	OCBC	Tan Teck Long	525	Singapore
2	DBS	Tan Su Shan	698	Singapore
3	HDFC Bank	Kapila Deshapriya	518	Mumbai, India
4	China Merchants Bank	Wang Xiaoqing (President)	2,000	Shenzhen, China
5	JPMorgan Chase	Jamie Dimon	4,900	New York, US

ISB ranks 5th globally; 7 Indian B-schools make top 100: LinkedIn Top MBA Programs 2026

- **LinkedIn has released its Top MBA Programs 2026,** ranking 100 business schools globally based on data on the long-term career outcomes of their alumni.
- **The Indian School of Business (ISB) has secured the fifth position** and is the highest-ranked Indian institution on the list.

- **Stanford University Graduate School of Business topped the ranking**, followed by Harvard Business School and the Wharton School.
- **INSEAD was ranked fourth, while ISB occupied the fifth position.**
- Besides ISB, the list includes Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad at 19, IIM Bangalore at 20, IIM Calcutta at 21, IIM Lucknow at 31, IIM Indore at 33, Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT) at 62 and IIM Udaipur at 83.

Rank	Institution
5	Indian School of Business
19	IIM Ahmedabad
20	IIM Bangalore
21	IIM Calcutta
31	IIM Lucknow
33	IIM Indore
62	IIFT
83	IIM Udaipur

QS MBA Rankings 2027: Top 3 IIMs slip, remain in global top 100

- **The three Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs) in the global top 100 of the QS Global Full-Time MBA Rankings 2027** have slipped from their positions last year, with IIM Calcutta recording the sharpest decline.
- **IIM Bangalore, the highest-ranked Indian institute, fell to 64th from 52nd**, while IIM Ahmedabad dropped to 70th from 58th.
- **IIM Calcutta slipped to 95th from 64th.**

Indian institute	QS MBA 2027	QS MBA 2026	Change
IIM Bangalore	64=	52	Down 12 places
IIM Ahmedabad	70=	58	Down 12 places
IIM Calcutta	95	64	Down 31 places

- Overall, 19 Indian institutions feature in the QS Global Full-Time MBA Rankings 2027, up from seven in 2022 and five in 2020.
- **Five Indian institutions have entered the ranking for the first time this year.**
- **India the fourth most represented country after the US, UK and France**.
- O.P. Jindal Global University (JGU) is the highest-ranked new Indian entrant, placed in the 171-180 band.

Rank	Business school	Country
1	MIT Sloan	US
2	Harvard Business School	US
3	Stanford Graduate School of Business	US
4	Penn (Wharton)	US
5	Cambridge Judge	UK
6	HEC Paris	France

- Other new entrants are Jaipuria Institute of Management, School of Business and Management, CHRIST (Deemed to be University), School of Leadership and Management, Manav Rachna International Institute of Research and Studies, and Vikrant University Gwalior. These institutions appear in the 301+ range.
- **Woxsen School of Business, ranked in the 251-300 band globally, recorded the strongest Indian performance on the Diversity lens**.
- **It ranks first in Asia and 33rd globally for diversity.**

India's rank on Global Gender Gap Index unchanged at 131



- India retained the **131st rank on the Global Gender Gap Index 2026.**
- **Released by the World Economic Forum**
- Iceland, Finland and Norway maintaining their top three slots respectively.
- Iceland was the only country to have closed more than 90% of the gender gap (93%).
- **Only 14 countries ranked below than India on the index of 145 countries.**
- These include Papua New Guinea, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Tajikistan, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Morocco, Mali, Algeria, and Congo.
- Chad was the lowest-ranked country in the index, with Iran and Pakistan joining it in the bottom three.
- In India, the world's most populous country with approximately 1.5 billion people, the progress towards gender parity stood at 64.5%, below the global average.
- **While India's score improved slightly over the last year, its global ranking remained unchanged at 131st.**
- Overall, India's gender parity increased by 4.3 percentage points since 2006, primarily due to gains in educational attainment.
- In the top ten, Namibia climbed four places to fourth, the highest-ranked country in Sub-Saharan Africa, followed by the United Kingdom, New Zealand, Sweden, Australia, Germany, and Ireland.
- **Australia entered the top 10 for the first time.**



The Global Business Climate Survey 2026

- India was ranked first in **business climate among 41 global markets in the Global Business Climate Survey 2026,** published by the **Swedish Chamber of Commerce in India (SCCI) alongside Business Sweden.**
- A premier annual international benchmark capturing the operational perspectives, performance, profitability, and expansion plans of Swedish multinational corporations operating across key global markets.
- **Organisation: Jointly produced by Business Sweden, the Swedish Chambers of Commerce (SCI / SCCI).**
- **Launched in: First instituted in 2020;** the 2026 edition represents the largest survey to date, covering 41 major economies across Western Europe, Asia-Pacific (APAC), MEA+, and the Americas.
- **Top Global Performers: India, Ireland, and Vietnam emerged as the top three highest-ranking markets globally**, standing out for economic momentum, political stability, and high investor confidence.

India's Standout Performance:

- **Ranked No. 1** overall in business climate favourability, **retaining a position in the global top three for four consecutive years.**
- **Along with the Philippines and Poland, India recorded the highest market-level revenue and growth projections.**

V-Dem's Democracy Index

- The latest V-Dem Democracy Report has placed **India's Electoral Democracy Index score at its lowest level since 1975**, continuing a decline **observed since 2009.**
- The Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Index is a **global framework that measures democracy using a multidimensional approach**, rather than **treating democracy merely as the conduct of elections.**
- It evaluates countries across dimensions such as **electoral integrity, civil liberties, institutional autonomy, judicial accountability, freedom of expression and public administration.**
- Published By: **Published by the Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Institute, based at the University of Gothenburg, Sweden.**
- Aim: To measure and compare different dimensions of democracy, track democratic progress or decline over time, and identify trends such as democratisation and autocratisation.

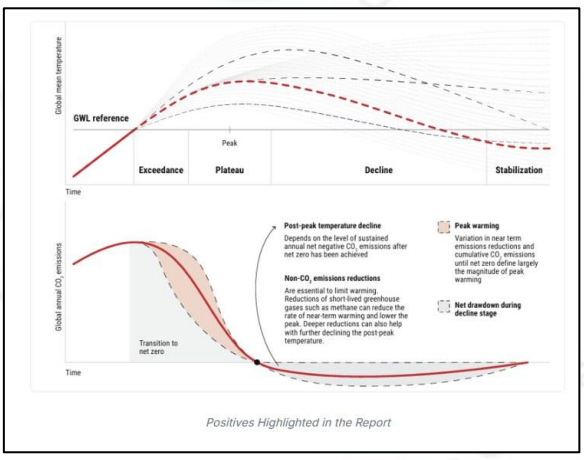


Key Findings on India:

- India's latest Electoral Democracy Index score is its **lowest since 1975, the year the Emergency was imposed.**
- V-Dem identifies India among countries undergoing slow autocratisation, characterised by what it describes as a systematic weakening of democratic institutions.
- Scores relating to judicial accountability, corruption, Election Management Body autonomy and impartial public administration are reportedly at their lowest levels in 50 years.
- The report records deterioration in academic and cultural expression alongside increased harassment of journalists.
- Indicators covering academic expression, freedom to research and teach, and institutional autonomy have also declined.

UNEP Limiting Overshoot Report

- The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) released a spotlight report titled "**Limiting Overshoot: Navigating Exceedance of 1.5°C and Pathways Towards Return."**
- The report highlights that breaching the 1.5°C warming limit is now unavoidable in the near term, outlining an "overshoot, peak, and decline" framework to restore climate stability by 2100.
- An overshoot pathway refers to a **scenario where global average surface temperatures temporarily exceed the internationally agreed target (1.5°C) before peaking and gradually declining back** below the limit through sustained



Positives Highlighted in the Report

net-negative emissions and deep decarbonization.

Key Findings

- Human-induced warming is nearing **1.4°C, rising at ~0.25°C per decade.**
- WMO estimates a **75% chance that the 2026–2030 average will exceed 1.5°C.**
- Only about 130 $GtCO_2$ remains from 2026 for a 50% chance of limiting warming to 1.5°C. At current emissions (~40 $GtCO_2$ annually), it could be exhausted in about three years.
- Current policies point to ~2.6°C warming by 2100. Even full implementation of NDCs and net-zero pledges could still result in peak warming of ~1.8°C.

India Ranks 31st in WEF Travel & Tourism Development Index 2026

- India ranked **31st in the World Economic Forum's Travel & Tourism Development Index 2026**, which assessed 110 economies and was published on 25 September 2026.
- The **World Economic Forum** published the TTDI 2026 in collaboration with **Zurich Insurance Group.**
- India **moved up nine places from 39th in the 2024 index**, while **Japan secured the first rank in the 2026 edition.**
- Japan ranked first in the TTDI 2026, **followed by the United States, Spain, Australia, and France.**
- **China was the only Asian economy other than Japan in the top 10.**
- The Travel & Tourism Development Index, or TTDI, **is a global index that measures the conditions supporting sustainable and resilient tourism growth.**
- It does not measure only tourist arrivals or tourism spending, and it **covers factors linked to the long-term development of the travel and tourism sector.**

Global Cities Index 2026

- **Delhi has secured the 268th position among 1,000 cities in the Oxford Economics Global Cities Index 2026.**
- It is an annual report **published by Oxford Economics, a leading global economic advisory firm.**
- The index ranks 1000 cities across the world based on **five major factors: Economics, Human Capital, Quality of Life, Environment and Governance.**
- The rankings are designed to **look at both a city's present performance and its future potential.**
- **New York has taken the top spot in the index.**
- **London has been ranked second, followed by Paris at third, Seattle at fourth, and San Francisco at fifth.**

India Findings:

- Around 100 Indian cities feature among the 1,000 major cities evaluated worldwide.
- **Delhi has the highest overall ranking at 268, followed by Bengaluru at 311, Mumbai at 330, Chennai at 381, Hyderabad at 421, and Pune at 427.**
- 55 Indian cities have secured spots among the world's top 100 fastest-growing city economies.
- **Delhi is currently the world's 63rd-largest city economy.**

WEF Survey Places India at Top of Global Growth Outlook

- **The World Economic Forum's** September 2026 Chief Economists' Outlook, based on an August 2026 survey, places India at the top of the **global growth outlook.**
- The survey covers expectations for growth, inflation, household incomes, and business conditions across major regions.

- It records the views of chief economists on macroeconomic trends, including growth, inflation, labour markets, and regional performance.
- **The survey placed China in a weaker position, with about one in three economists expecting weak growth.**
- **Europe remained the weakest region in the survey.**

IISc highest-ranked Indian institute at 254: THE World University Rankings 2027

- **The Indian Institute of Science (IISc) has achieved top position in India while 254 rank globally in the Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings 2027.**
- **The latest edition ranked 2,297 universities across 118 countries and territories, making it the most extensive edition of the ranking as per THE**
- **Overall, the University of Oxford has retained the number one position for the 11th consecutive year, followed by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) at second.**
- **Princeton University and Stanford University share third place, while the University of Cambridge is fifth.**
- **As per THE, Asia has overtaken continental Europe for the first time, while China's Tsinghua University has risen to 11th, moving ahead of Switzerland's ETH Zurich**
- **THE World University Rankings 2027: Indian universities**

University	Global rank
Indian Institute of Science	254
Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences	326–350
Shoolini University of Biotechnology and Management Sciences	451–500
Jamia Millia Islamia	501–550
KIIT University	501–550

Sports

National/ international Championships

India Ranks 10th at WorldSkills Shanghai 2026

- India ranks **10th at WorldSkills Shanghai which concluded on 27 September 2026.**
- India **won six Silver Medals and 20 Medals for Excellence, improving upon its 13th-place finish at WorldSkills Lyon 2024.**
- The **48th edition was held in Shanghai from 22 to 27 September 2026.**
- The competition **is held every two years** and **promotes international occupational standards, knowledge exchange and excellence in vocational skills.**
- Smriti Nambiar, who won the Silver Medal in Bakery, was also recognised as Best of the Nation for India.

Millie Shah, Rakesh Nidagundi Win Medals at Changwon

- Indian para-shooters **Millie Shah and Rakesh Nidagundi won team medals at the Changwon 2026 WSPS World Championships in South Korea** on 16 September 2026.
- Millie Shah won gold in the R2 team event, while Rakesh Nidagundi won silver in the R1 team event.
- These were India's first-ever team medals in rifle at the Para Shooting World Championships.

India to Host Asian Senior Wushu Championships for First Time in 2028

- India will host the **Asian Senior Wushu Championships for the first time in 2028,** with around 500 athletes from 42 countries across Asia expected to participate in the prestigious continental competition.
- **The decision was officially approved at the Wushu Federation of Asia (WFA) Congress held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.**

Asian Games

Asian Games 2026: Dates, venue, events and more



- The Asian Games 2026, **officially the 20th edition, will be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan,** from September 19 to October 4.
- Coinciding with the **75th anniversary of the very first Asian Games held back in 1951.**
- Double Olympic medallist **Manu Bhaker** and two-time Asian Games gold medallist **Tajinderpal Singh Toor** were named India's **flagbearers for 2026 Asian Games opening ceremony.**

Asian Games 2026 mascot



- The **20th Asian Games,** to be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, from September 19 to October 4, will have **Honohon as its official mascot.**
- The character's design is **inspired by the Shachihoko, a mythical creature** traditionally depicted with the **head of a tiger and the body of a carp.**
- The Shachihoko is closely associated with Nagoya and is **one of the distinctive symbols of the Nagoya Castle.**
- The mascot also incorporates the image of a flame, representing the passion and determination of athletes competing at the Games.
- The name Honohon is derived from the Japanese word **' honoho', which is connected to the origin of the Japanese word for flame.**
- **Honohon was designed by Yoshiyuki Nakagawa, a Japanese graphic designer.**

Asian Games: India win first medal, clinch women's 10m air rifle team silver


Results

RANK	BIB	NOC	TEAM	RESULT
1		CHN	People's Republic of China	1904.2
2		IND	India	1898.0
3		JPN	Japan	1897.1
4		KOR	Republic of Korea	1895.8
5		VIE	Vietnam	1884.3
6		KAZ	Kazakhstan	1879.9
7		IRI	Islamic Republic of Iran	1835.5
8		INA	Indonesia	1876.6

- The trio of **Sonam Maskar, Elavenil Valarivan and Vidarsa Vinod K** opened India's medal account at the 2026 Asian Games with a **silver medal in the women's 10m Air rifle event.**
- While **China took the gold medal** with a total score of 1904.2, India held on to second spot by 0.9 as **Japan finished third with 1897.1.**

Asian Games 2026: Smriti Mandhana surpasses Suzie Bates to become women's T20I cricket's leading run-scorer

- India opener Smriti Mandhana became the **leading run-scorer in women's T20Is, surpassing New Zealand great Suzie Bates**' tally of 4,758 runs during India's Asian Games semifinal against Bangladesh
- **Smriti Mandhana now has 4788 runs in 178 games in the shortest format.**
- She recently surpassed former India captain Mithali Raj's tally of 10,868 runs during the Women's Asia Cup.
- Mandhana **now has 10,987 international runs across formats --** 788 in Tests, 5,411 in ODIs and 4,788 in T20Is. Bates is third on the all-format list with 10,740 runs.
- Mandhana also holds the record for most international centuries in women's cricket.

Most runs in women's T20I cricket

- Smriti Mandhana (India) - 4788 runs
- Suzie Bates (New Zealand) - 4758 runs
- Harmanpreet Kaur (India) - 4327 runs
- Chamari Athapaththu (Sri Lanka) - 4282 runs
- Sophie Devine (New Zealand) - 3817 runs

Asian Games 2026: Silver for Himanshu, bronze for Rudrankksh Patil in men's 10m air rifle

- Indian shooters **Himanshu Dhillon and Rudrankksh Patil clinched silver and bronze medals, respectively**, in the men's 10m air rifle individual event at the Asian Games 2026, as China's Sheng Lihao secured the gold medal
- **Vidarsa Vinod becomes first woman shooter from Keralam to win medal at Asian Games**
- **Kerala's Vidarsa K. Vinod won silver in the women's 10m air rifle team event at the Asian Games 2026 in Japan**, becoming the first female sportsperson from the State to win an Asian Games medal in shooting.
- This was Vinod's first Asian Games, where she is also competing in the women's 50m rifle 3 Positions event.

Suchika Tariyal Wins India's First Asian Games MMA Medal

- Suchika Tariyal won India's first-ever Asian Games medal in mixed martial arts
- **She secured a bronze medal in the women's traditional -60 kg category at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games 2026,** where MMA featured as a medal sport for the first time.
- Mixed martial arts, or MMA, is a combat sport that combines techniques from striking and grappling disciplines.

Savita Punia Becomes India's Most-Capped Women's Hockey Player

- India's goalkeeper Savita Punia became the most-capped player in the history of Indian women's hockey
- She equalled Vandana Katariya's record of 320 caps during India's opening match against Uzbekistan.
- later, she earned her 321st international cap against Indonesia at the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.
- A cap is an appearance for a national team in an official international match.
- Savita Punia made her senior international debut in 2009.
- Her career included a historic Olympic hat-trick at the Tokyo Games and the Padma Shri.

India Women win cricket gold, country's first at Asian Games 2026

- The Indian women's cricket team retained the women's cricket gold at the Asian Games, beating Sri Lanka by 147 runs in the final held at the Korogi Sports Park in Nisshin.

- It was India's first gold medal at the Asian Games 2026.
- The victory margin was India's highest ever in all women's T20Is, eclipsing a 144-run win over Malaysia in 2018.
- Shafali and Mandhana became the first pair to reach 4000 runs in T20Is

Shafali Verma Sets Women's T20I Runs Record

- Shafali Verma became the highest run-scorer in a calendar year in Women's Twenty20 Internationals on 22 September 2026.
- She reached the mark during India's Asian Games gold-medal match against Sri Lanka at Korogi Sports Park, Nisshin, and finished the year with 863 runs in 24 T20Is.
- Verma surpassed South Africa's Laura Wolvaardt, who had scored 824 runs in 2026.

Asian Games 2026: India's women's skeet team wins bronze, secures sixth shooting medal

- At the Asian Games, the Indian trio of **Maheshwari Singh, Parinaaz Dhaliwal and Raiza Dhillon** secured **the bronze medal** in the women's team skeet shooting event at Aichi-Nagoya.
- **China won gold with 346 points, while Kazakhstan took silver.**

India Wins First-Ever Asian Games Medal in Soft Tennis

- **Jay Meena secured India's first ever soft tennis medal at the Asian Games**, fetching a **bronze after losing to Japan's Takuya Kurosaka** in the men's singles semifinals.
- **He hails from Madhya Pradesh's Dewas and is a 2022 National Games gold-medallist.**
- Meena previously won a bronze medal in the mixed doubles event of the 2024 World Soft Tennis Championship.

Mirabai Chanu Wins Asian Games Silver in 49 kg

- **India's Mirabai Chanu won the silver medal in the women's 49kg weightlifting event at the Asian Games 2026 in Japan.**
- Mirabai Chanu, **a Tokyo 2020 Olympic silver medallist, finished with a total lift of 198kg (87kg snatch + 111 clean and jerk) .**
- She also became India's first Asian Games weightlifting medallist since Karnam Malleswari won silver in Bangkok in 1998.

Asian Games: Indian men''s badminton team settles for bronze after 1-3 loss to China

- The Indian men's badminton team settled for a **bronze medal at the Asian Games 2026** after losing 3-1 to the People's Republic of China in the semi-finals in Aichi, Japan.
- India had won the silver medal at the last edition in Hangzhou in 2023, where they had lost to China in the final.

Roshibina Devi Wins Silver in Women's Sanda 60 kg

- India's **Roshibina Devi won silver in the women's 60kg sanda event at the Asian Games 2026** in Aichi-Nagoya, becoming the first Indian to win medals in wushu at three consecutive editions of the continental showpiece.
- Roshibina made her **first Asian Games podium with bronze at Jakarta 2018** before upgrading to silver at Hangzhou 2023 and matching that result at Aichi-Nagoya 2026.

Satnam Singh, Salman Khan Win Asian Games Bronze in Men's Double Sculls

- Satnam Singh and Salman Khan won a **bronze in the men's double sculls** as India concluded their **rowing campaign** at the **Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya with one medal.**
- The Indian pair clocked 6:13.25 at the **Nagaragawa International Regatta Course to finish behind the People's Republic of China'**
- It was India's first-ever Asian Games medal in the men's double sculls.

Asian Games 2026: Kamaljeet-Suruchi shoot India to gold in 10m air pistol mixed team event

- **Suruchi Singh and Kamaljeet** delivered India their **first gold medal in shooting at the Asian Games** 2026 , by winning the **10m air pistol mixed team title.**
- The Indian pair shot an Asian record 484.6 in the final to beat the Republic of Korea
- It was India's first Asian Games gold medal in the 10m air pistol mixed team event,
- **India Wins Silver in Asian Games 50m Rifle Team Event**
- India won the **silver medal in the men's 50m rifle** 3 positions team event at the Asian Games.
- The Indian team of **Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar, Niraj Kumar, and Rudrankksh Patil** scored 1762-94x and finished second behind China at the Aichi Pref. General Shooting Gallery in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.

India win silver in 4x400m mixed relay, Seema wins bronze in 10,000m

- In the Asian Games, 2026 Indian runners have clinched **silver in the mixed 4x400m relay race at Nagoya**
- The quartet of **Poovamma Raju, Vishal Thennarasu, Vithya Ramraj and Manu TS** timed the run at 3 mins 14.46 seconds
- **Seema Kumari won bronze in the 10,000 metre race** after finishing at third spot in 32.50 mins.
- The achievement marks India's first medal in the women's 10,000m event at the Asian Games in 16 years

Asian Games 2026 shooting: Anantjeet-Parinaaz win mixed skeet bronze medal

- **India's Anantjeet Singh Naruka and Parinaaz Dhaliwal** won the **bronze medal** in the **skeet mixed team shooting event at the Asian Games 2026**
- China went on to win gold, South Korea took silver

Asian Games 2026: Abhay settles for silver after losing to Malaysia's Eain Yow

- **India's Abhay Singh settled for the silver medal in the men's singles squash competition** at the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.
- **Anahat Singh won a historic silver medal in the women's singles squash event** at the 2026 Asian Games.
- Despite the loss, **Anahat became the first Indian woman to win a silver medal in singles squash at the Asian Games.**
- **Abhay is only the second Indian to win silver in men's singles** at the Games, **after Saurav Ghosal, who made the finals at Incheon 2014 and Hangzhou 2023 but lost**.
- The Indian mixed doubles team of Joshna Chinappa and Velavan Senthilkumar had secured a bronze medal .

Gulveer Singh on winning Silver medal in Men's 10,000m at Asian Games

- Gulveer Singh created Indian athletics history by becoming the **first Indian to win two Asian Games medals in the men's 10,000m after securing silver at the Mizuho Park Athletic Stadium.**
- Gulveer clocked **28:29.38 in the 25-lap race to finish second**, adding the silver to the **bronze he won in the event at the 2023 Asian Games in Hangzhou.**

- At the **Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, he won silver in the 10,000m and bronze in the 5,000m,** becoming the first Indian man to win a Commonwealth Games medal in the 10,000m.

Kabaddi Golden Double: India wins men's and women's Kabaddi gold at Asian Games

- **India completed a golden double in kabaddi** at the Asian Games as both the **men's and women's teams defended their respective titles with thrilling victories over Iran in the finals.**
- The men had won seven straight Asian Games gold medals before their streak ended in 2018, but they reclaimed the title at the 2023 Hangzhou Games.

Sawan clinches marathon silver; Tajinderpal settles for second spot; Prachi pulls off a surprise

- **Sawan Barwal wins silver in men's marathon at Asian Games 2026**
- Indian marathon runner Sawan Barwal created history at the Asian Games 2026 by winning a silver medal in the men's marathon event.
- **Barwal clocked 2:11:37 to register a personal best and set a new national record in the men's marathon final.**
- India's **Tajinderpal Singh Toor clinched the silver medal in the men's shot put** final at the Asian Games 2026, producing a best throw of 20.64 metres with his fifth attempt.
- **He had won gold medals at the 2018 Jakarta and 2022 Hangzhou editions before finishing second in Aichi-Nagoya.**
- **Prachi Choudhary contributed to India's Asian Games 2026 athletics medal tally with bronze in the women's 400m**.
- Prachi Choudhary clocked 53.21s to finish third
- It was **India's first Asian Games medal in the women's 400m since Hima Das won silver at Jakarta 2018.**
- **India wins silver in women's 50m rifle three positions team event at Asian Games**
- **Tilottama Sen, Vidarsa Vinod and Ashi Chouksey** won the women's 50m rifle 3 positions team **silver for India in shooting at the Asian Games 2026.**
- The Indian trio combined for 1763-90x at the Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery to finish second **behind the People's Republic of China,**

Baranica Elangovan Wins Bronze in Women's Pole Vault at Asian Games

- **Indian athlete Baranica Elangovan** won the **bronze medal in the women's pole vault at the Asian Games at Aichi-Nagoya in Japan**
- This marks country's **first-ever medal in the pole vault event at the Asian Games.**
- finish with a best clearance of 4.15 metres.
- Earlier this year, she shattered the National Record twice-first leaping 4.22m in March and later rewriting it to 4.23m in May at Bhubaneswar.

Manush Shah and Diya Chitale on winning Bronze medal in Mixed Doubles Table Tennis event at Asian Games

- India's **Manush Shah and Diya Chitale won the bronze medal in the mixed doubles table tennis event** at the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya.
- **Table tennis was first contested at the Asian Games at Tokyo 1958.**
- India waited 60 years for its first medal in the sport, with the men's team and Sharath-Manika winning bronze medals at Jakarta 2018.

Rishabh Das Sets National Record in 200m Backstroke

- **Rishabh Das set a new Indian national record in the men's 200m backstroke at** the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.
- **The 19-year-old swimmer recorded 1:58.77 in the final and finished sixth.**
- He improved his own previous national record of 1:59.84, which he had set earlier in 2026.

Asian Games 2026: Gritty Esha claims silver in women's 25m pistol

- In the Asian Games 2026 in Japan, **India's Esha Singh won the silver medal in the women's 25-metre pistol individual** competition at Aichi-Nagoya with 38 points
- **Indian athlete Pincky Balhara** secured the **bronze medal in the women's under-78kg Kurash event** at Aichi-Nagoya. She won the medal after defeating South Korea's Lim Garam
- **Sarvesh Kushare and Ancy Sojan** Edappilly won **silver medals in the men's high jump and women's long jump** at the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.
- **Parul Chaudhary** won the bronze medal and set a **new national record of 9:08.67 in the women's 3000m steeplechase** at the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya.
- **India's Tejaswin Shankar** won the **bronze medal in the men's decathlon** at the Asian Games 2026 in Nagoya, Japan.
- He finished with a total score of 7,934 points. He secured third place after winning the final 1500m race with a time of 4:33.09.
- **India's Harita Bhadra** clinched the **bronze medal in the women's 200m, clocking 23.20 seconds in the final.**

Neeru Dhanda scripts history with India's first women's trap gold

- Neeru Dhanda scripted history by becoming **India's first shooter to win an Asian Games gold medal** in the **women's trap individual event.**
- The 26-year-old from Haryana, who became the first Indian woman to win a World Cup gold medal in trap event at the Shotgun World Cup in Italy in July, won the gold with a score of 28, surpassing the previous Asian Record of 24.
- **No Indian woman trap or skeet shooter has ever won an individual medal at Asian Games.**
- **Randhir Singh had won India's historic individual gold in the men's individual trap event at the 1978 edition**, while Ronjan Sodhi claimed the individual gold medal in the men's double trap event at the 2010 Games.

Indian Women's Trap Shooting Team Wins Silver at Asian Games 2026

- The **Indian Women's Trap Shooting Team secured a silver medal at the Asian Games 2026** in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.
- The Indian trio consisted of **Neeru Dhanda, Aashima Ahlawat, and Manisha Keer.** They combined for a total score of 328 points
- **Vithya Ramraj on winning Bronze in Women's 400m hurdles at Asian Games**
- Indian hurdler **Vithya Ramraj** won the **bronze medal in the women's 400m hurdles at the 2026 Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya**
- At the 2023 Asian Games in Hangzhou, Vithya Ramraj clocked 55.42 seconds in the 400m hurdles, matching PT Usha's 1984 national record, the longest-standing in Indian athletics.
- **Indian long jumper Murali Sreeshankar** won the **silver medal in the men's long jump** at the Asian Games 2026 in Nagoya, Japan, with a jump of 8.07 meters

- **Indian javelin athletes Yashvir Singh and Rohit Yadav clinched silver and bronze medals,** respectively, in the men's javelin throw final at the Asian Games 2026.

Asian Games 2026: India sweep compound archery team gold medals; secure mixed team LA 2028 Olympics quota

- India swept all three compound archery gold medals on offer in team events at the Asian Games 2026.
- The three gold medals won by India in archery came from the following categories: Women's Compound Team, Compound Mixed Team and Men's Compound Team
- Women's Compound Team: The trio of Jyothi Surekha Vennam, Prithika Pradeep, and Chikitha Taniparthi
- Compound Mixed Team: The duo of Chikitha Taniparthi and Sahil Rajesh Jadhav. The pair also confirmed their berth in the 2028 LA Olympics, where the mixed compound event will make its debut.
- Men's Compound Team: Sahil Rajesh Jadhav, Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru, and Kushal Dalal

Asian Games 2026: Neeru-Kynan team snares trap mixed team shooting gold

- The Indian pair of Neeru Dhanda and Kynan Chenai clinched the gold medal in the trap mixed team event of the Asian Games

Archery

India to Host World Archery Para Series 2026



- India will host the Hyundai World Archery Para Series 2026 for the **first time at the Sabarmati Riverfront in Ahmedabad, Gujarat,** from September 5 to September 9, 2026.
- The tournament is **Stage 3 of the 2026 World Archery Para Series** and will feature competition in **Recurve Open, Compound Open, W1, and Visually Impaired divisions.**
- The World Archery Para Series is an international para archery circuit **conducted under World Archery, the global governing body for archery.**
- The 2026 series **includes Stage 1 in Bangkok, Thailand**, **Stage 2 in Nove Mesto, Czechia, and Stage 3 in Ahmedabad, India**.

World Archery Para Series : India finishes second in medal's table

- India concluded the World Archery Para Series 2026 Stage 3 in Ahmedabad with **15 medals - four gold, three silver and eight bronze -**
- The host **India finished second, behind Czechia, which topped the table with five gold.**
- **World Archery Para Series 2026 Ahmedabad: Indian medal winners**

Gold

- Women's individual compound: Sheetal Devi
- Men's compound doubles: Toman Kumar, Shyam Sunder Swami
- Men's recurve doubles: Harvinder Singh, Vijay Sundi
- Recurve mixed team: Bhawna, Harvinder Singh

Silver

- Women's recurve doubles: Bhawna, Pooja
- W1 mixed team: Swati Chaudhary, Adil Mohamed Nazir Ansari

- Visually impaired: Tanvi Pravin Ingale

Cricket

Rankings and Records

Shree Charani Becomes Fastest Indian to 50 T20I Wickets

- **Shree Charani, an Indian left-arm spinner, reached 50 T20I wickets in her 29th international match** on 10 September 2026.
- She became the **fastest Indian bowler across men's and women's cricket to reach the mark**, surpassing Kuldeep Yadav's previous Indian record of 30 matches.
- At 22 years and 37 days, **Charani became the second-youngest Indian to reach 50 women's T20I wickets.**
- **Radha Yadav remains the youngest Indian to do so,** with the age figure recorded at 20 years and 334 days.

Trophy

India wins record eighth Women's Asia Cup title



- The Indian cricket team beat Sri Lanka by 72 runs in the **Women's Asia Cup 2026 final to clinch a record-extending eighth title** at the Dubai International Stadium
- Ever since the **first edition of the competition in 2004, only three teams have won the coveted title — India, Sri Lanka, and Bangladesh.**
- India is the most successful team with a record eight **titles (2004, 2005-06, 2006, 2008, 2012, 2016, 2022 and 2026), while Bangladesh (2018) and Sri Lanka (2024) have won it once each.**

Sree Charani Sets ICC Women's T20I Bowling Record

- **India spinner Sree Charani became the world No. 1 bowler in the ICC Women's T20I Bowling Rankings.**
- **She reached 817 rating points, which is the highest tally recorded in the women's T20I bowling rankings.**
- **The previous best was 806 rating points, set by Australian pacer Megan Schutt in November 2018.**

Retirement

Mark Wood Announces Retirement from International Cricket

- England fast bowler Mark Wood announced his retirement from international cricket on 22 September 2026.
- Mark Wood played 38 Test matches and took 119 wickets at an average of 30.79.
- He also played 70 One Day Internationals and took 80 wickets, along with 38 Twenty20 Internationals in which he took 54 wickets.
- Wood was part of the England squads that won the 2019 Cricket World Cup and the 2022 T20 World Cup.

Miscellaneous

Tavengwa Mukuhlani Appointed ICC Deputy Chairperson

- The International Cricket Council (ICC) Board has appointed **Tavengwa Mukuhlani as its Deputy Chairperson until November 2027.**

- He will hold the office until November 2027 and **becomes the first Zimbabwean to serve in this position.**
- **ICC Chairman, Jay Shah**
- The International Cricket Council is the global governing body for cricket and **was founded in 1909 as the Imperial Cricket Conference**

India to Host Women's Champions Trophy

- The inaugural edition of the **ICC Women's Champions Trophy will be held in India** next year, from February 14 to 28, **after the governing council stripped Sri Lanka of its hosting rights.**
- The Champions Trophy tournament will be held at the Cricket Club of **India in Mumbai and the Vadodara International Cricket Stadium in Vadodara, and will comprise six teams — Australia, England, India, New Zealand, South Africa and Sri Lanka.**

Abhiram Singh Yadav Joins ICC Chief Executives' Committee

- **Abhiram Singh Yadav, Chairman of Persatuan Cricket Indonesia**, was elected to an Associate Member position on the International Cricket Council Chief Executives' Committee.
- He won **one of the three seats reserved for Associate Member representatives** and will serve until the next elections at the ICC Annual Conference in June 2027.
- The Chief Executives' Committee is a committee of the **International Cricket Council that includes representatives from Full Members and Associate Members.**

Chess

Ganges Grandmasters beat Alpine Pipers to win maiden GCL title

- Ganges Grandmasters won their maiden Tech Mahindra Global Chess League (GCL) title by defeating the defending champions, Alpine APL Pipers.

Chess Olympiad: India wins silver in Open section; women claim bronze

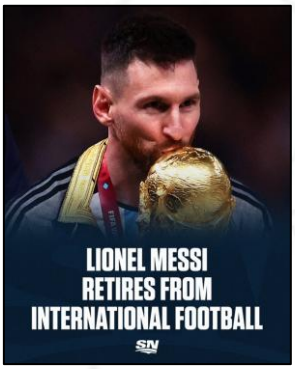
- India **defended the prestigious Nona Gaprindashvili Trophy at the 46th Chess Olympiad in Samarkand, Uzbekistan**, finishing as the best overall nation after picking up a silver in the Open section and a bronze in the Women's event.
- **This marks the third straight edition where India have won the trophy**
- The Uzbekistan team regained the gold medal in the open section
- In the women's section, China annexed the gold

Bodhana Sivanandan Becomes Youngest Woman Grandmaster

- Bodhana Sivanandan has become the **youngest player in history to earn the Woman Grandmaster (WGM) title, the International Chess Federation (FIDE) confirmed.**
- The 11-year-old Indian-origin British player completed her third and final WGM norm at the recently concluded 2026 Chess Olympiad in Samarkand, Uzbekistan, while representing England.
- **The previous age record belonged to Russian Grandmaster Kateryna Lagno, who achieved the WGM title at 12**

Football

Lionel Messi retires from international football



- Lionel Messi, who captained Argentina to World Cup victory in 2022 and the final in 2026, is retiring from international football,
- **The record eight-time Ballon d'Or winner is his country's record scorer, with 125 goals in 207 games.**
- Messi, played in six World Cups, won the tournament in Qatar in 2022 and led Argentina to the final in 2026 losing to Spain.
- **He is the highest-scoring man in South American soccer history.**

Munich and Barcelona to Host UEFA Champions League Finals

- The UEFA Executive Committee appointed **Munich and Barcelona as host cities for future UEFA Champions League finals** at a meeting in Thessaloniki, Greece.
- **The Munich Football Arena, also known as the Allianz Arena, will host the final in 2028,** while **Camp Nou in Barcelona will stage the final in 2029.**
- The UEFA Champions League final is the last match of Europe's premier club football competition, organised by the Union of European Football Associations (UEFA).

AIFF Launches Inaugural U15 Women's Youth League

- The **All India Football Federation (AIFF)** will launch the inaugural **U15 Women's Youth League on 15 October 2026** at the Sporting Planet Sports Complex in **Belagavi, Karnataka.**
- The league will feature 16 teams from across India and will conclude with the final on 31 October 2026.
- The AIFF is the national governing body for football in India and organises domestic competitions for men's and women's football.
- The U15 Women's Youth League follows the AIFF U17 Women's Youth League launched in July 2026.

Karan Yadav Appointed Indian Super League CEO

- The Indian Super League (ISL) appointed Karan Yadav as its **first Chief Executive Officer under a new club-led structure.**
- Yadav previously served as Chief Commercial Officer at JSW Sports from April 2023 to September 2026.
- **The Indian Super League is a professional football league in India.**
- The league operates with clubs, broadcasters, sponsors, and the All India Football Federation (AIFF) as key stakeholders

Tennis

Grand Slam

US Open: Elena Rybakina of Kazakhstan beats Belarusian Aryna Sabalenka to win Women's Singles title



- In tennis, Kazakhstan's Elena Rybakina defeated Belarusian Aryna Sabalenka to win the **US Open women's singles final at Arthur Ashe Stadium in New York.**



- This is **Rybakina's first US Open title and her third career Grand Slam championship**, following her Australian Open victory earlier in the year.
- American Christian Harrison and Britain's Neal Skupski clinched the men's doubles title,
- The American-British pair won the final 6-4, 7-6 to claim their second Grand Slam title of the year, after their Australian Open victory in January.

US Open men's final: Alexander Zverev defeats Ben Shelton

- Top seed **Alexander Zverev captured his first US Open crown** and second Grand Slam title of 2026 by defeating American Ben Shelton

Category	Champion(s)
Women's Singles	Elena Rybakina
Men's Doubles	Neal Skupski & Christian Harrison
Women's Doubles	Taylor Townsend & Kateřina Siniaková
Mixed Doubles	Karolina Muchova & Jakub Mensik

- Grand Slam tournaments, **also called majors**, are the four most important annual tennis events.
- The **Grand Slam itinerary consists of** :
- The Australian Open in mid-January,
- The French Open in May - June,
- Wimbledon in June–July
- The US Open in August–September.
- The **Australian and United States** tournaments are played on **hard courts**, the **French on clay**, and **Wimbledon on grass.**
- **Wimbledon is the oldest,** founded **in 1877**, followed by the **US in 1881**, the **French in 1891**, and the **Australian in 1905**.

Tennis: India's Karan Singh clinches singles title at ITF Men's World Tour

- In Tennis, India's Karan Singh clinched the **Men's Singles title at the ITF Men's World Tour M15, at Bali in Indonesia.**
- hails from Karnal in Haryana defeated Isaac Becroft of New Zealand

India's SD Prajwal Dev wins second ATP Challenger doubles title in Vietnam

- In tennis, India's SD Prajwal Dev, partnering France's Constantin Bittoun Kouzmine, has won his **second ATP Challenger doubles title at the Sport Festival Challenger** in Phan Thiet, Vietnam.

Table Tennis

Ankur wins maiden WTT title, doubles gold in Czechia

- Indian table tennis player Ankur Bhattacharjee has won his **maiden WTT men's singles title at the WTT Feeder Olomouc tournament in Czechia.**
- He **also secured the men's doubles gold with fellow Indian Akash Pal.**

Race

Prem Khandle emerges as overall winner in FIM Moto Mini India Series

- The India Series is a structured platform for young riders between the age of 10 and 14 to develop their racing skills and progress towards international competition.
- The top two riders will represent India in the FIM Moto Mini World Series in Valencia, Spain, from November 22 to 26, ahead of the final round of the FIM MotoGP.

Grand Prix

Kim Antonelli wins Spanish Grand Prix, extends F1 points lead

- Kimi Antonelli won the first Spanish Grand Prix finishing ahead of Max Verstappen and Lando Norris

Kimi Antonelli Wins Italian Grand Prix at Monza

- Mercedes driver Kimi Antonelli won a historic and sensational Italian Grand Prix at Monza, became the first Italian driver to win at Monza in 60 years,

Badminton

Satwik-Chirag Win Maiden China Masters Title

- Indian badminton stars **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty** made history on September 6, 2026, by becoming the **first Indian men's doubles pair to win the China Masters.**
- The duo defeated China's He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang Yu in Shenzhen
- The victory is their **second BWF World Tour title of 2026, following the Singapore Open Super 750, and their 10th World Tour title overall.**

Japan Para Badminton International 2026: Pramod Bhagat Wins Gold, Pairs with Sukant Kadam for Doubles Silver

- At the **Japan Para Badminton International 2026 held in Tokyo**, Tokyo Paralympic champion **Pramod Bhagat clinched the gold medal** in the men's singles SL3 category and a silver medal in the men's doubles SL3-SU5 category alongside partner Sukant Kadam.
- This tournament also marked a **monumental milestone for Sukant Kadam, who successfully completed his 100th career medal haul.**

Tanvi Patri wins U17 title in all-Indian final at Badminton Asia Junior Championships

- Fifteen-year-old **Tanvi Patri secured the girls' singles U17 title at the Badminton Asia U17 & U15 Junior Championships final.**

Pickleball

India Finishes Fourth at Pickleball World Cup 2026

- The 2026 Pickleball World Cup was held in Da Nang, Vietnam, from 30 August 2026, and India finished fourth in the overall medal standings with 41 medals.
- The Indian tally **included seven gold, 17 silver, and 17 bronze medals.**
- Pickleball is a paddle sport that **combines elements of tennis, badminton, and table tennis.**

Squash

India's Abhay Singh wins men's singles title at Tuanku Muhriz Trophy 2026

- **In Squash, India's Abhay Singh won the men's singles title at the Tuanku Muhriz Trophy 2026 in Seremban, Malaysia.**
- It was also **Abhay Singh's third Tuanku Muhriz Trophy title.**
- He previously won the tournament in 2022 and 2024.
- He is also part of the Indian squash squad for the Asian Games 2026 in Aichi-Nagoya.

Hockey

India crowned Asia Cup champions with 4-1 win over Korea

- **India defended their men's Junior Hockey Team Asia Cup title with remarkable ease, winning the final against Korea 4-1** .
- India lifted the **continental crown for a record sixth time.**
- India's previous titles came in **2004, 2008, 2015, 2023 and 2024**
- Hockey India announced prize money of Rs 3 lakh for each player and Rs 1.5 lakh for each member of the support staff.

Javelin

Rumesh Pathirage wins Diamond League Final with a throw of 89.04m

- **Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage** capped a sensational season by winning the **men's javelin throw at the Diamond League Final 2026 in Brussels**, becoming the first Sri Lankan to win the title.
- produced a best throw of 89.04m
- NOTE: **India's Neeraj Chopra did not compete in the Diamond League** Final after withdrawing from the event last week due to injury.

Shooting

Laxuman Adhikari wins Sikkim's first-ever North East Zonal shooting medal

- Sikkim Shooters performed extraordinarily in 13th North East Zone Shooting Championship 2026.
- **13th North East Zone Shooting Championship 2026 concluded at Guwahati, Assam.**
- Laxuman Adhikari from Sikkim won a historic Bronze Medal in the Master Men's 10m Air Pistol Individual category in this Championship.
- This was the **first-ever medal won by a shooter representing Sikkim at the North East Zonal level.**

Yugan Sakthivel Muthukumaar Wins Men's Trap Gold

- Indian shooter **Yugan Sakthivel Muthukumaar won the gold medal in men's trap** at the ISSF **Junior World Cup Shotgun 2026 in Porpetto, Italy**
- Other Indian results at the event:
- **Men's trap qualification**: Arjun and Vinay Pratap Singh Chandrawat finished 12th and 13th with 112 each. Udhav Singh Rathore was 16th with 111.
- **Women's trap:** Junior Asian champion Sabeera Haris was the only Indian to reach the final.
- **Skeet events:** No Indian shooter reached the final in the junior men's or women's skeet.

ISSF Junior World Cup Shotgun 2026

- **Venue: Porpetto, Italy**
- Dates: 12 to 20 September 2026
- Participants: 218 athletes from 30 member federations
- **Series position: This is the second ISSF Junior World Cup of the year.**
- Record: **Greece's Pontikis equalled the junior world record in the opening days of the finals.**
- **The first Junior World Cup of the year was held in Cairo, Egypt, in April 2026, with rifle, pistol and shotgun events.**
- **India topped the medal tally there with 16 medals**: five gold, six silver and five bronze.
- **Zuhair Khan and Addya Katyal won India's only shotgun medal in Cairo, a bronze in mixed trap.**

Yugan Sakthivel wins junior men's trap event at ISSF Junior World Cup

- Yugan Sakthivel **Muthukumar won gold in the junior men's trap event at the ISSF Junior World Cup held in Porpetto, Italy, recently.**
- The 15-year-old from Tamil Nadu finished with 27 hits out of 30 to finish on top of the podium.

Miscellaneous

Zuccaro bags the President Of India Gold Cup

- The **six-year-old champion Zuccaro** extended his spectacular winning streak by **clinching the prestigious President Of India Gold Cup (Gr.2) at the Hyderabad Race Club**
- Trained by the **legendary Pesi Shroff and masterfully piloted by jockey Vivek G**
- This victory marks Zuccaro's sixth consecutive win,
- The President of India Gold Cup is a prestigious **Grade II annual horse racing event traditionally** held during the Hyderabad Monsoon Races at the Hyderabad Race Club

Tanya Chaudhary Sets National Hammer Throw Record

- Tanya Chaudhary became the unlikely star at the Indian Athletics Series Final as the 22-year-old from Uttar Pradesh **shattered the national record in the women's hammer throw.**
- **Tanya sent the hammer to a distance of 68.35 metres**, improving her state-mate Anushka Yadav's previous record of 67.02m set in June at the Inter-State National Championships.
- **Anushka finished second with 66.34m.**

Nirbhay Choudhary Breaks Men's Hammer Throw National Record

- **Delhi athlete Nirbhay Choudhary** set a new **men's hammer throw national record of 71.02 metres on** 10 September 2026 at the Indian Athletics Final Series in New Delhi.
- The mark broke the previous Indian record of **70.73 metres, which Neeraj Kumar had set in 2016.**
- Hammer throw is a field event in track and field athletics.

Assam CM, Sunil Gavaskar launch Guwahati International Marathon

- Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and former cricketer Sunil Gavaskar launched the **Guwahati International Marathon.**
- About 12,000 people, including top international athletes, are expected to take part in the maiden running event in northeast India's largest city scheduled for **February 7, 2027.**

- Promoted by PMG Sports LLP, the **event with ₹1.25 crore as prize money will feature races across five categories—the full marathon of 42.195 km, the half marathon of 21.097 km, the 10 km, 5 km, and a 1.5 km community run.**
- The Assam Tourism Development Corporation will be the State sponsor of the inaugural Guwahati International Marathon.

India Wins Nine Medals at International Earth Science Olympiad 2026

- The International Olympiad was held from **August 20 to August 27 in Italy, with a total of 39 countries participating from across the globe.**
- Indian students achieved a historic feat by winning **nine medals, including four gold, three silver and two bronze, across various categories.**
- Earlier this year, five Indian students clinched gold medals in July at the 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026, held in Bucaramanga, Colombia.
- India also bagged four gold medals at the 58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026, organized from July 10 to 19 in Tashkent, Uzbekistan.

India to Host Cycling Road World Championships in Pune in 2032

- **Pune will host the UCI Road World Championships in 2032**, marking the first time cycling's prestigious global road championships to be held in India.
- The decision was announced at the **UCI Congress in Montreal,**
- The bid was jointly led by the Government of Maharashtra and the Cycling Federation of India, with support from the Government of India

Short News

- Two-time Asian Games defending **champion Tajinderpal Singh Toor** was replaced as India's flag-bearer by **kabaddi star Pawan Sehrawat,** as the shot putter didn't have his ceremonial kit.
- Manu Bhaker was the other flag-bearer.

Banking & Finance

India's sovereign credit rating upgraded to 'A-' with Stable Outlook by Japan Credit Rating Agency

- The Japan Credit Rating Agency (JCRA) upgraded **India's sovereign rating from BBB+ to A- with stable outlook**
- The Indian economy has maintained a high growth rate of around 7%,
- The growth momentum was sustained in Q1 of FY27, with real GDP growing by 7.8%,

Coastal Local Area Bank Gets Scheduled Bank Status

- **Coastal Local Area Bank Limited, headquartered in Vijayawada**, was included in the Second Schedule to the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, and received scheduled bank status.
- Scheduled banks in India are banks listed in the **Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.**
- Such banks can **access Reserve Bank of India liquidity facilities, participate in money market operations**, and receive refinance support from institutions such as NABARD and the National Housing Bank.

With UPI fee update, what may change for shopping above Rs 2,000

- The government has barred banks and payment system providers from charging any fee on UPI transactions up to Rs 2,000, while leaving payments above that threshold outside the exemption.

- The notification, therefore, creates the legal room for introducing charges such **as the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments above Rs 2,000.**
- **MDR is a fee charged to merchants.**

What is Merchant Discount Rate (MDR)?

- MDR is a **fee charged to merchants for processing digital payments,** and is typically shared among banks and other entities involved in processing the transaction.
- **Credit cards, for instance, face an MDR of 1-3% of transaction value while it is up to 0.9% for debit cards.**
- UPI, unlike card payments, has **operated under a zero-MDR regime since January 2020.**
- To be clear, such a fee **would not apply on person-to-person payments** — that is, if you transferred an amount more than Rs 2,000 to a friend

NCDEX Launches Chennai Rain Futures Contract

- The National Commodity & Derivatives Exchange Limited (NCDEX) **launched RAINCHNNAI**, a weather futures contract **for Chennai's Northeast monsoon.**
- The contract is **cash-settled,** uses **official rainfall data from the India Meteorological Department (IMD)**, and is **linked to rainfall recorded at the Meenambakkam and Nungambakkam weather** stations in Chennai.
- Weather Derivatives
- Weather derivatives are **financial contracts whose value depends on measurable weather variables such as rainfall, temperature, or snowfall.**
- They are used in risk management by sectors exposed to weather variability, including agriculture, logistics, retail, and utilities.

India Post Payments Bank Celebrates 9th Foundation Day ; Launches DakPay Sound Box

- India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) marks its 9th Foundation Day on 1st September 2026.
- As part of the 9th Foundation Day celebrations, **IPPB announced the launch of DakPay Sound Box for Merchants**, designed to simplify and strengthen everyday digital payment acceptance for merchants.
- The Bank also announced the launch of its **Digital Insurance Technology Platform**, designed to provide customers with a seamless pathway to insurance solutions by connecting them with opportunities across **Life, Health and General Insurance.**
- IPPB has also introduced a **Digital Mutual Fund Platform, aimed at providing customers with a simple, accessible and seamless digital investment experience.**

Moody's raises India fiscal 2027 GDP growth forecast to 7% on West Asia resilience

- Moody's Ratings sharply raised **India's GDP growth forecast for current fiscal to 7 per cent, from 6 per cent earlier**, saying the economy has shown resilience to global shocks amid the West Asia conflict but flagged risks to inflation from elevated oil prices and El Nino impact.
- **India's real GDP growth accelerated to 8.2% year on year in the first six months of calendar year (CY) 2026,** up from 7.3% for the full year in CY 2025

India's First Blue Bond Set for Launch

- India's first blue bond issue is scheduled for launch on 28 September 2026 by **Sagarmala Finance Corporation, a state-owned maritime lender.**

- The proposed issue size is ₹600 crore, with a greenshoe option of ₹500 crore, and the **bonds have a tenor of 10 years**.
- Blue bonds are debt instruments **in which the proceeds are earmarked for projects linked to oceans, marine ecosystems, water management, and the sustainable blue economy.**
- Such instruments are used in financing activities connected with **coastal infrastructure, marine conservation, and water-related public utilities.**

Trinidad and Tobago to Become First Caribbean Nation to Adopt UPI

- **Trinidad and Tobago** is set to become the **first Caribbean nation to adopt India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI),** a real-time digital payments system developed by the National Payments Corporation of India.
- The project involves a real-time payments platform modelled **on UPI and is linked to technical cooperation between NPCI International Payments Limited and the Ministry of Digital Transformation of Trinidad and Tobago.**










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